

THURSDAY, AUGUST 6, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 20 PAGES

₹7.00 (₹8 RAIPUR, ₹15 SRINAGAR) • www.indianexpress.com

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

Happening today

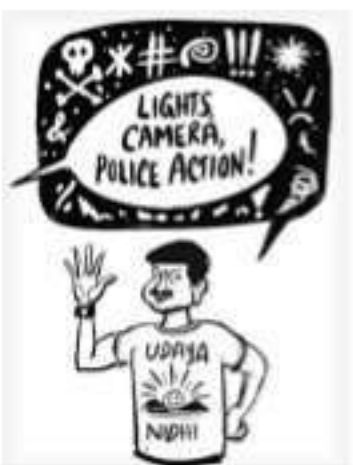
● **BOMBAY HC** will pronounce its verdict on Goa government's plea challenging Tarun Tejpal's acquittal in a sexual assault case.

● **SC WILL** resume hearing pleas of Uddhav Thackeray-led faction against the EC's decision recognising Shinde-led faction as "real Shiv Sena".

TRACK THESE AND MORE ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



RBI keeps interest rates unchanged, opts for caution amid uncertain global outlook

Monetary Policy Committee raises growth outlook, cuts inflation forecast marginally

Akash Mandal & George Mathew
Mumbai, August 5

THE RESERVE Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) Wednesday kept its key policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent, opting for caution as volatile crude oil prices, geopolitical tensions in West Asia and an uncertain global outlook

cloud the inflation trajectory.

While the central bank maintained the neutral policy stance and marginally raised its growth forecast for FY27 to 6.7 per cent from 6.6 per cent, it lowered its inflation projection to 5 per cent from 5.1 per cent, signalling confidence that price pressures will moderate over the course of the year despite near-term risks.



Opposition MPs protest outside Parliament, Wednesday. PTI

2026 would not have any penalising retrospective provision. Civil society and religious

groups have expressed concern that asset-vesting rules in the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Money Bill route pending before SC, Govt chooses it to raise strength of judges

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, August 5

THE RAJYA Sabha Wednesday passed the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to increase the sanctioned strength of Supreme Court judges from 34 to 38 including the Chief Justice of India.

The Bill, which cleared Lok Sabha Monday, was passed as a

money Bill, a route it had also taken in 2019 when the Supreme Court strength was raised to 34. In 2018, a key dissenting opinion in a Supreme Court ruling had described this route as a "fraud on the Constitution."

The Statement of Objects and Reasons of the Bill cites the expenditure involved in creating four additional posts of judges,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special

'Can't leave without justice': Jharkhand protest brings job aspirants together

Protest swells into a wider movement for reforms in recruitment, education



Leader of Opposition in Jharkhand Assembly Babulal Marandi at the protest site in Ranchi, Wednesday. PTI

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, August 5

BRAHMANAND KUMAR Mahato from Ramgarh lies on a thin mat beneath the statue of Olympian, writer and politician Jaipal Singh Munda at Ranchi's iconic Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium.

His white shirt, unchanged for four days, is drenched in sweat and the pouring rain, the streaks of mud on it the only real indication of the passage of time. Around the 30-year-old, fellow protesters sit gently pressing his arms and feet, while doctors hover nearby to monitor his health.

"I had no idea how a hunger

strike was observed. I've never done it before. I just came here, lay down and began my protest," Mahato says, his voice feeble. "I don't know how long this will continue, but if this is what it takes to get justice, I'm prepared to stay here."

Mahato is one of seven people who have been on a hunger strike for the last four days as part of a wider movement for sweeping reforms in Jharkhand's recruitment and education system, long rife with allegations of irregularities.

The controversy began soon after the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC)

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



THE WORLD

PROPOSED DEAL WILL GIVE IRAN CONTROL OVER SHIPS ENTERING HORMUZ

PAGE 14

INSIDE

AIR INDIA PICKS EX-GROUP CHIEF OF ETHIOPIAN AIRLINES AS ITS CEO & MD

PAGE 9

GOLD RINGS, COINS & LAPTOPS: BIG SPENDING IN VIJAY'S DEBUT BUDGET

PAGE 7

PM video removal: Meta apologises, House committee wants to hear it from Zuckerberg

Soumyarendra Barik & Jatin Anand
New Delhi, August 5

SOCIAL MEDIA giant Meta's global affairs head Joel Kaplan Wednesday reiterated the company's apology over the brief takedown of a video posted by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. He conveyed this during a meeting chaired by IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw.

Meta is learnt to have said that the video's removal was an inadvertent error, and it was strengthening its internal checks and balances.

In a statement, Kaplan said, "I apologised to the minister on behalf of Meta for the error restricting PM Modi's post."

A contingent of Meta's policy and regulatory officials, including Kaplan and Neil Potts, vice president of public policy at the company, had two separate meetings with government officials on Wednesday — a meeting with senior bureaucrats from the IT Ministry,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Want to go back in December, our (1971) victory month, says Hasina

Regret India allowed public event: Dhaka

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 5

DECLARING THAT her "life moved beyond calculations of personal safety long ago", former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina, who has been living in India ever since her ouster in August 2024, said

Wednesday that she plans to return to her country, stand with its people and help improve their lives.

Asked when she plans to return, Hasina referred to the 1971 Bangladesh liberation war and said, "December is our victory month, so I want to go back in

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



Cannot stay away while my countrymen are suffering: Ex-PM Sheikh Hasina. REUTERS FILE

Netflix Co-CEO Ted Sarandos is guest at Express Adda today

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

THE WAY we watch stories has changed dramatically over the past decade. Streaming has transformed not only how entertainment reaches audiences, but also how films and series are created, discovered and celebrated across the world. As storytelling continues to evolve, so do the questions: What does the future of enter-



Netflix Co-CEO Ted Sarandos

tainment look like? How will changing audience habits and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



● SHYAMPUKUR IN KOLKATA STILL BEARS POLL POSTERS IN WHICH SAGAR SONKAR HAILS WEST BENGAL CM

Adhikari aide's murder: Father of accused says 'son was like shadow, made scapegoat'

Ravik Bhattacharya & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 5

ACROSS SHYAMPUKUR in Kolkata, there are still posters thanking voters on behalf of Sagar Sonkar, the "Dadar Anugami (the brother's follower)", for the victory of the BJP — the "brother" being Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari, whom the posters hail as "the architect behind change in West Bengal".

However, on the ground, a lot has changed since May, when the Assembly results swept Adhikari to power. Sagar, 29, and his 20-year-old brother Saheb are in CBI custody on charges of orchestrating the murder of Adhikari's personal assistant Chandranath Rath on May 6, two days after the Assembly results.

Their arrests, on July 31, came more than two months after the CBI, which took over

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



A poster by Sagar Sonkar congratulating Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari in Kolkata's Jorabagan. RAVIK BHATTACHARYA

KRACKJACK JOKE #6

WHAT DOES KRACK CALL HIS GIRLFRIEND LOVINGLY?

SCAN TO KNOW MORE

IT'S SWEET. IT'S SALTY.

Follow @wearekrackjack

Like our video

Drop a one-word comment

And stand a chance to win Amazon vouchers*.

*Conditions Apply

ISSUED BY DELHI HEALTH MINISTER

Health Secy gets notice over pending procurement

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

DELHI HEALTH Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh has issued a show-cause notice to Health Secretary Rupesh Kumar Thakur, alleging that repeated failure to comply with directions on pending procurement of medicines, consumables and equipment "not only impeded monitoring of critical procurement activities but has also reflected serious administrative negligence directly affecting public health services".

In the notice, Singh mentioned he had issued directions first on May 26 regarding preparation and submission of a comprehensive action plan with item-wise timelines for completion of all pending procurement processes relating to medicines, consumables and equipment, along with a review of timelines for demand submission by health institutions.

However, there was allegedly no response, following which the matter was reiterated on June 6, directing submission of the requisite action plan and report by June 19.

"...despite the above directions, the requisite information was still not furnished, necessitating issuance of a further communication on July 22. However, concrete reply has not been furnished regarding item-wise timelines for completion of all pending procurement processes relating to medicines, consumables and equipment, etc," the notice stated.

Thakur did not respond to calls and messages seeking a response on the matter.

He has been asked to explain why the directions issued by the minister were not complied with and no action-taken



Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh. FILE

The Health Secretary has been asked to submit a reply along with action-taken report sought earlier and furnish it by Wednesday

report or reply was furnished despite repeated reminders.

Thakur now has to submit his stand on "why disciplinary action under the applicable Conduct Rules shall not be recommended to be initiated for immediate penalty against the officers responsible for such commission and dereliction of duty".

The Health Secretary has also been asked to submit a reply along with action-taken report sought earlier and furnish it latest by Wednesday, mentioning the reasons for non-compliance, and specifying corrective measures taken to ensure that such lapses do not occur in future.

"In case no satisfactory reply is received within the stipulated period, initiation of disciplinary proceedings may be recommended to the disciplinary authority against the officer/officers concerned, under the extant rules," the notice also read.

From Rs 533 crore to Rs 1,268 crore: Cost to expand Lok Nayak hospital doubles,Vigilance dept probe sought

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 5

EVEN AS the Delhi government's Finance department recently recommended before the Council of Ministers a revision in the project cost for an ongoing expansion of the Lok Nayak Jai Prakash Narayan Hospital (LNJP) Hospital with a new multi-specialty block, it has also sought a Vigilance department inquiry into the Health department's project as the overall cost has nearly doubled since the work first started under the previous AAP government, *The Indian Express* has learnt. LNJP hospital is the largest tertiary healthcare centre run by the Delhi government.

The initial approved cost of the project — which involves the construction of a new maternity, medicine and paediatric centre — was Rs 533.91 crore and it was targeted to be completed by 2023. The overall cost for the completion, however, has now been revised to Rs 1,268.85 crore.

The cost escalation

As per the officials privy to the matter, the initial proposal for the expansion — which began in 2021 — was to add 1,570 beds by constructing 22 floors and a double basement for establishing the new multi-specialty block at the hospital. However, the minutes of the meeting held recently by the Finance department's Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC) highlight that a dispute with the contractor led to cost escalation.

"The work was progressing smoothly until a dispute cropped up with respect to the contractual conditions and the amount payable towards the item of structural steel work, which in this building was/is a significant item. The contractor invoked dispute redressal mechanism under Clause 25 of the contract. The dispute was decided by an arbitral tribunal, and the arbitration award was granted in favour of the contractor on 29.05.2023..." read



At LNJP Hospital in New Delhi. FILE

the minutes.

Officials said that the Administrative department submitted that an expenditure of Rs 586.09 crore was incurred with nearly 55% of the project having been completed.

An official explained, "Seeing the likely expenditure for the completion of work exceeding the original A/A (administrative approval) & E/S (expenditure sanction) due to arbitration award, revision in GST rates from 12% to 18%, escalation in the material and labour cost, Covid... the revised preliminary estimate is received amounting to Rs 1,268.85 crore with Rs.682.75 crore set to cover the remaining work."

Last year, PWD minister Parvesh Sahib Singh had said that the government sent a file to the Lieutenant Governor, requesting for a probe in the matter, claiming the project's budget was inflated by Rs 650 crore during AAP leader Satyendar Jain's tenure as the Health Minister.

"There is a difference between the budget sanctioned for the construction of a new block at LNJP Hospital earlier and today. The amount has increased by Rs 650 crore. AAP leader Satyender Jain was both PWD and Health Minister. He would go on inspection and rounds in the hospital and suggest changes in the going project to benefit the contractors, which led to cost escalation.

after following the due procedure," the minutes read.

Contractor under lens

The government also directed the Health department to examine if any FIR had been registered against the previous contractor engaged for the construction of the hospital block.

"In the event that an FIR has been registered... the Administrative department shall examine the feasibility of incorporating appropriate eligibility/restrictive conditions in the forthcoming tender documents so as to ensure that such contractor is not permitted to participate in the fresh bidding process for completion of the balance construction work, subject to the extant legal and contractual provisions," the minutes read.

Officials said that EFC was informed that certain hospital projects are already under probe by the Vigilance department or the Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB).

"Following which, it was asked to obtain the latest status reports of such investigations through the Vigilance department from the ACB and place the same before the competent authority..." an official said.

Estimates revised

The government has also approved the revised cost for completing two other hospital projects at Madipur and Jwalapuri. The original cost of the Madipur hospital project was Rs 320.07 crore and an expenditure of Rs.262.90 crore has already been incurred. Physical progress of the work is 65%. To complete the remaining work, the department would need an additional amount of Rs 203.60 crore, said officials.

Similarly, the Jwalapuri hospital project's original cost was Rs 319.65, of which Rs 260.51 crore has been incurred with a physical progress work 65%. To complete the project, an additional amount Rs.223.53 crore is required, said officials.

IAS officer Manoj Kumar Dwivedi appointed new NDMC chairperson

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

MANOJ KUMAR Dwivedi, a senior Indian Administrative Services (IAS) officer has been announced as the new chairperson of New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) by the Ministry of Health Affairs (MHA) on Wednesday.

Dwivedi is a 1997 batch officer of the Arunachal Pradesh-Goa-Mizoram and Union Territory (AGMUT) cadre.

He succeeds Keshav Chandra, who was transferred last month and appointed as Secretary, Ministry of Mines.

Prior to his current appointment, he was serving as Additional Secretary in the Department of Personnel and Training (DoP&T) under the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions.

He has earlier served in the Ministry of Commerce & Indus-

tries as Joint Secretary.

An Alumnus of IIT Delhi & IIM Bangalore, he was conferred with Lieutenant Governor's (LG) Gold Medal for Integrity, Honesty & Meritorious public service, the highest award given to a civil servant in Jammu & Kashmir.

The official notification, signed by Praveen Kumar Rai, Joint Secretary to the Government of India, stated: "In exercise of the powers conferred by Clause (a) of sub-section (1) of Section (4), read with sub-sections (1) and (2) of Section 13 of the New Delhi Municipal Council Act, 1994 (44 of 1994), the Central Government hereby appoints Shri Manoj Kumar Dwivedi, IAS (AGMUT:1997) to be the Chairperson of the New Delhi Municipal Council with effect from the date of assumption of charge and will remain in the position until further orders."

Lok Sabha official found dead in Noida, suicide note points to Rs 70L loan

Drishti Jain
Noida, August 5

A 40-YEAR-OLD officer posted as a Joint Director in the Lok Sabha allegedly died by suicide in his flat in Noida, police said on Wednesday. According to police officers, the deceased has been identified as Gaurav Gautam. He was found dead at his home in Kendriya Vihar-II in Gautam Buddha Nagar on Sunday, and a suicide note was recovered.

"On August 2, the Noida Phase 2 police received information through a memo from a hospital that a 40-year-old man had been brought for treatment, and doctors declared him dead... they said he died by suicide," police said.

A Field Unit and a forensics team was dispatched to inspect

the scene.

"The body was sent for a post-mortem examination after inquest proceedings. Further legal action is underway," police added.

As per an officer, the suicide note mentions a loan of around Rs 70 lakh. He added that its contents are being examined.

"His wife was not home at the time. When she returned, she called and knocked on the door but he didn't answer. She then called a security guard to help... and found her husband unresponsive," the officer added.

Another officer said that the ID shown by the family shows his designation as 'Joint Director Lok Sabha Parliament of India.' "He was an officer in the Lok Sabha reporting branch," the officer added.

UKP

USHA KAKADE

PRODUCTIONS

presents

EXPRESS

AQDA

co-presented by

Burgundy Private

Private Banking by Axis Bank

TED

SARANDOS

Co-CEO, NETFLIX

in conversation with

Anant Goenka

Executive Director

The Indian Express Group

The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

SCREEN

WPU

GOA

MIT

WORLD PEACE UNIVERSITY

Transdisciplinary. Technological. Transformative.

UNESCO

Chaired Institution

Call for Applications: Full Time

Ph.D.

Programmes

Academic Year 2026–2027 (Fall Semester)

India's First Fully Residential Transdisciplinary University for Holistic Learning & Research

World Peace University (WPU), Goa invites applications from highly motivated, research-oriented candidates for its Full Time Ph.D. Programmes for the Fall Semester, Academic Year 2026–2027.

Selected scholars will receive a monthly fellowship of INR 37,000 for the first two years and INR 42,000 for the subsequent two years. The scholars would also be offered semi-furnished accommodation.

PhD programmes that focus on Transdisciplinary Research and Sustainable Development in:

• Computer Engineering

• Management Studies

• Computer Science

• Design

• Psychology

Eligibility, selection criteria, reservation, and relaxations shall be as per UGC norms.

Applications must be submitted online on or before Tuesday, 25 August 2026. For fee structure & other details please visit wpugoa.edu.in

Scan to Apply

phd.admissions@wpugoa.edu.in

+91 8605007433

Thivim, Bardez, Goa

wpugoa.edu.in

CJP'S JULY 20 MARCH



Protesters during the march last month. FILE

Listen to youth ... forces need to have lot of restraint: SC

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

MAINTAINING THAT the state must listen to the youth and counsel them, the Supreme Court, while hearing a plea seeking accountability for the violence during the CJP's Sansad Chalo march on July 20 over NEET-UG paper leak, cautioned Wednesday that an "aggressive" response from the state could unnecessarily escalate the situation into further violence.

"If some misguided element is indulging in stone pelting etc, still... youngsters are required to be pacified, counselled. They need a lot of advisory consulting. Any aggressive force coming from the other side in the name of the mighty state may also unnecessarily aggravate the situation and precipitate... further violence. That needs to be avoided. Law and order machinery is well conversant with this situation," Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant said, presiding over a three-judge bench.

He said when a protest commences with a peaceful march, and some kind of incident takes place, "forces also need to have a lot of restraint in order to ensure that the situation does not go out of hand".

"Stray incidents here or there, we need to tread very carefully... so that the youngsters don't indulge in violence. The better course is to counsel them, to pacify them. The best powerful source is listening. Listen to them why they are shouting..." the CJI said.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, was hearing a writ petition by former Air Force official Maneesh Kumar Solanki. Appearing for the petitioner, advocate Rizwan Ahmed said it is understandable if the protests were about fixing accountability of the minister or police. "Moot question is, 15 days have passed, where is the accountability of the so-called organisers?"

Apparently referring to the CJP, he added, "Why I am saying so is because it is not a registered organisation."

Ahmed said that the organisers of the march are still fanning the flames through provocative statements moving from channel to channel.

The counsel said the organisers are held responsible even if there is a religious congregation and there is some negligence or if there is a fire in a pandal. He added, "In this case, if the government is on the backfoot, society cannot be on

the backfoot, the law cannot be on the backfoot..."

Ahmed pointed out that there was a law and order problem in Rajasthan on Tuesday. "A young man has died. So, if the government is bending over backwards in a matter of national capital, will the government set up a precedent for Rajasthan? There also, the government will bend backwards to accommodate students... Tomorrow in Lucknow, a degree college student... for some demand... starts stone pelting on buses; will the government in Uttar Pradesh also bend backwards?" he said.

He further said, "In a society, everybody is important. The fraternity of law is important, fraternity of farmers is important... fraternity of people saying reservation should not be there is important."

Ahmed said the petition only sought community service for the wrongdoers and not any punitive measure. "Stone pelters cannot be just allowed to go scot-free without any consideration just because the government was caught on the wrong foot."

"Today the government is there, tomorrow it won't be there... This is a very dangerous precedent," he added.

He said, "Three years back, the farmers were at Shambhu border... People (were) at Shaheen Bagh. Tomorrow, Generation Alpha, Beta, Gama, Delta will come. The people at the Shambhu border, tomorrow they will come to the Parliament with the tractors. Tomorrow, people from Shaheen Bagh will come to the Parliament with tractors..."

Ahmed said the organisers of the July 20 March had flouted several conditions imposed by the police.

"Parliament is the temple of democracy. We have to see the motive and intention. If 500 people would have entered the Parliament... who knows they were not carrying a country-made gun? Who knows they were not carrying some country-made bomb? The Parliament security is not made to handle 500 people. It is a highly sophisticated weapon force; they would have opened fire. What would have happened?" he said.

The court tagged the petition with other pleas on the student protests' issue. "We will hear you again. Let's also see what the view of the central government is. And we are open to hearing everyone..." the CJI said.

CJP's Saurav Das says YouTubers entered and filmed house 'unlawfully'

Pragynesh
New Delhi, August 5

CHIEF SPOKESPERSON of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), Saurav Das, has filed a complaint with the Delhi Police against certain social media handles for allegedly entering and filming his Greater Kailash residence in his absence "unlawfully", officers said. Sources in the Delhi Police, however, said no case has been registered so far.

In his complaint, Das, who is also one of the founders of the CJP, has also mentioned two YouTube channels — the Pamphlet and the Jaipur Dialogues — besides alleging that political commentator Abhijeet Iyer Mitra "drew attention to his residence", and "interfered with his peaceful possession of the premises". He said the videos invaded his privacy and posed a threat to him and his family.

"#SOS: Certain YouTubers

and media channels have broken into my house and are showing the visuals from inside. It's not just an invasion of my privacy but also a grave security threat for me and my family," he posted on X

Das alleged that the YouTubers also spoke to the caretaker and security personnel at his residence and his neighbours to gather information about him. "These miscreants have further illegally and without any authority questioned and interrogated the caretaker and security personnel at the residence, as well as neighbouring residents and passers-by in the locality, regarding the personal life, residence, finances and other private affairs of the Complainant. Such conduct is wholly unauthorised and constitutes a deliberate invasion of the private affairs of the Complainant and his family members," he said in the complaint.

NAREDCO TALKS OF HEAVY FINANCIAL BURDEN, URGES GOVT TO CONSULT STAKEHOLDERS

Reconsider blanket ban on construction during winter, industry body writes to CM

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, August 5

PRIVATE DEVELOPERS have urged the Delhi government to reconsider the curbs it had issued on construction activities during winter to check pollution, saying the blanket restrictions lack scientific backing and could hurt the real estate sector as well as contractors and workers.

The Delhi government's ambitious winter action plan, notified last month, makes measures such as construction curbs, staggered office timings and vehicle restrictions mandatory every year from November 1 to February 28, a departure from the existing system where restrictions are linked to the prevailing pollution levels.

In a letter to Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday seeking a review of the curbs, the Delhi chapter of real estate industry body National Real Estate Development Council (NAREDCO) said the restrictions notified by the government had "caused widespread concern across the infrastructure sector".

As per the plan, demolition and open civil construction activities that generate dust will be

prohibited from November 1 to January 31, with an exemption for essential public infrastructure projects. Finishing work, plumbing and electrical installations inside construction sites will continue to be permitted, subject to dust-control norms. Between December 10 and January 20, only government projects deemed indispensable for public utility or emergencies will be allowed, and vehicles carrying construction material will be barred from entering Delhi.

In the letter, NAREDCO Delhi president Harsh Vardhan Bansal said the construction industry supported "all scientific, practical and effective measures aimed at improving Delhi's air quality".

However, he said prolonged halt on construction work would impose a heavy financial burden on developers, who continue to bear fixed costs such as EMIs on heavy machinery, bank interest, equipment lease rentals, security expenses, wages and statutory compliance costs even when work is suspended. Repeated annual shutdowns during the peak construction season, the letter said, could strain cash flows and push MSMEs,



Demolition and open civil construction activities that generate dust will be prohibited from November 1 to January 31 every year. FILE

contractors, subcontractors and vendors into financial distress.

The NAREDCO questioned the rationale behind a blanket suspension of construction activities, maintaining that no source-wise scientific assessment had been made public to justify such a ban. It argued that Delhi's air pollution is caused by multiple sources, including vehicular emissions, road dust, industrial emissions and stubble burning, and that "focusing disproportionately on one sector" would not ensure equitable regulation.

According to the 2018 TERI

source apportionment study, construction contributes 8.4% of Delhi's PM2.5 emissions and 21% of PM10 emissions.

The letter further said that construction is among India's largest employment generators. "Whenever construction activity is suspended, many migrant workers return to their native places. Experience has shown that a significant number do not return immediately, which could lead to loss of livelihoods," it added.

The Delhi government, as well as other NCR governments

provide compensation to construction workers who are impacted by these curbs. Last year, Delhi government had announced a Rs 10,000 compensation for each worker affected by imposition of Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP).

The industry body asked the government to put out a detailed list of activities which would be permitted and prohibited during winter, and to reconsider the blanket prohibition. It also requested the government to hold stakeholder consultations before implementing measures having significant economic implications.

Queries sent to the Delhi government did not elicit a response.

The government has said the winter action plan is based on air quality trends over the last three winters, during which Delhi consistently recorded 'Very Poor' to 'Severe' air quality index (AQI). The measures, which will automatically come into effect from November 1 to February 28 irrespective of the prevailing AQI, will operate alongside GRAP, whose repeated implementation and withdrawal has drawn criticism from experts in recent years.

• Skywatch



Forecast: August 6, 2026

Generally cloudy sky. Very light to light rain.

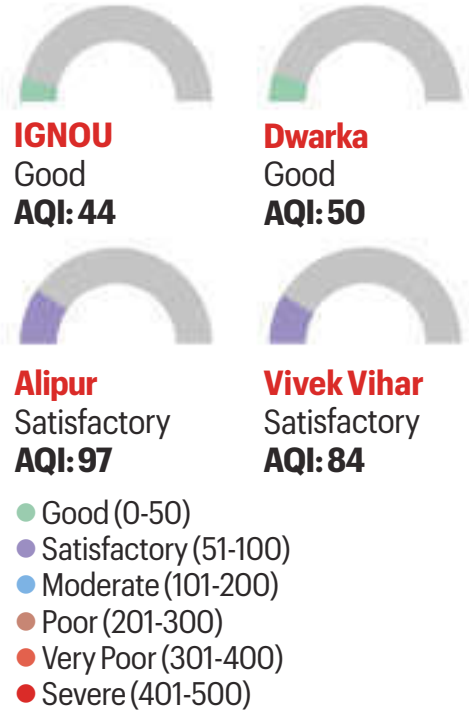
MAX: 31-33

1.2°C below normal

MIN: 22-24

4.9°C below normal

• AQI Tracker



Pad vending machines, washrooms for female cops must in police stations: HC

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, August 5

THE DELHI High Court Wednesday directed the Delhi Police Commissioner to conduct a survey of all police stations in the city and take necessary steps to ensure all of them have sanitary pad vending machines and washrooms exclusively designed for female personnel.

The direction by a bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia followed a PIL by Justice for Rights Foundation, an NGO.

Based on information obtained through RTI from 17 police districts and units, the PIL flagged a "near-total absence" of functional sanitary pad vending machines, waste incinerators and earmarked budgetary allocations for menstrual hygiene at hundreds of police stations.

According to the NGO, women police personnel are forced to discharge duty without access to basic menstrual hygiene and private, clean washrooms that violates their fundamental rights to dignity, health, privacy, and humane working conditions. It also sought the court's directions to the Delhi Police and Union Home Ministry to disburse earmarked budgets and formulate SOPs.

The bench directed the Police Commissioner to submit a report on the availability or non-availability of functional sanitary pad vending machines and washrooms for female officers at the police stations.

The survey has to be completed in six weeks. The court also asked police to file an affidavit on action taken.

The matter will be heard again on September 23.



On war footing

Preparations underway at Red Fort ahead of Independence Day celebrations, in New Delhi on Wednesday. AMIT MEHRA

A murder and a missing weapon: When life imitated a crime web series at East Delhi home

Pragynesh
New Delhi, August 5

FOR WEEKS, *The Staircase*, the HBO crime drama based on one of America's famous murder trials, played out on the television at Kamal Singh's Gagan Vihar home in East Delhi.

The web series revolves around a husband accused of killing his wife while investigators struggle to nail him because the murder weapon is never found.

Days later, police said, the plot played out again at the same house — this time in reality.

On July 30, the 62-year-old software consultant allegedly killed his wife, Komal Singh (50), inside their home, hid the murder weapon and fled with more than Rs 12 lakh in cash.

The murder, police said, came to light when the couple's son, Gaurav Singh (26), a doctor, returned from a library in Noida, where he had spent the day preparing for the postgraduate medical entrance examination.

He had called Komal multiple times. But she never answered.

Using a spare key, Gaurav entered their home around 9.15 pm. He found Komal, a tuition teacher, lying beside the living room sofa in a pool of blood. She had suffered more than 10 stab wounds, said police. While a pair of scissors lay nearby, the object used to hit Komal on the head was missing.

Kamal too was missing.

Only hours earlier, Gaurav had left home after watching

• THE MURDER

1. Police say Kamal bought and hid a sword weeks before the murder.
2. Chose a time when no one was at home
3. Allegedly struck Komal from behind, then stabbed her multiple times with a pair of scissors.
4. Showered, packed his blood-stained clothes and weapon, and left on his scooter.
5. Withdrew cash, changed routes to evade police
6. Arrested four days later

his parents argue over the registration of a property. About an hour later, his twin sister, Gaurika, too, had left for work.

"It had been going on for far too long," Gaurav told *The Indian Express*.

An affair

Police said the marriage started falling apart after Kamal allegedly began a relationship with another woman during a trip to Mumbai last year.

Kamal used to be a freelance SAP (systems, applications and products in data processing) software consultant, and had made considerable money.

The couple lived in a four-storey building the family owned in Gagan Vihar, a posh neighbourhood. "They lived on the second floor of the building with their children. The first was occupied by Kamal's parents, the third by the wife and



Victim Komal Singh



Accused Kamal Singh

which he wanted to be registered in his father's name.

"Komal feared she was being excluded from the family's assets. So, she insisted that the property be registered in her name as well. This led to frequent disputes," said the officer.

By July, Kamal told the police, he had begun planning Komal's murder.

This is where *The Staircase* came in. In the web series, a man named Michael Peterson killed his wife Kathleen with a fireplace blow-poke. The blow-poke was never found.

Police said Kamal bought a sword and hid it.

The killing

As both the children and the domestic help left after finishing her work on the day, Kamal went to find Komal at around 12.45 pm, said police.

"As Komal was hanging clothes on the balcony, Kamal hit her on the head from behind with the sword. But as he had used the blunt side of the sword, Komal didn't collapse. Instead, she started screaming and ran for her life," said the officer.

While her scream could be heard through the building, no one intervened, police said.

In the meantime, Komal hid herself in the kitchen. Police said Kamal caught her, dragged her by the hair into the living room and stabbed her with scissors multiple times.

By then, it was 12.55 pm. Kamal had taken 10 minutes to commit the murder, said police.

Police said Kamal then

Property dispute

The final flashback, police said, was a property Kamal wanted to buy in Jagatpuri,

Monsoon Session from tomorrow, Assembly may scrap B&B policy

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

OVER A month after a fire at a Bed & Breakfast (B&B) facility in Hauz Rani killed 23 people, a Bill to repeal the government's B&B policy is on the agenda in the Delhi Legislative Assembly's upcoming Monsoon Session, Speaker Vijender Gupta said on Wednesday. The sixth session of the Eighth Legislative Assembly is stated to be held from August 7 to 11.

Apart from this, two Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) reports and a notification concerning the electricity regulator will also be laid on the table. Three Bills relating to the time-bound delivery of public services, the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board and B&B establishments will also be introduced, the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) has decided, officials said.

The Bill proposing the repeal of The National Capital Territory of Delhi (Incredible India) Bed and Breakfast Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2007, along with its amendment Acts of 2010 and 2021 will be introduced.

The Delhi (Right of Citizen to Time Bound Delivery of Services) Bill, 2026, which provides for the repeal of the earlier Delhi (Right of Citizens to Time Bound Services) Act, 2011 will also be introduced.

The third Bill on the agenda proposes an amendment to the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board Act, 2010.

EXPRESSspecial

We have voters to answer to, say 3 rebel TMC MPs who won't join NDA meetings

Ravik Bhattacharya & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 5

IT IS a tightrope walk for three rebel Trinamool Congress (TMC) Lok Sabha MPs who despite being part of the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) have decided against joining or supporting the ruling BJP or NDA. Their stance seems to be posing a challenge to the BJP dispensation both in Delhi and West Bengal.

The three rebel TMC MPs — Murshidabad MP Abu Taher Khan, Jangipur MP Khalilur Rahaman, and Baharampur MP Yusuf Pathan, all from Muslim-dominated Lok Sabha seats in Murshidabad district — announced their decision on Tuesday when they skipped an NDA parliamentary party meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Delhi for the second time. However, these MPs still attended a coordination meeting in Delhi held by Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari to discuss developmental work in their constituencies.

Khan, Rahaman and Pathan were part of a larger rebel group of 20 Lok Sabha MPs who broke away from Mamata Banerjee's TMC following the party's defeat in the Bengal Assembly elections. They later merged with the little-known outfit NCPI. Khan is a veteran politician who started his political career with the Congress and joined the TMC in 2019. From 2001 to 2019, he was the Nowda MLA and first became a Lok Sabha MP in 2019 from the Murshidabad seat, which he retained in 2024.

Rahaman is also a two-time



(From left) TMC MPs Abu Taher Khan, Khalilur Rahaman and Yusuf Pathan — all from Muslim-dominated Lok Sabha seats in Murshidabad district — announced their decision on Tuesday

Lok Sabha MP, from the Jangipur constituency, apart from being a prominent industrialist in the district.

Pathan is a former cricketer who joined the TMC ahead of the 2024 Lok Sabha polls and defeated veteran Congress leader Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury in Baharampur.

Khan told *The Indian Express*, “We will not join or support the NDA or BJP. But we will be a part of the NCPI. We have voters to answer to. We will not vote on any Bill that goes against Muslims. However, on the question of development, we held a meeting with the Bengal CM.”

Speaking to reporters outside Parliament, Pathan said, “We were part of the meeting with the CM. I highlighted the plight of people whose names have been deleted from voter lists in Bengal. There are over 27 lakh. I also urged the CM to see whether tribunals can be set up to speed up the process. He said he will do whatever he can.”

Sources close to the three MPs said all three are concerned about “voter backlash” in their Bengal constituencies if they come out in support of the NDA

or BJP in Parliament, while also fearing “pressure” from the BJP-led Bengal government if they leave the rebel TMC group.

Sources also said these MPs were keen to recontest their respective seats under the NCPI banner in the 2029 Lok Sabha elections, for which they would need to maintain support among the Muslim voters there.

“After leaving TMC and joining the rebel group, there was public backlash in their respective constituencies. Now, if they support NDA, which is led by the BJP, or are seen attending meetings with Narendra Modi, they will lose their public support base completely in the district,” claimed a senior Congress leader from Murshidabad, adding that they were also keen to prevent any possible action against them by the Bengal government.

Sources said they will remain in the NCPI but act “factually” in Parliament, and even vote for the crucial delimitation Bill if it is introduced in the Lok Sabha.

However, TMC MP Saugata Roy told *The Indian Express* that these three MPs “failed to take the final step”, adding that they made the decision after

“consulting with (Kalighat) TMC” led by Mamata Banerjee.

Reacting to their decision not to support the NDA, Bengal BJP president Samik Bhattacharya said, “Why those NCPI MPs are not supporting NDA, only their party leadership can say. However, the people will not accept such double standards.”

Meanwhile, CPI(M) Central Committee member Sujan Chakraborty said, “This is basically nothing but a fascist tool to make a shadow Opposition. Suwendu Adhikari gave assurances, are playing a double-standard game so they will remain with the BJP and get support at the ground level, but Bengal’s people are not fools.”

Congress spokesperson Soumya Aich Roy alleged, “The TMC always was a mass organisation of the RSS. Taking such a stance, these three MPs supported the BJP indirectly and fooled the minority community. They are thinking they will continue that strategy by giving support to the NDA government.”

BOMBAY HC TERMS VIDEOS, DIGITAL CONTENT ‘ABUSIVE, VILE’

Meta and Google to take down Gadkari deepfakes on E20 row

Omkar Gokhale
Mumbai, August 5

THE BOMBAY High Court on Wednesday granted interim relief to Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari in his suit against allegedly defamatory AI-generated deepfake videos and manipulated digital content linked to the ethanol-blended fuel controversy.

The High Court observed that the content in question was “abusive, vulgar and vile fueling venom” and the platforms, including Meta and Google LLC, assured the court that they would take down the offending material flagged by Gadkari in his interim application. It also said that any material recirculating the content in question should be taken down and that, in the event that further similar abusive deepfake content and material is circulated against Gadkari, it shall be communicated to the defendant platforms, which shall act on it.

“I can only say that the same is absolutely vile, abusive and defamatory and such material should not have a place on a public platform which is accessed by all sections of society including young people. Therefore, I am satisfied that the applicant (Gadkari) has made out a case for the grant of ad-interim relief”, Justice Arif S Doctors said.

The Court was hearing an interim application by Gadkari seeking immediate relief in his suit against Meta platforms, X



Union Minister Nitin Gadkari and BJP MP Ravi Kishan during a meeting on Wednesday. PTI

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 Corp, Google LLC, among others, including John Doe (all unknown persons), seeking the removal of the ‘defamatory’ content. The application referred to 26 links featuring face-swap videos, AI-generated images and cartoons that allegedly use his name, face, voice and mannerisms without his consent and sought damages of Rs 11 crore from the defendants.

Gadkari had stated that the purpose of his civil suit against Meta platforms was not to prevent public discussion or criticism of his actions or government policies.

Advocate Sandeep S Ladda, representing Gadkari, sought urgent relief pending hearing of the suit in respect of the content appearing on the respective Meta platforms, and Google LLC and also referred to an Instagram reel giving no specific and clear user

Technology (IT) Rules and they should ensure due diligence.

“This is absolutely abusive. Do you have a policy to pull this down? With all this technology at your disposal, don’t you earmark posts that have patently vile, abusive language, that are accessed by everybody and trigger?” Justice Doctor orally questioned the defendant’s platforms.

The lawyers representing Meta Platforms and Google LLC stated they would take down the material in question, which the court accepted.

The Court also directed the defendant platforms to furnish the information of the subscribers who have posted the offending material.

Additional Solicitor General (ASG) Anil Singh, representing the Union Ministries of Electronics and Information Technology and Telecommunications, also said that such content cannot be tolerated and that the departments will extend cooperation in the matter.

The Court sought affidavits in reply by the defendant platforms to the plea within three weeks and posted the next hearing after four weeks.

EXPRESS Careers



Gautam Buddha University
Greater Noida
(Established by the Uttar Pradesh Gautam Buddha University Act, 2002 U.P. Act No.09 of 2002, passed by the Uttar Pradesh Legislature)

Advertisement No: GBU/Admn/2026/07 Dated: 06 August 2026

RECRUITMENT OF PROFESSOR ON DEPUTATION BASIS

Gautam Buddha University (GBU) invites applications for the post of Professor (On Deputation Basis) in the Department of Electronics and Communication Engineering, School of Information and Communication Technology

Eligible and willing candidates may send their applications alongwith their Bio Data through Speed Post/Registered Post/Courier to “The Registrar, Gautam Buddha University, Greater Noida GautamBudh Nagar-201312 U.P. (India). On or before 31 August upto 5.30 p.m.

Registrar

PUBLIC NOTICE

This Notice is given for the information of the general public at large that Our Client is desirous to acquire entire shareholding of Big Tree Hotels Pvt. Ltd. having its Registered Office at 4/1, Single Storey Ramesh Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110015 (Company) along with all assets including but not limited to Scheduled Property owned by the Company without any liability from its shareholders, Mr. Vinod Nagrath, Mrs. Neelam Nagrath, Mr. Piyush Nagrath and Mr. Satpaul Nagrath, all residents of FA-307A, Mansarovar Garden, Ramesh Nagar, Delhi-110015.

If any person(s), entity(s), Company(ies), Bank(s), Financial Institution(s), vendor, contractor etc. has any right, title, interest, demand, claim, objection, lien, charge, encumbrance etc. in the nature of mortgage or any other claim of whatsoever nature over the Company and/or the Scheduled Property or the part thereof the same may be notified to the undersigned in writing within 30 days from the publication of this Notice, failing which it shall be presumed there is no third party claim of whatsoever nature on the Company and/or the Scheduled Property desired to be acquired by Our Client and Our Client will be free to proceed with the acquisition of the same.

SCHEDULED PROPERTY

Land measuring 00-30-16 Hectares comprising in Khasra Nos. 881 (00-01-69), and 916/882 (00-28-47) in revenue village Deorighat, Mohal Kiari, Tehsil Theog Distt. Shimla, Himachal Pradesh with requisite approvals, permissions, no objection certificates, etc. owned by the Company.

Malini Sud/Vidhi Goel
Advocates
Place: Delhi C-451, LGF, Defence Colony
Date: 06/08/2026 New Delhi-110024, PH: 011-40519011

PUBLIC NOTICE

This Notice is given for the information of the general public at large that Our Client is desirous to acquire entire shareholding of RTM Hotels Pvt. Ltd. having its Registered Office at 4/1, Single Storey Ramesh Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110015 (Company) along with all assets including but not limited to Scheduled Property owned by the Company without any liability from its shareholders, Mr. Vinod Nagrath, Mrs. Neelam Nagrath, Mr. Piyush Nagrath and Mr. Satpaul Nagrath, all residents of FA-307A, Mansarovar Garden, Ramesh Nagar, Delhi-110015.

If any person(s), entity(s), Company(ies), Bank(s), Financial Institution(s), vendor, contractor etc. has any right, title, interest, demand, claim, objection, lien, charge, encumbrance etc. in the nature of mortgage or any other claim of whatsoever nature over the Company and/or the Scheduled Property or the part thereof the same may be notified to the undersigned in writing within 30 days from the publication of this Notice, failing which it shall be presumed there is no third party claim of whatsoever nature on the Company and/or the Scheduled Property desired to be acquired by Our Client and Our Client will be free to proceed with the acquisition of the same.

SCHEDULED PROPERTY

Land measuring 01-02-58 Hec. with requisite approvals, permissions, no objection certificates, superstructure etc. owned by the Company as follows:

- Land measuring 00-80-12 Hectares comprising in Khasra Nos. 898 (00-01-00), 899 (00-22-44), 900 (00-03-23), 901 (00-06-52), 902 (00-20-32), 903 (00-21-25) and 904 (00-05-36) in revenue village Deorighat, Mohal Kiari, Tehsil Theog Distt. Shimla, Himachal Pradesh.
- Land measuring 00-22-46 Hectares comprising in Khasra Nos. 858 (00-00-24), 861 (00-20-82) and 862 (00-01-40), in revenue village Majhar, Mohal Dharech Gawach, Tehsil Theog Distt. Shimla, Himachal Pradesh.

Malini Sud/Vidhi Goel
Advocates
Place: Delhi C-451, LGF, Defence Colony
Date: 06/08/2026 New Delhi-110024, PH: 011-40519011



TMC leader Abhishek Banerjee

HC dismisses Abhishek's plea to travel abroad for eye treatment

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 5

THE CALCUTTA High Court on Wednesday dismissed TMC leader Abhishek Banerjee's plea to travel abroad for eye treatment, citing the ongoing proceedings in the criminal cases against him.

The observation came a week after the single-judge bench of Justice Saugata Bhattacharya had asked Banerjee to seek opinion from the medical board at SSKM Hospital on whether the overseas travel was unavoidable. However, as the TMC leader submitted that he was not ready to do so, the court dismissed his plea to go abroad. The matter was taken up after the Supreme Court directed the High Court to dispose of Banerjee's application within a week.

Appearing for Banerjee, Senior Advocate Rebecca John argued that the criminal cases against him carried a maximum punishment of three years, with most being bailable offences. She also cited previous instances where Banerjee was allowed to travel abroad for treatment in cases initiated by the ED.

“He went as many as 12 times between 2023 and 2025... Every time he has gone abroad, he has returned to the country on schedule. There is no fear that he will abscond. His wife and two children are in Kolkata. They will remain here... allowing him to go abroad will not cause any harm or inconvenience to the investigation or to the other party in the case. He has always cooperated with the investigation and has participated in the investigative process,” his counsel submitted.

The HC bench, in response, said there are other cases pending against the TMC national general secretary and his travel would affect the proceedings. Justice Bhattacharya said that he was not satisfied with the credibility of the medical documents related to the treatment. “...this Court finds the issue agitated in the application ought not to be kept pending further. Hence, the application is dismissed,” the court observed.

कार्यालय: राँची नगर निगम, राँची
(अभियंत्रण शाखा), कचहरी रोड, राँची, पिन – 834001
E-mail :- support@ranchimunicipal.com

पत्रांक: 311

इच्छा की अभिव्यक्ति

दिनांक: 04 / 08 / 2026

MRF (Material Recovery Facility) से कचरा के पुनर्चक्रण के क्रम में प्राप्त Recyclable item यथा :- Kartoon (Cardboard), Katroon Mix (cardboard), Plastic (Per Bottle), Mix Plastic , TIN , Ferrous Metal (IRON) , NON Ferrous , Lite IRON , Glass Bottle Recyclable items, Hard Plastic , Chitta, Newspaper, Aluminum Can, Broken Glass, File, Aluminum Section, Brass, Copper, Battery Mc, Dry Battery, Big Water Battery, Books, Copy, Rubber Scrap इत्यादि के विक्रय हेतु अधिकृत क्रेताओं से दर आमंत्रित करती है। इच्छुक क्रेता दिनांक: 11 / 08 / 2026 अपराह्न 04:00 बजे तक अभियंत्रण शाखा में मुहुरबंद लिफाफा में दर समर्पित कर सकते हैं।
प्राप्त कोटेशन को दिनांक: 12 / 08 / 2026 अपराह्न 05:00 बजे खोली जाएगी। संबंधित क्रेता / प्राधिकृत प्रतिनिधि उपस्थित रह सकते हैं।

नियम एवं शर्तें :-

- Recyclable item यथा Kartoon (Cardboard), Katroon Mix (cardboard), Plastic (Per Bottle), Mix Plastic , TIN , Ferrous Metal (IRON) , NON Ferrous , Lite IRON , Glass Bottle Recyclable items, Hard Plastic , Chitta, Newspaper, Aluminum Can, Broken Glass, File, Aluminum Section, Brass, Copper, Battery Mc, Dry Battery, Big Water Battery, Books, Copy, Rubber Scrap का दर items wise Per Kg/ Per Pcs उल्लेखित करते हुए कुल दर समर्पित करना होगा।
- GST REGISTRATION एवं PAN CARD की प्रति समर्पित करना होगा।
- संबंधित इच्छुक क्रेता सरकारी अथवा किसी एजेंसी या संस्था से BLACK List नहीं होना चाहिए, इससे संबंधित AFFIDAVIT समर्पित करना होगा।
- Recyclable Item के नियमित उठाव के संबंध में रव-सोष्णा पत्र समर्पित करना होगा।
- राँची नगर निगम बिना बताये किसी भी समय इसे रद्द कर सकती है।
- इस आमंत्रण सूचना के संबंध में अंतिम निर्णय नगर आयुक्त, राँची नगर निगम का होगा।
- SWM Rules 2016 & SWM Rules 2026 का अनुपालन एवं समय समय पर सरकार के द्वारा इस संबंध में निर्गत होने वाले दिशा-निर्देश / आदेश का अनुपालन करना अनिवार्य होगा।

ह० / -

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
राँची नगर निगम, राँची

PR 386731 Ranchi Municipal Corporation(26-28)#D



Jodhpur Development Authority
Jodhpur

E-Auction Programme of Commercial Lands in Jodhpur (September 2026)

क्रमांक :- एक46/नीलामी/2026/जुलाई/23729048 दिनांक:- 30.07.2026

भूखण्डों की भव्य ई-नीलामी

दिनांक 01.09.2026 से 17.09.2026 तक

07 व्यावसायिक भूमि खण्ड

खसरा खंख्या 827 /650 खसरा खंख्या 66

ग्राम चौखा में कुल रिक्त भूमि ग्राम घड़ाव में कुल रिक्त भूमि

(1340.22 वर्ग मीटर से (1276.63 वर्ग मीटर से

2831.55 वर्ग मीटर) 2575.31 वर्ग मीटर)

03 04

ईएमडी जमा दिनांक ऑनलाईन बिड

01 सितम्बर 2026 से प्रारम्भ प्रारम्भ तिथि: अंतिम तिथि:

01 सितम्बर, 2026 17 सितम्बर, 2026

प्रभारी अधिकारी (नीलामी शाखा) जोधपुर विकास प्राधिकरण जोधपुर

अधिकृत जानकारी के लिए QR Code स्कैन करें

निवेशक वित्त जोधपुर विकास प्राधिकरण जोधपुर

फोन:- 0291-2656355, 2656356

- नीलामी के समस्त भूमि खण्डों की विस्तृत जानकारी एवं नीलामी की शर्तें जोधपुर विकास प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट : joda.rajasthan.gov.in पर देखें या कार्यालय में सम्पर्क करें।
- नीलामी की प्रक्रिया SSOID के जरिये Urban Services के माध्यम से की जाएगी।

PUBLIC NOTICE
GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA
EXCISE & TAXATION DEPARTMENT

NOTICE FOR INVITING e-TENDERS FROM GENERAL PUBLIC FOR RE-ALLOTMENT OF TWO ZONES OF RETAIL LIQUOR VENDS OF DISTRICT GURUGRAM (EAST) AND GURUGRAM (WEST) IN THE STATE OF HARYANA FOR THE REMAINING PERIOD OF THE EXCISE POLICY YEAR 2025-2027.

- It is hereby notified for the information of the general public that e-tenders are invited for the re-allotment of Zone No. ZGRE13 and Zone No. ZGRW04 comprising of retail liquor vendes of Country Liquor (CL) and Indian Made Foreign Liquor (IMFL) (L-2/L-14A) in District Gurugram (East) and District Gurugram (West), respectively, in the State of Haryana, for the remaining period of the Excise Policy Year 2025-2027.
- The schedule for submission of e-bids for the above said zones and evaluation thereof shall be as under:-

Starting date and time for placing e-tenders	From 6th August, 2026 (9.00 A.M)
Closing date and time for placing e-tenders	Till 6th August, 2026 (04.00 P.M)
Evaluation of e-tenders	6th August, 2026 (5.00 PM)
- The reserve price of these zones for the purpose of e-tendering has been decided as per the provisions of clause 2.17 and other relevant provisions of the Haryana Excise Policy 2025-27.

The reserve price and quota of these zones shall be displayed in the excise arrangement.
- The e-tenders for these zones can be submitted online through the official website of the department i.e. www.haryanatax.gov.in. The remaining terms and conditions of e-tenders and allotment of zones shall be same, as informed vide the Public Notice, published in leading newspapers on 21st May, 2025, for inviting e-tenders for allotment of retail liquor zones of all districts in the State of Haryana. The copy of Public Notice dated 21st May, 2025 is also available on the official website of department i.e. www.haryanatax.gov.in. The detailed procedure of registration for participation in the allotment process and submission of e-tenders is also available on the official website.
- The excise arrangements of these zones containing number of vendes, liquor quota, location of vendes, command area as applicable and reserve price thereof, as well as the venue for evaluation of e-tenders shall be conspicuously displayed in the office of DETCs (Excise) and DETCs (ST) of the district concerned. These details shall also be available on the official website i.e. www.haryanatax.gov.in.
- The allotment and grant of licence shall be subject to the provisions of the Haryana Excise Act, 1914, the rules framed thereunder, orders/instructions issued by the competent authority and the Excise Policy for the year 2025-27. Any clarification regarding the procedure may be obtained from the office of DETCs (Excise) in any of the districts. The copy of Haryana Excise Policy for the year 2025-27 is available on official website of the department.
- The allotment shall be subject to the approval of the Excise and Taxation Commissioner (FC), Haryana. He may reject, without assigning any reason, any allotment in public interest as the case may be, within 10 days of the date of allotment.

VINAY PRATAP SINGH, IAS
Excise and Taxation Commissioner,
Haryana, Panchkula.

No. 47891/HR/

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi



Damini Nath & Divya A
New Delhi, August 5

THE RAJYA Sabha on Wednesday approved the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026, which replaces an ordinance promulgated in May to increase the strength of the apex court judges from 34 to 38, including the Chief Justice of India.

The Money Bill was passed by the Lok Sabha Monday, and the Upper House cleared it with a voice vote and returned it to the Lower House after a nearly two-hour discussion Wednesday.

Law and Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal introduced the Bill when the House reconvened at 2 pm. Starting the discussion, Congress MP and Senior Advocate Vivek Tankha asked why the government had chosen the ordinance route just four days before the Supreme Court was to start its summer vacation. He questioned the government's "hurry" to bring the ordinance, when Parliament was due to meet in July anyway.

As Tankha began raising the issue of the Supreme Court judgment on the abrogation of Article 370, Deputy Chairman Harivarsh reminded him to stick to the Bill. Harivarsh then called on the next speaker, leading to protests by Opposition MPs, stressing that Tankha be allowed to speak. The Congress MPs then walked out in protest. Later, other Opposition MPs too staged a walkout. Several Opposition MPs raised the issue of lack of

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>



Law and Justice Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal, who introduced the Bill, speaks in Rajya Sabha on Wednesday. PTI

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mljMzg1

showed that out of the 593 judges appointed to the Supreme Court and High Courts from January 1, 2021, to January 30 this year, 26 were from SCs, 14 were from STs, 80 from OBCs and 37 from minorities. In total, 96 women were appointed to High Courts.

Several MPs also raised the demand for increasing judges' strength in the district courts. National Conference MP Chowdhry Mohammad Ramzan said it would have been better had the government brought a Bill to increase the strength of judges in the lower courts, where crores of cases are pending.

AAP's Sanjay Singh questioned the government over the lack of representation of vulnerable groups in the judiciary. Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said the Centre notifies the appointments, but the recommendations come from the Supreme Court Collegium.

Earlier this year, in reply to a question by Wilson, the Law Ministry provided data that

PM to NDA MPs at breakfast meeting: 'Be careful & dignified while using technology'

Liz Mathew

New Delhi, August 5

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Wednesday hosted NDA's 36 first-term Rajya Sabha MPs for a breakfast meeting, where he told them that technology can be productive as well as counterproductive, so be careful and dignified while using it.

The meeting was attended by MPs of the BJP as well as those who joined the NDA from other parties, including the AAP and the TMC. He also advised the MPs not to get caught in Delhi's web of narratives and maintain a warm relationship with the Opposition members.

Stressing the importance of active participation in the House proceedings, Modi urged the MPs to make use of their time to "learn" and "work for the country's bright future".

"He told us that Parliament is like a university — that no other university can give us such an experience or teach us things that we can learn here," said an MP who was present in the meeting. "Every MP will be able to experience the realities in this country; while some MPs ask for a second airport, others ask for the first railway line."

He encouraged the MPs to spend time in Parliament to know about the entire ecosystem. "The PM mentioned that each MP should know about the structure of Parliament, statutes and spend at



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Raghav Chadha, Swati Maliwal and other newly elected BJP Rajya Sabha MPs, in New Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

least two hours daily in the library," said the MP.

The PM asked the MPs to engage with the youth and spend the local area development funds with a focus on the young population and promote sports activities in their constituencies. "The PM told us that Parliament is not just the chambers, but it's a whole lot more. We need to explore and discover the ecosystem in a few months," said an MP, who recently joined the NDA.

Modi is learnt to have cautioned the MPs against "getting trapped" in some narratives.

"Delhi ki makadjaal mein mat fassna... the PM told us," said another MP.

Reminding the members that they were the "chosen ones" from among hundreds who wanted to be in Parliament, the PM urged the MPs to be conscious of their responsibilities.

"He advised us not to carry the anxieties and angst over the Opposition behaviour inside the House or outside it. And that we should always speak with dignity, no need to be aggressive before the television cameras," the MP, who was quoted above, said. He also

urged them to learn to "live in the present without worrying too much about the future," the MP added.

In the backdrop of criticism of the ruling party's "aggressive" rebuttals to the Gen Z protests and those who were part of them, the PM said the members should be careful while utilising technology in communication and use "dignified language". He has been hosting breakfast meetings during Parliament sessions for several years, providing the MPs an opportunity to interact with him directly.

Hold mass outreach camps for doorstep delivery of tribal welfare schemes: Govt

Nikhil Ghanekar & Harikishan Sharma

New Delhi, August 5

IN A bid to ensure the doorstep delivery of the Centre's tribal welfare schemes, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs (MoTA) has urged all states to conduct public outreach camps in the run-up to Independence Day (August 15).

The MoTA Secretary, it is learnt, has written to all chief secretaries of states directing them to organise 'Jan Sunwai' (public grievance and entitlement camp) at Adi Sewa Kendras between August 13 and 15.

The mass outreach has been proposed through the Adi Karmayogi Abhiyan, which was formally launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in September last year to

build up a volunteer-led grassroots tribal leadership of about 2 million people across 1 lakh villages.

As part of the initiative, tribal-dominated villages were encouraged to establish an Adi Sewa Kendra, where local issues could be addressed and resolved, and development roadmaps charted. It is at these Kendras the public outreach camps are slated to be held.

According to government data, 38,509 Kendras have already been established in the country. A further 41,454 remain at the proposal stage.

The Centre has asked district collectors to lead the public outreach, and sought inclusion of the tribal development agency, the local administration, and frontline officers from key departments such as

health, education, rural affairs, forest, among others.

These gatherings have also been utilised by the Centre to widen coverage of two other flagship programmes concerning the welfare of tribal communities, namely the Dharti Aaba Janatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan (DAJGUA) and the Janati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan (PM-JANMAN).

The PM-JANMAN vision is aimed to improve the socioeconomic status of particularly vulnerable tribal groups by bridging gaps in health, education, livelihoods, whereas DAJGUA aims for the holistic development of tribal villages.

The upcoming Jan Sunwai outreach initiative will not be the first. Two such events were held earlier — in November 2025 and May 2026.

After facing backlash, MP Speaker withdraws his 'gulati khata hai' comments on Kushwahas

Anand Mohan J

Bhopal, August 5

MADHYA PRADESH Speaker and veteran BJP leader Narendra Singh Tomar has become the first leader from the party to publicly apologise to the Kushwaha community in the aftermath of the Datia bypoll loss, after an introspection revealed that his remarks during the campaign trail may have hurt the ruling party's chances as the crucial community swung towards the Congress party.

Tomar issued a public apology to the Kushwaha community, withdrawing remarks made during the by-poll campaign that described the community as one that "gulati khata hai" (does somersaults, an expression suggesting it frequently shifts political loyalties). "BJP



Madhya Pradesh Speaker & BJP leader Narendra Singh Tomar

has always been tolerant and dedicated towards the Kushwaha community. But from time to time, the Kushwaha community has indulged in gulati khana, affecting its own credibility," Tomar had said.

The statement triggered a backlash, with community leaders accusing one of the BJP's tallest leaders in the Gwalior-Chambal region of questioning

LS clears Bankers' Books Evidence Bill with voice vote amid Opposition din

Vikas Pathak & Asad Rehman

New Delhi, August 5

THE LOK Sabha was adjourned as it convened at 2 pm for the second half on Wednesday, soon after the Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026, was passed by voice vote without debate amid Opposition din.

Earlier, when the Lok Sabha convened at 11 am, the House was adjourned within minutes, as Opposition members started raising slogans and disrupted the Question Hour. Speaker Om Birla asked the protesting members to allow the Question Hour to function. A visibly upset Birla said raising slogans inside and outside the House was not good for democracy. He then adjourned the House until 2 pm.

At 2 pm, Jagdambika Pal, who was in the Chair, requested Opposition members to return to their seats so that the Zero Hour could start. He underlined that the Zero Hour and Question Hour were important for Parliamentary functioning. However, the ruckus continued.

Pal then asked Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman to take up the Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026, for consideration and passing. The Bill was passed by a voice vote.

The Bill repeals and replaces the Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891, providing for certified copies of bank records



Jagdambika Pal presides over the Lok Sabha, Wednesday. PTI

to be used as evidence in legal proceedings without requiring production of the original records. It lays down that an authentic digital record of a banker's book will be legally enforceable as evidence, thus bringing legal requirements in sync with the realities of the banking system, explains PRS Legislative Research in its analysis of the Bill.

Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs Kiren Rijiju said Congress leader K C Venugopal was a "good man" but of no use if he cannot convince his fellow members to allow the House to function. "People can see that it is the target of the Opposition to not let Parliament function," he said, adding that the government gave all the time for debate in the Business Advisory Committee, but Bills were being passed without debate as the Opposition was not participating.

Pal requested Opposition members to vacate the well of the House, but slogans continued. Pal then adjourned the House for the day.

Shah is responsible for violence against student protesters: Rahul

Express News Service

New Delhi, August 5

CONTINUING THE offensive against Home Minister Amit Shah, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday alleged that the minister was responsible for the violence against protesting students and doesn't have the courage to explain in Parliament what had happened.

Rahul was addressing mediapersons along with a group of students who had protested last month seeking then Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation over the paper leak issue.

"I just met young protesters from various states and had a discussion. I want to thank them and am proud of thousands of students like them as they fought for the Constitution, the education system and the future of India," Rahul said.

"They mentioned to me how they were assaulted and threatened. They have defended the Constitution, protected the idea of India and the future of India," said Rahul.

He also said that complaining about the country's education system, which is flawed, collapsing and useless, is not a crime. "If anything, the system needs to be changed, it needs to be corrected, and that is all they (the students) were asking for. They were not indulging in violence; they were not being ag-



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi with student protesters during a press conference in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANIL SHARMA

gressive or nasty. They were beaten up, assaulted and threatened," said Rahul.

"Sending 'goondas' and forcibly taking their apology, taking an apology from a 15-year-old and accepting that apology, is nonsense and unacceptable to us," he said.

According to Rahul, there should be an education system that works, and that examination leaks should stop.

Attacking Shah, Rahul alleged that the person who is responsible for this violence is the Home Minister. "The person who had a pellet gun fired at this young lady, the person who had a pellet gun fired at that young man whom I brought before the press a few days ago, the person who has turned the

police force against this young lady, is Amit Shah and he is the Home Minister of India."

Meanwhile, reacting to Rahul's allegations, BJP MP Sambit Patra said it was "inappropriate to build a false political narrative through children".

Accusing Rahul of being selective in raising issues, Patra flagged the plight of students due to the "examination irregularities in Jharkhand".

"The country's children should remain fearless and should not hesitate from participating in movements or protests whenever necessary. The children are protesting in Jharkhand... Rahul Gandhi should also engage with them and mitigate their pain and suffering," Patra said.

the caste's political credibility.

On Wednesday, the Assembly Speaker, addressing the community in a signed letter, wrote, "In the past few days, I had gone to the residence of BJP president Kamlesh Kushwaha for a family function. During that conversation, I said that the Kushwaha community and we are complementary to each other... Throughout my life, I have respected the Kushwaha community and will continue to do so. I cannot even imagine insulting it. If any of my words have hurt any member of the community, I withdraw those words and express regret for the pain caused."

The apology came as the BJP's internal assessment increasingly points towards the erosion of support among Kushwahas, who account for an estimated 12% of Datia's

electorate and are regarded as one of the seat's most influential OBC voting blocs. With Congress candidate Kunwar Ghanshyam Singh winning by 6,016 votes, even a modest swing among the community could have proved decisive.

Congress leaders insist they recognised that opportunity early. While the BJP was battling resentment after denying a ticket to former Home Minister Narottam Mishra, the Congress quietly built a parallel social coalition around OBC communities, particularly the Kushwahas. Satna MLA Siddharth Kushwaha, credited with the decisive victory for the Congress, remained camped in Datia for weeks, coordinating booth-level mobilisation and local outreach among Kushwaha leaders.

Home Secretary, Cabinet Secy get 1-year extension

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

THE TENURES of Cabinet Secretary T V Somanathan and Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan have been extended for one more year by the Appointment Committee of the Cabinet on Wednesday.

Somanathan took over as Cabinet Secretary in 2024 following the superannuation of Rajiv Gauba, who had been in the post since 2019. Then, the allotted tenure was for two years. Following the revision, he will stay on for a further period of one year. A 1987-batch IAS officer of the Tamil Nadu cadre, Somanathan is a qualified chartered accountant, cost accountant and company secretary. He has held important assignments at the Centre, including as Joint Secretary and later, as Additional Secretary in the Prime Minister's Office.

Somanathan also served as a Joint Secretary in the Ministry of Corporate Affairs and was deputed as Director for Corporate Affairs at the World Bank in Washington DC. He was holding the charge of Finance Secretary and Secretary in the Department of Expenditure when he was named Cabinet Secretary.

Gold rings and coins, laptops: Big spending in Vijay’s debut Budget

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, August 5

TAMIL NADU’S new government has chosen direct welfare and human-capital spending for its first Budget, even as it acknowledges a debt burden of nearly Rs 11 lakh crore and a weakening link between economic growth and State revenues.

Presenting the TVK government’s maiden Budget on Wednesday, Finance Minister N Marie Wilson argued that tighter administration, technology-driven governance and better revenue collection would eventually create the fiscal space needed to sustain an ambitious expansion of welfare, education and healthcare, while rolling out a series of politically resonant schemes centred on Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay’s campaign promises.

The Budget’s most visible announcements reflected that political choice.

Eligible brides will receive an eight-gram gold coin and a silk saree under the new Annan Seer Thittam, backed by an allocation of Rs 812 crore. Every child born in a government hospital

will receive a one-gram gold ring under the Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam, with Rs 560 crore set aside for the programme.

The government also expanded the breakfast scheme to middle-school students, allocated Rs 2,000 crore for the Vetri Laptop Scheme, announced modernisation of over 3,700 government schools, introduced a school sanitation programme, promised residential schools for disadvantaged students, and expanded social welfare programmes covering senior citizens, transgender persons and women.

The Budget referred to the White Paper’s finding that Tamil Nadu’s debt had doubled over five years to about Rs 10 lakh crore. Separately, the revised Budget estimates place outstanding debt at nearly Rs 10.99 lakh crore. It said declining tax effort, rising committed expenditure and increasing interest payments had steadily reduced the government’s ability to finance new programmes.

Wilson said the government had ended restrictive tender practices, widened competition



Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay and state Finance Minister N Marie Wilson ahead of Budget proceedings on Wednesday. ANI

in public procurement, delegated planning approvals to reduce discretion, introduced faceless GST assessment and registration systems, digitised mining surveillance and imposed an additional privilege fee on liquor manufacturers.

Together, these measures, he said, could generate around Rs 16,000 crore in additional revenue, including up to Rs 1,000 crore annually from liquor levy and approximately Rs 15,000 crore from technology-led improvements in tax, registration

and mining administration.

That fiscal argument closely mirrors the broader approach the government has articulated since taking office. Rather than portraying the state’s financial challenge as one requiring immediate expenditure cuts, the government argues that administrative inefficiency, leakages and weak revenue mobilisation have prevented the State’s finances from keeping pace with one of India’s fastest-growing economies.

To reinforce that strategy,

Wilson highlighted the recently constituted Revenue Augmentation Committee headed by former Planning Commission Deputy Chairman Montek Singh Ahluwalia, describing it as central to strengthening Tamil Nadu’s fiscal autonomy and identifying sustainable sources of tax and non-tax revenue.

The budget therefore represents a calculated political wager. Instead of postponing welfare until public finances improve, the government has chosen to begin with visible social programmes while betting that governance reforms will generate sufficient fiscal room over time.

Many of the flagship announcements also combine welfare with longer-term human-capital investment.

School education received Rs 44,527 crore, with curriculum reforms, expanded AI education, campus sanitation and school infrastructure. Healthcare allocations included maternity support centres, mobile geriatric treatment units, expanded telemedicine, cancer-care hubs and higher allocations for essential medicines.

After Bankipur defeat, BJP concludes it lost the battle of narrative

Santosh Singh
Patna, August 5

FAILURE TO effectively counter Jan Suraj Party founder Prashant Kishor’s narrative. That’s what the Bihar unit of the Bharatiya Janata Party is now blaming for its recent Bankipur bypoll defeat – one of the party’s most significant losses in the recent past.

A review by the Bihar BJP has concluded that it lost the battle of the narrative by failing to counter Kishor’s refrain – that the electorate of Bankipur, considered a BJP stronghold for three decades, had been taken for granted. Despite the loss, the party has ruled out immediate organisational restructuring.

BJP candidate Neeraj Kumar Sinha lost Bankipur – a seat represented five times by its national president Nitin Nabin – to Kishor by 19,324 votes.

“We discussed the Bankipur outcome and upcoming party programmes,” a senior BJP leader who attended the review meeting told *The Indian Express*. “Feedback from ground workers clearly suggested that we failed to counter the narrative built by Prashant Kishor.”

During his campaign, Kishor had repeatedly maintained that the BJP was treating the Bankipur electorate “like bonded labour”. But what the BJP’s review is learnt to have found damaging was Kishor’s allegation that the BJP believed “even a cat or dog could win the seat on a party ticket”.

“Although senior leaders, including Patna Sahib MP Rav Shankar Prasad, attempted to clarify the context of Kishor’s remarks, our response should have been far more aggressive,” the leader admitted. “Moreover, since the Bankipur candidate, Neeraj Kumar Sinha, was closely backed by our national president Nitin Nabin, the state unit hesitated to aggressively pursue the issue during the campaign.”

Asked if objections to the candidate came up, the leader denied it. “We don’t debate such matters because the party stood firmly behind giving tickets to a ground-level worker. We lost to a narrative built on falsehoods – none of our leaders ever made any ‘kutta-billi’ remarks,” the leader said.

Now the BJP is focusing on two nationwide outreach drives: the Kalash and Tiranga yatras.

‘Malicious’: India slams Pak on Art 370 abrogation remark, flags PoJK killings

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 5

AS DEPUTY Prime Minister and Foreign Minister of Pakistan, Ishaq Dar, called on the international community to fulfil its “long-overdue responsibility” for the peaceful resolution of the Kashmir dispute, Delhi sharply retorted that the “Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh are, have always been, and shall forever remain an integral and inalienable part of India”.

On the anniversary of the abrogation of Article 370 and removal of special status to Jammu and Kashmir, Dar said India’s actions in Kashmir on August 5, 2019, presented a “grave challenge” to the established international framework and expressed solidarity with the people of the region.

“We reaffirm our unwavering support for their fundamental rights, as enshrined in the Charter of the United Nations and reflected in the relevant UNSC resolutions,” he said, adding that events of August 5, 2019, remained a “matter of deep concern”.

Responding to Dar’s comments on Wednesday, the Ministry of External Affairs official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said: “India categorically rejects the political absurdity and futile attempts by Pakistan to observe the so-called Youm-e-Itislahal to spread malicious propaganda against India. The Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh are, have always been, and shall forever remain an integral and inalienable part of India”.

Jaiswal said that the constitutional changes made on Au-

gust 5, 2019, are “entirely an internal matter of India”. These decisions have brought unprecedented socio-economic development, good governance, and democratic empowerment to the people of the region, he said. “Pakistan has no locus standi to comment on matters that are strictly internal to India,” Jaiswal said.

“Pakistan’s desperate attempts to peddle falsehoods are intended solely to deflect international attention from its own dismal human rights record and its status as the global epicentre of terrorism. The international community is currently witnessing the brutal suppression of fundamental rights in Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir (PoJK). Recent weeks have seen Pakistani security forces resort to lethal violence, targeted killings, and draconian bans to silence peaceful civil rights protests led by the local populace. Such state-sponsored violence against unarmed civilians exposes the profound hypocrisy of the Pakistani establishment,” he said.

“Instead of engaging in predictable diplomatic theatre, Pakistan would be well-advised to stop the bloodshed in PoJK, take credible, verifiable, and irreversible action against terror networks operating from its soil, and immediately vacate all Indian territories under its illegal and forcible occupation. The world is not fooled by these orchestrated spectacles,” he said.

On Tuesday, India had upped the offensive on Pakistan over the elections in PoK, as it called them a “complete farce” and slammed the crackdown by Pakistan’s forces that had led to the killing of at least 90 civilians.

EXPRESS special

7 years of Aug 5: Why Omar Abdullah is talking Robert Frost and ‘promises to keep’

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, August 5

AS ANOTHER anniversary comes and goes of Jammu and Kashmir being stripped of its special status and reduced to a Union Territory, the Narendra Modi government continues to promise restoration of statehood, but has not committed to when it will happen. Under increasing political pressure on the issue, Chief Minister Omar Abdullah has hardened his political stance and recently held his first protest in Delhi for statehood.

Marking the seventh year of the Centre’s August 5, 2019, move, Abdullah declared Wednesday that he had neither “forgotten” nor “accepted”.

“My party & I remain committed to reversing all that was done to J&K,” he said in a post on X, adding Robert Frost’s lines: “I have promises to keep... miles to go before I sleep.”

The statement marked a departure from the calibrated approach the National Conference (NC) leader has adopted since he led his party to power in October 2024, in the first elections held after the change. In the period after that, his government maintained a cooperative relationship with the Centre in the hope that statehood would follow. Realisation seems to be dawning now that this strategy has produced little.

Promises, promises

Since Parliament passed the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, the Centre’s position has been consistent: statehood will be restored at an “appropriate time”.

The first assurance came during the debate on the reor-



Participants carry a 200-metre Tricolour during a Tiranga Rally organised by the Jammu and Kashmir Peoples Forum (JKPF) in Reasi; (right) PDP leader Iltija Mufti during a protest demanding the restoration of J&K’s special status in Srinagar on Wednesday. PTI

ganisation Bill. Replying to concerns in Parliament in August 2019, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said: “When normalcy returns...when the right time arrives, J&K will be given statehood again.”

Later, in October 2019, Shah said J&K would not remain a UT forever, and statehood would return once the security situation normalised. In February 2021, he again assured Parliament that “full statehood” would be granted, at an “appropriate juncture”. Then, visiting J&K in October 2021, he laid out what he described as a roadmap – delimitation, Assembly elections and then restoration of statehood. In early 2022 and in 2023, Shah maintained his stance.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi too has given similar assurances. During a rally in J&K before the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, he spoke of restoring statehood and holding Assembly elections, but stopped short of specifying any timeline. The same position has been taken before the Supreme Court. Dur-

ing restoration of statehood the immediate objective. In a speech after the polls, he said: “I would like to believe the honourable Prime Minister.”

However, there has been no reciprocal gesture from the Centre. The Lieutenant Governor’s dominance over the administration continues, the notification of Transaction of Business Rules still hasn’t happened, and bureaucracy’s powers are seen as dwarfing the elected government’s.

One hand tied behind his back, Abdullah is also under attack from political rivals, who accuse his government of failing to deliver even on routine governance promises. He has only difficult choices now. He can return to quiet engagement with the Centre; or escalate public mobilisation around the statehood demand; or broaden his campaign by again foregrounding restoration of Article 370 and other constitutional guarantees alongside statehood. The irony is that given the Centre’s reluctance over statehood, the other de-

Omar’s gamble

The NC contested the 2024 Assembly elections promising to strive for restoration of Article 370, Article 35A and statehood, as existed before August 5, 2019. However, pragmatism prevailed and, in government, Abdullah recalibrated his priorities, mak-



mands are even more unlikely to be met.

August 5, 2026

Valley-based parties held protests Wednesday to mark the abrogation of Article 370. Apart from Abdullah’s statement in Srinagar, NC MPs held a demonstration outside Parliament, and were joined by their INDIA bloc allies. PDP president Mehbooba Mufti, who led a demonstration, told *The Indian Express*: “It started with a very dark night on August 4 and that dark night continues.” The reference was to the detention of leaders in the Valley ahead of the 2019 move.

The BJP, in contrast, celebrated August 5 as ‘National Integration Day’, in Jammu. BJP chief spokesperson Sunil Sethi spoke about “the positive changes” in the UT since 2019, listing infrastructure development, governance, and “stronger democratic institutions”.

WITH NAVEED IQBAL IN SRINAGAR & ARUN SHARMA IN JAMMU

‘Outrageous’: PDP leader Para on Giriraj’s calling Mehbooba ‘terrorist’

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

PEOPLES DEMOCRATIC Party leader Waheed Para on Wednesday hit out at Union Minister Giriraj Singh for his statement in which he described Jammu and Kashmir’s former CM Mehbooba Mufti as “terrorist”, saying the remarks were “outrageous” and “irresponsible”.

“Giriraj Singh’s remarks calling PDP president Mehbooba Mufti a ‘terrorist’ are outrageous, irresponsible, and beneath the dignity of a Union Minister. Such language against a former chief minister of J&K and a senior Muslim woman leader reflects nothing but prejudice and political intolerance,” Para said in a post on X.

Mufti courted controversy on Tuesday after she was seen holding the national flag upside down in Srinagar during a pro-



Union Minister Giriraj Singh

test against the abrogation of Article 370.

Giriraj told reporters at Parliament that she was “a terrorist since she had sided with terrorists for so long”. In his statement, Giriraj said: “Mehbooba Mufti is a terrorist. I say terrorist because she sided with terrorists for long. She was with us for a few days, we tried to reform her, she did not improve, so we let her go.”

Para said “This is not a political statement; it is a reflection of Giriraj Singh’s own mindset,” the Pulwama MLA said.

Misri meets Lanka President, bilateral projects in focus

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 5

INDIA AND Sri Lanka have agreed to take forward the negotiations on updating the Free Trade Agreement and will sign the Social Security pact soon, as Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri met Sri Lankan President Anura Kumara Dissanayake in Colombo on Wednesday.

The discussions between Misri and Dissanayake focused on issues of “mutual interest and review of key bilateral projects, including assisted development projects in Sri Lanka”.

Following the meeting, both sides exchanged agreements on INR-denominated Lines of Credit for USD 350 million, which form part of the USD 450 million reconstruction package extended by India in the wake of Cyclone Ditwah. The LoCs will support reconstruction, infrastructure development, and procurement requirements that arose in the aftermath of the cyclone, the Indian High Com-

mission in Sri Lanka said.

The Foreign Secretary also “called upon the Sri Lankan leadership to implement their commitment to hold Provincial Council elections at the earliest and to fully implement the Constitutional provisions of Sri Lanka to meet the aspirations of the Tamil people”, MEA said.

“He welcomed President Dissanayaka’s assurances as contained in the Joint Statement of December 2024 that Sri Lankan territory shall not be permitted to be used in any manner inimical to the security of India and conveyed that this provides a strong foundation to build a comprehensive and mutually beneficial development,” the MEA said.

“There was also discussion on strengthening our partnership on economic matters. Both sides welcomed the initial discussions in June this year and the decision to take forward negotiations on updating the Free Trade Agreement between India and Sri Lanka. They also wel-



Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri with Sri Lanka President Anura Kumara Dissanayake in Colombo on Wednesday. ANI

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mljMzg1 was his first stand-alone visit to Sri Lanka as Foreign Secretary. He also met Prime Minister of Sri Lanka, Harini Amarasuriya and Leader of Opposition Sajith Premadasa and had separate meetings with leaders of Sri Lankan Tamil and Indian Origin Tamil community.

According to the MEA, both nations expressed satisfaction at the progress registered in the implementation of various pro-

jects, including under the reconstruction package of USD 450 million, announced following cyclone Ditwah. In particular, they welcomed the conclusion of agreements on two INR-denominated Lines of Credit of USD 250 million for the railway projects and of USD 100 million for livestock and other priority requirements respectively.

“Both sides also noted that reconstruction of damaged houses and construction of permanent bridges under the Ditwah Reconstruction Package and covered under a grant of USD 100 million will commence shortly... Both sides are also working towards earliest possible implementation of an Island wide disaster warning system for Sri Lanka... the work on rehabilitation of Northern Railway corridor under a grant of USD 5 million has been completed and train services have resumed,” MEA said. It said that the two sides also discussed modalities for “expediting implementation of energy projects, including

electricity grid interconnection project, Sampur solar power project and development of Trincomalee as an energy hub”.

They also agreed to work towards the earliest possible conclusion of the tender process for implementation of the Sri Lanka Unique Digital Identity project.

“They directed that discussions be initiated at the earliest to conclude an MoU on rehabilitation and modernisation of Kankesanthurai harbour project, to be implemented under a grant of USD 61.5 million. Recalling the commitment made during the visit of PM of India to Sri Lanka in April 2025, the two sides agreed that the MoU to implement the proposed expansion of the 1990 Suwa Seriya Ambulance service should be concluded at an early date. They also noted with satisfaction that the initiative on capacity building announced during the visit of the Prime Minister last year has also been implemented successfully...,” it said.

SC acquits murder convict who served 22 years in prison

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 5

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday acquitted a murder convict who had spent 22 years in prison, saying that the eyewitness testimony based on which he was convicted "is shaky and highly improbable".

Although Arjun Jani alias Tuntun was accused of bludgeoning to death three women, he was convicted of murder of only one.

Allowing his appeal challenging the Odisha HC's refusal to grant him relief, a bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran said, "Three lives were snuffed out...., a person taken into custody on mere suspicion from whom a confession, though not admissible, was extracted employing third-degree methods; the trial court fails to evaluate the evidence properly and the HC remains a mute spectator while adding to the tally of disposals; cumulatively resulting in 22 years being erased out of a person's life without any reliable evidence."

The court also directed the District Legal Services Authority, Koraput, to attempt rehabilitation or resettlement of the appellant with the assistance of the District Administration.

HC verdict on Tarun Tejpal acquittal today; former *Tehelka* editor ordered to be present

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, August 5

THE HIGH Court of Bombay at Goa is expected to pronounce its ruling on the Goa government's appeal against the acquittal of former *Tehelka* editor-in-chief Tarun Tejpal in the 2013 sexual assault case on Thursday. Tejpal has been directed to remain present in court at the time of the pronouncement.

A woman journalist had complained that Tejpal sexually assaulted her in a hotel elevator on November 7 and November 8, 2013. In 2021, a sessions court in Goa acquitted Tejpal of all charges, observing that the complainant "did not demonstrate any kind of normative behaviour" that a victim of sexual assault "might plausibly show".

Ruling that there was no medical evidence, the court had said the woman's messages to the accused clearly established that she was neither "traumatised nor terrified" and that this "completely belies" the prosecution's case.

The Goa government subsequently filed an appeal in the High Court challenging the acquittal. During the hearings, the state argued that the manner in which the trial court dealt with the case was "perturbing", claiming it virtually laid down guidelines on how the victim should respond in such circumstances. The state argued that it was a "classic case of perverse findings". Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the state of

AGITATION MAY INTENSIFY TODAY AS DOCTORS THREATEN TO SUSPEND EVEN EMERGENCY SERVICES

Resident doctors' protest impacts OPDs, surgeries across Maharashtra

Purnima Sah
Mumbai, August 5

PATIENTS WAITED for hours in overcrowded OPDs, several elective surgeries were postponed and teaching came to a standstill in government and civic-run medical colleges and hospitals across Maharashtra on Wednesday as resident doctors launched an indefinite strike against the Maharashtra Medical Council's (MMC) decision to grant conditional registration to BHMS graduates who have completed the Certificate Course in Modern Pharmacology (CCMP).

The agitation is set to intensify on Thursday, with doctors threatening to suspend even emergency services if the impasse continues, even as Medical Education Minister Hasan Mushrif said the government had halted the registration process after granting only one conditional registration on Tuesday night to defuse the situation and would not proceed with further registrations until there was clarity from the Bombay High Court.

According to Central MARD, around 40,000 resident doctors and interns across Maharashtra, including 4,500 in Mumbai, participated in the first day of the strike. The association claimed



Doctors at Mumbai's JJ Hospital protest after suspending regular OPD services on Wednesday. AKASH PATIL

the protest affected nearly 57,400 OPD consultations across the state, including around 10,000 in Mumbai's government and civic hospitals.

The strike affected 35 government and five municipal medical colleges, with resident doctors boycotting OPDs, elective surgeries and academic activities. As a result, no teaching sessions were held in medical colleges on Wednesday.

The impact was most visible in medicine and surgery departments, where hospitals

struggled to manage patient loads with reduced manpower. Professors, associate professors, assistant professors, bonded assistant professors, senior residents and, in some hospitals, interns were deployed to keep essential services running.

At Nair Hospital, the waiting list of patients at the OPD crossed 140 patients by noon.

Sunil Haryana, a Nerul resident who has been visiting the rheumatology OPD for treat-

ment over the past three years, reached the hospital around 7.30 am but was still waiting to be examined after noon. "Usually the wait is not this long. Our regular doctors were not there today. Had I known about the strike, I would not have come," he said.

Nandini Pal, who has been bringing her mother for arthritis treatment at Nair Hospital for the past seven years, said they reached the hospital at 8 am but were still waiting at noon. "Nor-

mally there are five or six doctors in the OPD, but today there were only two. We left home at 7 am and have not even had lunch yet," she said. Her mother suffers from severe joint pain and stiffness due to arthritis.

Patients from Mumbai, Vasai-Virar and neighbouring areas crowded hospital OPDs through the day.

Similar scenes were reported at KEM, Sion, Cooper and JJ hospitals, where OPDs functioned with skeletal staff and several elective surgeries were postponed. JJ Hospital Dean Dr Ajay Bhandarwar said the hospital had managed to keep critical services operational despite the strike. "The main operation theatre, gastro-intestinal endoscopy services and the 24-hour emergency operation theatre remained functional despite the strike."

The agitation follows the MMC's decision to begin granting conditional registrations to BHMS practitioners who have completed the CCMP course, allowing them to practise modern scientific medicine within limits prescribed by government notifications and subject to the outcome of pending litigation before the Bombay High Court.

• BRIEFLY



Students commute to school in a boat after floodwaters submerge roads in Morigaon district of Assam on Wednesday. PTI

ASSAM

Flood worsens: Nadda reviews relief, rehabilitation, health measures

UNION MINISTER J P Nadda on Wednesday reviewed the ongoing relief and rehabilitation measures in the flood-affected areas of Assam in the presence of Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and senior state government officials. Earlier in the day, the Union health and family welfare minister visited the flood-affected areas of Sivasaagar in Assam along with Sarma to assess the damage and met with the families of the deceased. In the evening, he participated in a high-level review meeting on the prevailing flood situation at the chief minister's secretariat in Dibrugarh. PTI

Telangana CA ends life by inhaling helium

A CHARTERED accountant has allegedly died by suicide by inhaling helium gas in Siddipet district of Telangana after suffering huge losses in gambling, police said on Wednesday. He was 33 and found dead in a hotel room on Tuesday. The deceased, a native of Siddipet district, was employed in a firm in Hyderabad, a senior police official said. He purchased a helium gas cylinder from Balanagar here along with equipment and used a mask to inhale the gas to end his life in a hotel room in Siddipet on August 1, the official said, adding that he had watched videos on YouTube in this regard. PTI

Wireless devices seized near Nepal border in Bihar

SECURITY FORCES on Wednesday seized 100 high-frequency wireless communication devices in Bihar's Supaul district which shares its borders with Nepal, officials said. In another incident, Nepalese currency worth Rs 2.63 lakh was also seized in the same district. One person was nabbed in each case. "Sashastra Seema Bal officials from Niyor border outpost (BOP) stopped and searched a suspicious SUV headed for Nepal. Fifty Baofeng walkie-talkie sets and 50 portable wireless devices were recovered from the vehicle's trunk," SSB Commandant Gaurav Singh said. PTI

Odisha constable lynching: 11 named in chargesheet

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, August 5

THE CRIME Branch of Odisha Police on Wednesday named 11 people in the preliminary chargesheet in the lynching of a 32-year-old railway police constable on the outskirts of Bhubaneswar on May 7.

The 767-page chargesheet was filed before a local court in Bhubaneswar under Sections 103(1) (murder), 191(2), 191(3) (rioting), 189(4), 190 (unlawful assembly), and 127(2) (wrongful confinement) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

"It has been based on substantial oral, documentary, scientific, and other corroborative evidence collected during the course of the investigation," one officer from the Crime Branch said.

Twenty people were arrested in the case, with a Crime Branch officer saying there wasn't sufficient evidence against the remaining nine accused to establish their active participation in the assault.

But the Crime Branch said the investigation continued. "Efforts are underway to apprehend the remaining identified persons involved in the incident and collect further evidence," read an official statement. "Supplementary chargesheets, if warranted by further evidence, will be submitted before the competent court in accordance with law."

The GRP constable — Soumya Ranjan Swain — was beaten to death after the motorcycle he was riding pillion collided with a scooter in the Baliaanta area near the state capital. The two women riding the scooter accused Swain of trying to sexually assault them, prompting a mob to tie him to a pole and brutally assault him.

The constable's family, however, alleged it was a "pre-planned murder" and demanded an impartial investigation. Family members also allegedly scuffled with the police outside Baliaanta Police Station.

EXPRESS special

Excavated in 1957, Varanasi skeleton could reveal who lived here 1,000 yrs ago

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 5

FOR NEARLY 70 years, a human skeleton lay sealed inside a wooden box at Banaras Hindu University (BHU). Now, researchers have opened it, hoping its bones can reveal more about who lived in Varanasi nearly 1,000 years ago.

The skeleton was recovered during excavations at Rajghat, an archaeological site in the middle Ganga Valley, in 1957 and has remained in the custody of BHU's Department of Ancient Indian History, Culture and Archaeology ever since.

On Tuesday, a team of experts specialising in ancient DNA collected samples from the skeleton for genetic and bio-archaeological analysis.

It was the department head, Professor M P Ahirwar, who took the lead to reopen the box and examine the skeletal remains. He approached Professor Gyaneshwar Chaubey of BHU's Department of Zoology.

"Following correspondence and the necessary approvals, it was decided to conduct a comprehensive scientific examination of the skeleton. At our request, a team of scientists led by Dr Prajwal Pratap Singh from the Centre for DNA Fingerprinting and Diagnostics (CDFD), Hyderabad, visited BHU," said Professor Chaubey.

Before opening the box, the team of experts trained BHU officials in the proper scientific procedures to prevent contamination of the ancient remains.

Donning protective gear, the



The samples will be analysed at one of the specialised ancient DNA laboratories. EXPRESS

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 Hyderabad, Lucknow or Bengaluru, where scientists will attempt to recover genetic material from the centuries-old bones. Professor Chaubey said the skeleton is believed to be about 1,000 years old.

"But its age can only be confirmed through radiocarbon dating, which will provide a more precise estimate of when the individual lived."

"In addition to radiocarbon dating, we will analyse mitochondrial DNA, which is inherited through the maternal line and can reveal maternal ancestry extending back thousands of years."

The samples will be analysed at one of the specialised ancient DNA laboratories in

• RAJESH GAVE AWAY HIS LIFE JACKET TO THE FARMER WHO WAS TRAPPED IN KANNUR FLOODS

Kerala mourns adventurer who saved life of a farmer

Express News Service
Thiruvananthapuram, August 5

WHEN HE gave his life jacket to a local farmer trapped in the surging currents of Kannur's Tejaswini river this Saturday, Rajesh knew he was handing over his own best chance at survival. After all, these treacherous flood waters were exactly what the 37-year-old adventurer and rappelling instructor would ask others to avoid.

On Wednesday, that selfless act was what led Kerala to mourn his death. Rajesh's body was recovered Tuesday, bringing to a close an intensive three-day search.

As his body was brought to his hometown of Kaliyoor in Thiruvananthapuram, political leaders cutting across the political spectrum paid homage to a man who

sacrificed his life to save a stranded stranger near Kannur's Cherupuzha.

Chief Minister V D Satheesan said he would be accorded a state funeral. "He had taken part in several rescue missions in the past. His death is deeply painful. The government will also complete the construction of his unfinished house," Satheesan said.

Rajesh and some co-workers were returning after giving training in river rafting at the Tejaswini river at Kozhichal in Kannur district when locals alerted them about a farmer stranded in neck-deep water on his farm after river waters suddenly rose after heavy rain.

An accomplished swimmer and rappelling expert, Rajesh had trained adventure clubs, NCC cadets and students in trekking and rappelling, and was part of rescue



Rajesh's body was finally found downstream on Tuesday evening

operations after the 2024 Wayanad landslides. He was, therefore, well equipped to rescue Benny, who had told a local panchayat member over the phone that he had been stranded on his farm

since noon and clinging to a coconut tree.

Cherupuzha panchayat member K D Praveen said Rajesh and some co-workers were returning after a rappelling session at the nearby Menthully waterfalls when locals alerted them about a farmer stranded in neck-deep water on his farm after Tejaswini's waters suddenly rose after heavy rain.

"Farmer Benny was marooned after the road that ran through his area. After hearing about the incident, Rajesh and his colleagues also joined the rescue operation. Once they reached the other side of the river, Rajesh and his two co-workers threw a rope to Benny, whose fingers became entangled while tying it to the tree. Rajesh reached the stranded farmer with his co-workers, removed his own life jacket and helped Benny put it

on. While the others escorted him across the raging river, Rajesh stayed behind to ensure Benny reached safety, but the swirling waters swept him away," Praveen said.

When they first heard of it, Rajesh's friends and family said they expected a man as experienced as him to return. But as time wore on, hope dimmed.

His body was finally found downstream on Tuesday evening. Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan said Rajesh had left behind "an enduring symbol of sacrifice and humanity."

"He gave away his life jacket to save another life. His sacrifice will be remembered forever," Vijayan said in a Facebook post.

Rajesh is survived by his wife, Shafiya, and their school-going sons, Arshan and Abhishek.

GOVERNMENT POLYTECHNIC, MANDKOLA (PALWAL)

Advertisement for engagement of visiting faculty on Hourly Basis

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for engagement as **Visiting Faculty** on an hourly basis for the **Odd Semester of Academic Session 2026-27** in the Departments of **Computer Engineering, Civil Engineering, Electrical Engineering, Medical Lab Technology, and Fashion Technology**.

The engagement is purely a **stop-gap arrangement** until the joining of regular faculty through direct recruitment, transfer, or deputation.

Qualification: As per Haryana Technical Education Service Rules/AICTE norms. **Honorarium:** Honorarium will be paid on an hourly basis @Rs. 600/- per hour with the monthly ceiling of Rs. 40890/- as per prevailing Government norms.

The **General Instructions, Eligibility, and Application Form** are available at www.gpmandkola.edu.in.

The duly filled application form, along with self-attested copies of required documents and experience certificates, must reach the **Office of the Principal** by hand or post **latest by 17.08.2026 (4:00 P.M.)**.

The list of shortlisted candidates will be uploaded on www.gpmandkola.edu.in on **19.08.2026**.

Interview: 21.08.2026 at 10:00 A.M.

No TA/DA will be paid for attending the interview. The engagement is purely temporary in nature and shall not confer any right to regular appointment/regularization.

47859/HRY

Principal

Decomposed body parts found in bag as TN Exp arrives at Agra

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 5

DECOMPOSING BODY parts were found inside a red trolley bag in the general coach of the Tamil Nadu Express after the train arrived at Agra Cantt railway station on Wednesday morning.

Police said the incident came to light after an unidentified person alerted the railway control room about the bag lying unattended near the rear end of a coach of the train.

The caller reported that the bag appeared to be oozing blood and emitting a strong foul smell. By the time the information was received, the train, which was on its way from Chennai and heading to New Delhi, had already left Gwalior station and was enroute to Agra.

A message was immediately relayed to Agra.

As the train arrived at Agra Cantt railway station around 5 am, personnel from the Government Railway Police (GRP) and the Railway Protection Force (RPF) boarded the general coach, located the bag and removed it from the train.

"On opening the trolley bag, we found decomposed human remains," said Rajeev Dixit, Circle Officer, GRP.

2024 SAMBHAL VIOLENCE

‘Conspiracy hatched by MP & an MLA’s son’: UP govt tables report in Assembly

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, August 5

THE UTTAR Pradesh government Wednesday tabled in the state Assembly the report of the three-member judicial commission that investigated the November 2024 violence during a court-ordered survey of the Shahi Jama Masjid in Sambhal, saying the probe found the incident to be the result of a “pre-planned conspiracy” hatched by local MP Rahman Barq, MLA Iqbal Mehmood’s son Suhel Iqbal and mosque management members.

Four people were killed and 28 police personnel were injured in the violence.

Barq, also a former MLA, is Samajwadi Party MP from Sambhal. The others the commission held responsible for the alleged conspiracy include Jama Masjid Intezamia Committee president Zafar Ali, secretary Mashhood Ali Farooqui, and other members.

In the report, former Allahabad HC judge Justice Devendra Kumar Arora, who headed the commission, concluded the circumstances preceding the violence indicated the gathering on November 24 was not sponta-



Four people were killed and 28 police personnel were injured in the November 2024 violence. FILE

neous and was “well-planned”.

The report reads, “The incident of violence dated 24 November 2024 was pre-planned and primarily result of abetment by conspiracy hatched between Zia-ur-Rahman Barq, MP Sambhal, Suhel Iqbal, son of Iqbal Mahmood MLA Sambhal, Zafar Ali, Sadar Intezamia committee, Jama Masjid Sambhal, Kasim Jamal Advocate, Mashhood Ali Farooqui Advocate, secretary in Intezamia committee, Laddan Khan, Nayab Sadar, Intezamia committee and other members of Intezamia Committee.”

The commission linked their alleged role to what it described as “political ambitions and an at-

tempt to retain influence and control over the mosque”.

To support its conclusion, the judicial panel cited a chain of events beginning with the first survey on November 19 that year. These included alleged obstruction during the survey, statements by Barq following Friday prayers on November 22, WhatsApp messages asking people to turn up in large numbers for Friday prayers, and telephone communication between Zafar Ali and the MP on night preceding the November 24 survey.

The commission also referred to the “history of riots and violence” in Sambhal as a possible cause leading to violence.

The report says, “The town of Sambhal has a population of 80% Muslim and 20% Hindu. This town has a long history of communal riots. Due to environment and background of riots and violence, Muslim religious extremism has increased in Sambhal town, and elements that promote and provoke religious extremism have also gained strength, creating a fertile ground for religious extremism. In Sambhal, two groups among the Muslims, Turks and Pathans, are active. A violent atmosphere is created for the fight of dominance between them.”

“From above it appears that the death of four persons of an unlawful assembly was a result of cross firing by the miscreants present in the crowd i.e. Turks and Pathans,” it further says.

The commission referred to a large gathering around the mosque on the morning of November 24, saying some people had their faces covered and some were carrying sticks or weapons, rejecting the claim violence erupted spontaneously after people came to know water was being drained from mosque’s wazukhana amid apprehension of excavation or demolition.

The judicial commission also

observed that the four people who died during the violence were not killed in police firing.

Citing “ballistic and other evidence”, the panel said the firearm injuries to those who died could have been caused by .315-bore weapons, while there was no evidence that police personnel deployed at the site had weapons of that bore. It observed that the four deaths appeared to have occurred in cross-firing among miscreants in the crowd, which the report identified as members of “local Turk and Pathan groups”.

It also noted the FIRs lodged by relatives of the four deceased named unidentified persons and that they did not accuse the police of killing the victims in their complaints or in their statements before the panel.

The report further reads, “Doctors who did the autopsy of four deceased persons have opined they died as a result of gunshot injuries. Ballistic reports, which had been filed by SP, also on record which shows the injuries found on the deceased may have been caused by 315 bore weapons. Admittedly there is no evidence on record any Police personnel had any 315 bore weapons in their hands.”

IN MARCH, TRIAL COURT ACQUITTED ALMOST ALL ACCUSED IN 2016 CASE

10 yrs after Una flogging, Dalit victims seek help to continue fight for justice

Parimal A Dabhi
Ahmedabad, August 5

IN MARCH, a court in Gujarat acquitted 35 men accused of partially stripping and flogging four Dalits after falsely accusing them of killing cows in Una in Gir Somnath district 10 years ago.

The incident was seen at the time as a stark illustration of the atrocities that Dalit communities continued to face at the hands of non-Dalits in many parts of the country.

Months after the acquittal, the complainant in the case, who was himself a victim of the 2016 atrocity, is seeking financial assistance from well-wishers so he can pursue his appeal in the Gujarat High Court (HC).

The last hearing on Vashram Sarvaiya’s appeal against the March 16 order of the Veraval sessions court took place on July 20. A division Bench of the HC asked the registry to get the records of the proceedings in the trial court, and posted the matter



Vashram Sarvaiya (left) and his father Balu Sarvaiya. EXPRESS FILE

for hearing on August 25.

“Over the past 10 years, we have had to incur a lot of expenses to pursue this case. Our sources of income are limited. For a decade, we did not ask for help... But now we need it and I have appealed to society. We will need money to fight in the High Court and, if needed, in the Supreme Court as well,” Vashram told *The Indian Express*.

tutyochhe. Joaa ladai ma samaj sahhbhai bani ful nahi to ful ni pankhadi nobhagidar banshet to High Court Supreme Court ma ladai khub majboot svaman swabhiman ni ladai ma jeet melvi shakishu. High Court ane Supreme Court ma apane janie chhie ke khoob mota praman kharcha thata hoy chhie tyare aaje aa case ni javabdari samaj ni samjine sath, sahyog daapi aa pidit parivar ne ane samaj ne nyay apavie. [Today, this family is financially completely broken. If the community comes together and contributes even a modest amount—a petal if not a flower—we will be able to win this fight for dignity and self-respect in the High Court and Supreme Court. As we know, proceedings in the High Court and Supreme Court involve very heavy expenses. Therefore, considering this case to be the community’s collective responsibility, let us offer our help, support, and cooperation to secure justice for this victim family and our society.]”

Man lynched after missing teen returns, alleges rape

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, August 5

A MAN was beaten to death in Jharkhand’s Chatra district Tuesday morning after villagers accused him of confining and raping a minor girl. A top officer in the administration said the allegations of abuse are yet to be confirmed. Mohammed Sultan, the father of the lynching victim, Mohammed Imroze, has filed a police complaint. An FIR has been registered under several sections, including one related to mob lynching.

According to the father’s complaint, a crowd of 100-150 people reached their place on Tuesday and accused them of forcibly keeping a girl from the village at their home. When they denied this, people in the crowd tied up the man’s parents and assaulted them, the complaint said.

The FIR states that when the man came to rescue his parents, the mob attacked him with sticks and stones. His father has alleged that some police personnel were present during the incident. The complaint said the injured man was

taken to the police station, and the family was later told that he had died. According to some reports, the victim was jailed in 2023 in a rape case.

The father has named 56 people in his complaint. He has also alleged that videos of the assault were recorded and circulated on social media.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Block Development Officer (BDO), Deolal Oraon, said 10 people have been detained in the lynching case. He said the administration is yet to establish the series of events that led to the crime.

The BDO said a girl from the village went missing on Monday night. She was found on Tuesday, and she reportedly alleged that she was confined at the victim’s home. Following this, villagers gathered and stormed the victim’s home, the official said. “The girl has been sent for medical examination, and the administration is awaiting the report before drawing any conclusions regarding the allegations,” the BDO added.

Heavy force has been deployed in the area to keep the situation under control.

Ethiopian Airlines ex-chief Tewolde Gebremariam is new Air India CEO

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 5

FORMER ETHIOPIAN Airlines Group CEO Tewolde Gebremariam has been appointed as the next chief executive officer and managing director of Air India, and will be succeeding the Tata group airline’s current CEO Campbell Wilson who had put in his papers in April. Wilson had agreed to continue as CEO till a successor was found by the airline’s board. Air India said that details regarding the exact onboarding timeline for the new CEO and the transition schedule will be shared in due course. Foreign-origin leadership executives of Indian airlines require security clearance from the government before taking charge.

Gebremariam’s appointment comes at a time when Air India is facing external headwinds due to geopolitical conflicts and high fuel prices, and is recovering from last year’s tragic crash of AI 171. The airline is also at a critical juncture in its transformation programme to become a world-class airline. Gebremariam served in Ethiopian Airlines for over 36 years, 11 of which were as group CEO. He took an early retirement from the airline in March 2022 due to health issues, and is currently a senior strategic advisor to Delta Air Lines of the US, as per his LinkedIn profile.

According to reports, Gebremariam was chosen by the recently privatised Pakistan International Airlines (PIA) to be its next CEO. But it was not clear why he did not join PIA.

As Air India’s first post-privatisation CEO, Wilson helmed the Tata group carrier through a turbulent period. Under him, the carrier embarked upon an ambitious transformation programme to shrug off its legacy image of a rundown government-owned airline, placed world record-breaking aircraft orders, faced challenges due to supply chain woes, suffered a



Tewolde Gebremariam

tragic plane crash that killed 260 people, came under intense regulatory heat, and grappled with heavy financial losses and headwinds like airspace closures.

“The objective of the (Air India) Board was to identify a leader with a proven record of managing mega-scale airline turnarounds, delivering operational excellence, fostering a strong culture of safety and service, and driving profitable expansion. Following an intensive evaluation process, the Board unanimously concluded that Mr Gebremariam possesses the ideal combination of leadership, deep operational expertise, and strategic execution capability required for Air India’s next phase of growth,” Air India said in a release.

“On behalf of the board, I am delighted to welcome Tewolde to Air India. Having completed the initial phase of stabilisation, integration, and fleet commitments under Campbell’s guidance, Air India is now entering a critical execution and expansion era. Tewolde’s track record in building one of the world’s most efficient and profitable airline groups makes him uniquely suited to lead Air India. His operational expertise, commitment to safety, and vision for hub development will be instrumental as we establish Air India as a premier global carrier and a source of national pride,” Tata Sons and Air India Chairman N Chandrabose said.

Bareilly’s Urs-e-Razvi advanced in view of Kanwar Yatra; meat dishes off the menu

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 5

IN VIEW of the ongoing Kanwar Yatra, the organisers of the Urs-e-Ala Hazrat, or Urs-e-Razvi, in Uttar Pradesh’s Bareilly have for the first time advanced the festival by a day and decided that vegetarian food will be served instead of the customary meat dishes, following directions from the district administration and police.

The three-day festival that draws devotees from around the world has been advanced from August 7-9 to August 6-8 because it falls this year in the month of Shravan, when large numbers of people from Bareilly, as well as those passing through the district for the Kanwar Yatra, are expected to be on the move.

The decision was taken keeping in mind traffic congestion as well as a desire to avoid situations in which devotees from the two communities might cross paths, officials said.

“The decision to change the dates was taken keeping in mind the presence of large numbers of Kanwariyas in the city on the following day (August 10, Monday), as well as a request made by the district administration and police,” Nasir Qureshi, media in-charge of the Ala Hazrat Dargah, said in a statement.

He explained that the Urs had originally been scheduled for August 7-9, with the concluding Kul Sharif ceremony coinciding with major Kanwar processions passing through the city.

“Following a directive from Dargah chief Maulana Subhan Raza Khan (Subhani Miyan), an eight-member panel of Islamic scholars was constituted to examine the issue and recommend whether the dates ought to be changed. Senior police and administration officials also visited and met with the Dargah leadership, requesting that the event be rescheduled

in the interest of public order and security. Following consultations with the scholars, and taking the administration’s request into account, it was decided that the 108th Urs-e-Razvi would instead be held from August 6 to 8 — Thursday, Friday and Saturday,” Qureshi said.

Qureshi added that the revised schedule is being communicated through social media, so that pilgrims who had planned their travel around the previously announced dates could adjust their arrangements accordingly.

When contacted, Manush Pareek, Superintendent of Police, Bareilly, said that he and a team from the district administration had met the Dargah chief to request a shift in the Urs dates, keeping in mind the anticipated heavy traffic on Monday, August 10—the day on which a large number of Kanwar pilgrims were expected to be present in the city. We also asked the Dargah administration to instruct all langar committees and groups organising community meals for pilgrims to serve only vegetarian food this year.

“Following our request, the Dargah chief agreed to both our demands,” he added.

Qureshi also explained that since this year’s Urs-e-Ala Hazrat coincides with Shravan, during which meat-related restrictions are also observed, the Dargah has appealed to all langar committees and those organising community meals to arrange meat-free, vegetarian dishes for pilgrims.

“We have urged people not to use DJ sound systems, as they encourage unnecessary noise and extravagant spending,” he added.

The organisers have also appealed to pilgrims to offer flower baskets in place of cloth chadars and to donate whatever money they save in the process to charitable causes.

MULTIPLE FAILURES AND MAJOR DEFICIENCIES REPORTED WITHIN 13 DAYS OF OPENING

NHAI suspends toll on Rs 4,200-crore Kanpur-Lucknow e-way

Dheeraj Mishra & Bupendra Pandey
New Delhi, Lucknow, Aug 5

FOLLOWING MULTIPLE failures and major deficiencies reported on the 63-km Kanpur-Lucknow Expressway within 13 days of its opening, the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has suspended toll collection until the issues are fully rectified. The authority has also initiated action against the contractor, consultant and concerned officials.

NHAI has issued a notice to declare the concessionaire or contractor, PNC Infratech Ltd, a non-performer, which would make the company ineligible to participate in bidding for future NHAI projects. Along with this, a show-cause notice has been issued to levy a penalty of 2% of the performance security and

initiate debarment proceedings for up to three years against the head of highways and other responsible staff.

To conduct a technical investigation into the incident, it said an expert committee from IIT Kharagpur has been constituted.

A senior NHAI official said the rectification would cost around Rs 3 crore and that the contractor would have to bear the cost without any financial implication for NHAI. The official added that the loss of toll revenue would be recovered from the contractor.

On July 26, a slippage spanning about 300 metres was observed near the 64-km mark in Unnao’s Korari area on the expressway, after its inauguration on July 13. The issue went viral on social media, with several highway users questioning NHAI and the contractor over



The six-lane access-controlled expressway is expected to cut travel time between Lucknow and Kanpur from around 90 minutes to just 35-40 minutes. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT PHOTO

the quality of the Rs 4,200-crore expressway. Traffic has currently been diverted at the affected stretch.

Apart from taking action against the contractor, NHAI has removed the project manager of

the construction agency, the team leader of the independent engineer and the resident engineer from the project. They have also been debarred from participating in any highway projects for the next two years. Theme

Engineering Services Pvt Ltd, the independent engineer for the project, has also been issued a debarment notice.

The official said that a chargesheet is being issued against former NHAI project director Saurabh Chaurasia, during whose tenure a substantial portion of the construction took place, and the present project director Nakul Prakash Verma for alleged negligence in the project. Verma has been repatriated to his parent department.

Gautam Vishal Charan Pahari, Regional Officer and Chief General Manager of NHAI, said, “Road surface slippage was detected near Km 64 on the Kanpur-Lucknow Expressway on July 26. Restoration work was initiated immediately after the incident was reported, and directions were issued for a comprehensive technical assessment of

the affected location. Traffic has been diverted at the affected stretch, and the expressway continues to operate smoothly.”

The ambitious six-lane expressway is expected to reduce travel time between Uttar Pradesh’s capital Lucknow and its industrial hub Kanpur from around 90 minutes to about 40 minutes. It has been positioned as a game changer for residents of the region.

Videos of the damaged section of the expressway also triggered criticism from opposition parties, which alleged that the BJP government was compromising construction quality in one of its flagship highway projects. Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, sharing a video on social media, posted: “Running less, sinking more: Lucknow-Kanpur Expressway! Cost: Rs 4,700 crore!”

● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Israel must end the siege and say yes to a Gaza deal.
— *Haaretz, Israel*



READ. THINK. SHARE.
Scan the QR code to explore curated editorials and opinions from leading voices

New FCRA bill is about control, not transparency. It must be opposed



THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

THE FOREIGN Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, reintroduced in the Lok Sabha for adoption during the Monsoon Session following its sudden withdrawal in April, marks a dangerous escalation in the centralisation of executive power in India. In the name of enhanced transparency and regulatory oversight, the proposed legislation fundamentally rewrites the relationship between the Indian state and civil society. Driven by its majoritarian ideology and allergy to independent voices, the current government has increasingly reframed non-profit charities, think tanks and human rights groups not as development partners, but as sources of subversion and foreign manipulation. To neutralise these voices, the state has targeted their primary vulnerability: Dependence on international philanthropy.

Through aggressive enforcement and sweeping amendments to the FCRA, the government has already imposed complex compliance burdens, such as banning subcontracting to grassroots organisations, slashing allowable administrative outlays, and mandating a single bank branch in New Delhi for all foreign inflows. The resulting regulatory squeeze has triggered an 87 per cent drop in foreign funding, forcing thousands of secular and community-based organisations to shut down, while an impending legislative push to allow the state seizure of cancelled NGO assets threatens to permanently cripple the sector. For the nation's welfare network, and particularly for the long-standing Christian institutions that form the backbone of healthcare, higher education, and social care across states like Kerala, the provisions of this Bill do not merely represent administrative hurdles; they present an existential threat to institutional autonomy, property rights, and constitutional freedoms.

The Amendment introduces an unprecedented mechanism of control that by-

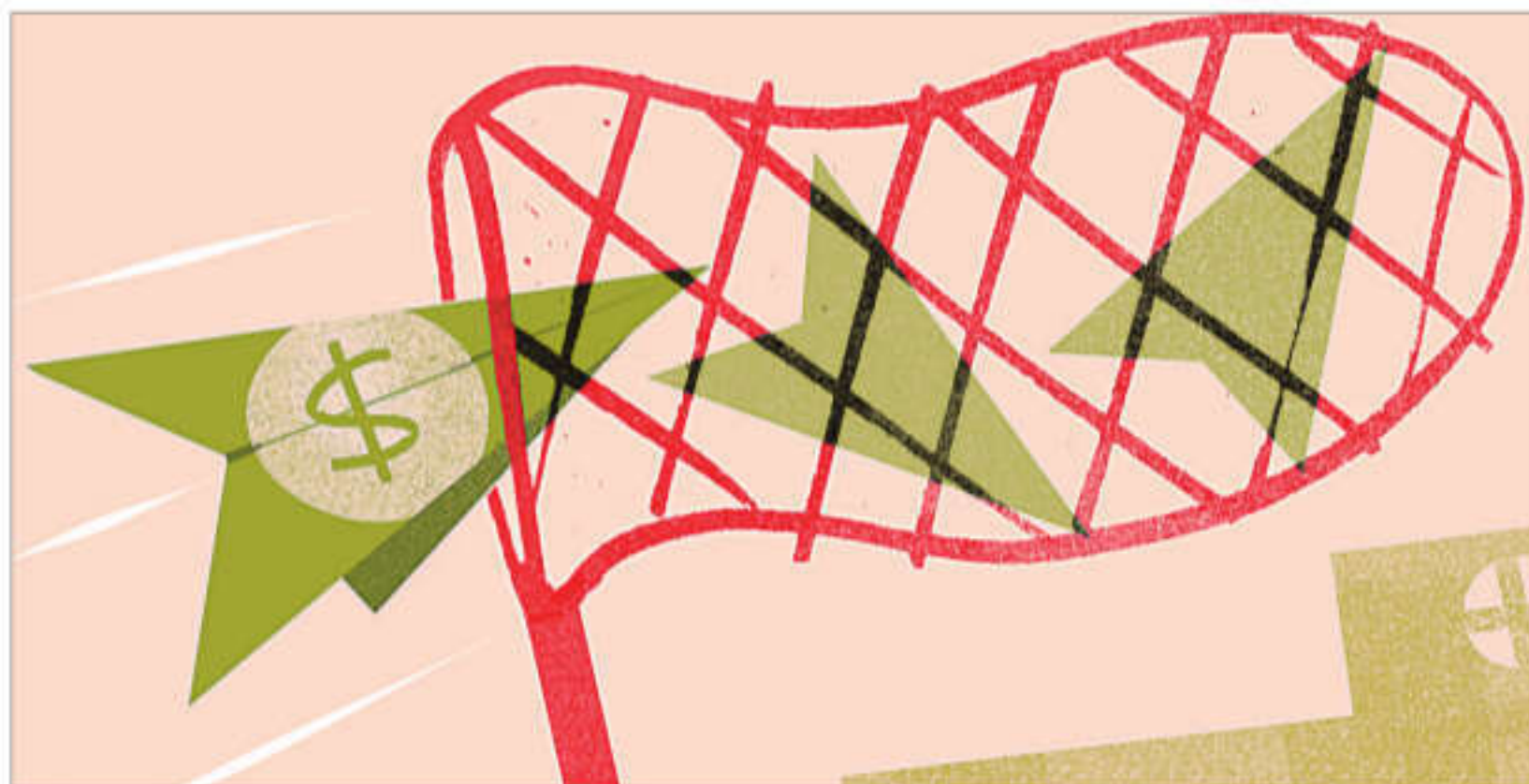


ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

passes traditional legal protections. The Bill establishes a central, bureaucratically appointed Designated Authority, empowered to take control of an organisation's foreign funds and physical properties. If an entity's FCRA license is suspended, cancelled, or denied renewal, its assets provisionally vest in this authority, granting the government the statutory right to seize, manage, and ultimately sell these properties while crediting the proceeds directly into the Consolidated Fund of India, even if an asset was only partly funded through foreign contributions. Furthermore, under newly proposed mechanics of "deemed cessation", if an organisation fails to submit its renewal application on time or if its renewal is rejected by the Home Ministry, its registration automatically ceases, immediately terminating its right to operate, utilise tied assets, or access remaining foreign funds. At the same time, the executive reserves the authority to dictate rigid timelines for the receipt and disbursement of funds, stripping charities of the financial flexibility required to manage long-term infrastructure projects, disaster reserves, or endowments.

To understand the human toll of these provisions, just examine their impact on regions with deeply-rooted institutional networks. As a Kerala MP, I have seen Christian-run charitable trusts, schools, hospitals and diagnostic centres, medical colleges, and welfare NGOs serving marginalised

It is a profound injustice to subject institutions that have devoted generations to India's development, education, and healthcare to such punitive statutory mechanisms

populations, regardless of caste or creed, for well over a century. These facilities rely on a mix of local contributions, domestic fees, and foreign grants to maintain world-class medical equipment, sponsor affordable care, and fund educational scholarships. By linking an administrative decision on an FCRA license directly to the physical confiscation of land and buildings, the Bill creates an environment of extreme instability. A single administrative delay or an adverse ruling by the Ministry of Home Affairs could instantaneously convert a functioning 500-bed charitable hospital into state property, disrupting essential public services and placing community assets under government control. The victims are the ordinary Indians who are the beneficiaries of these facilities.

If an institution's FCRA license is suspended or withdrawn under this proposed framework, its legal recourse is severely restricted, forcing non-profits into protracted and costly litigation through writ petitions under Article 226 in high courts or Article 32 in the Supreme Court. Constitutional challenges could rest on Article 300A regarding the right to property, as taking over legacy assets (created partly through foreign and partly through domestic funds) without fair compensation or stringent judicial safeguards constitutes arbitrary deprivation of property. Challenges may also arise under Article 14, given that the Bill mandates that law enforcement agencies must seek cen-

tral government clearance prior to initiating investigations, risking selective enforcement that shields favoured entities while applying draconian measures against minority-run organisations. Furthermore, by choking the financial lifelines of these institutions, the administration circumvents core constitutional protections, specifically the rights to freely practice and propagate religion (Article 25) and acquire and manage denominational property (Article 26), without formally repealing them.

In practical terms, if a hospital's license is suspended, the trust must immediately seek an emergency stay order from the high court against physical eviction by the Designated Authority while simultaneously defending its registration before the Ministry of Home Affairs, a process that drains charitable resources away from patient care and education. It is a profound injustice to subject institutions that have devoted generations to India's development, education, and healthcare, to such punitive statutory mechanisms. The contributions of the Church and affiliated charitable organisations in India are documented in millions of lives uplifted, educated, and healed. To treat these developmental partners with institutional suspicion, and subject their physical assets to executive expropriation, undermines the principles of a constitutional democracy. This selective enforcement fundamentally violates the foundational liberal tenet that a democratic state must remain a neutral arbiter rather than an instrument of political engineering. The ruling party uses the cover of regulatory legality to assault liberal policies, transforming our humane, constitutional democracy into a rigid state structure of majoritarian control.

This Bill must therefore be resisted through every legal and democratic channel available, beginning on the floor of Parliament. When it comes up for discussion in the Lok Sabha, the Opposition must stand united in its resistance, demanding an absolute minimum that the Bill be referred to a Select Committee for rigorous, clause-by-clause consideration, public consultation, and input from civil society stakeholders. India's democratic integrity and the survival of its independent social sector depend on ensuring that state regulation does not turn into executive overreach.

The writer is a fourth-term Congress MP from Thiruvananthapuram

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Justice for wrestlers

INSTITUTIONS MUST respond promptly, fairly and without prejudice ('In struggle for justice, a story of impunity', IE, August 5). Faster investigations, victim protection, legal assistance and time-bound trials are necessary to restore public confidence. Workplaces should also establish effective grievance redressal mechanisms and ensure strict compliance with laws against harassment. Justice should not depend on persistence alone but on institutions that act with sensitivity and accountability.

Abbharna Barathi, Chennai

TVK-DMK showdown

POLITICAL DISAGREEMENTS should be addressed through democratic debate rather than through actions that create avoidable controversy ('Udhayanidhi's arrest is TVK's own goal', IE, August 5). Public attention should remain focused on governance, employment, education and public welfare instead of political spectacle. Leaders across parties must exercise restraint and communicate responsibly. At the same time, speeches containing double meanings, obscenity or language that lowers the standards of public discourse should not be tolerated, irrespective of who makes them.

Arun Kumar, Tiruchengode

AI romance

AI MAY offer companionship, but it cannot replace genuine human relationships built on trust, empathy and shared experiences ('Love me like AI does', IE, August 5). As AI becomes more accessible, users should be encouraged to understand its limitations. Families, schools and communities must promote healthy social interaction and digital literacy. Technology should support emotional well-being, not become a substitute for meaningful human connection or personal responsibility.

Prajesh Paramasivan, Neelambur



VINAY SAHASRABUDDHE

THOMAS FRIEDMAN once said that "the world is flat". Globalisation has indeed created a level playing field for trade and industry. However, when forces try to make the world socially and culturally flat, it amounts to making it less beautiful. The globalisation of philanthropy illustrates this danger.

As Parliament prepares to debate amendments to the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), many civil society groups have criticised the proposed changes and levelled serious allegations against the government. But India's experience with foreign-funded activism, along with examples from other countries, offers enough reason to revisit the regulatory framework.

Over time, genuine voluntarism has given way to professionalised activism. Organisations once known for commitment, sacrifice and grassroots engagement increasingly adopted the NGO model, with access to large donor funding reshaping priorities. Some evolved into influential actors that sought to shape public policy, at times reflecting donor agendas more than local needs. The rapid expansion of foreign funding encouraged this shift.

The experience of other countries is instructive. In 1997, scholar James Petras, writing on Latin America, argued that foreign-

Look closely at source and purpose of foreign funding

funded NGOs had become adept at designing donor-driven projects while promoting the rhetoric of identity and globalism. He said that this fostered dependence on external funding, aligned organisations with neoliberal priorities, and weakened genuinely autonomous grassroots movements.

Researchers in Africa have also pointed out that aid flows have created a vicious cycle of dependency that is proving hard to dislodge. There is also research in India showing that foreign aid does not have a significant impact on poverty alleviation. This is not to point fingers at every funder. There is no need to ban foreign funding. Tighter scrutiny is essential in the interest of the community, donors as well as recipients. Seen this way, the FCRA amendments are aimed at increasing the framework's transparency and making it risk-ready. They seek to bring administrative clarity, improve monitoring of the use of foreign contribution, enable the identification of inactive associations, fix accountability and ensure that foreign contribution is used only for the purpose it was provided.

India's experience with foreign-funded activism, along with examples from other countries, offers enough reason to revisit the regulatory framework

These amendments will ensure that foreign money does not shape domestic political, social or ideological outcomes in ways that compromise national security and sovereignty. A Supreme Court judgment, in fact, upholds the Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

State's invocation of sovereignty and national security to regulate foreign contribution. The relevant question is not the cost of compliance to an individual organisation but the source and purpose of foreign funding of activity within India. Besides, the regulatory framework proposed is as per international norms — sovereign states maintain comparable, and frequently stricter, controls over foreign funding of domestic non-governmental activity.

The proposed FCRA amendments are both faith-neutral and sector-neutral. They make no distinction between religious and secular organisations or among different faiths. While some groups have opposed the changes, most voluntary organisations — including hospitals, universities, research institutions and service bodies — have not objected. For organisations that use foreign funds transparently and for declared purposes, greater accountability poses no threat. Had the amendments genuinely endangered the voluntary sector, resistance would have been far broader. Beyond FCRA, the government should also address the excessive professionalisation of the sector. It needs to revive India's tradition of autonomous, community-driven voluntarism rooted in civilisational values.

The writer is president, The Asiatic Society of Mumbai and NEC member of the BJP



ROUHIN DEB AND ROOPLEKHA DUTTA

THE EXCHANGE rate has been the most discussed macroeconomic variable in India amid the current global crisis. The lopsided dependence on crude (a key input) is the predominant cause for the rupee depreciating vis-à-vis the dollar. However, the recent steps by the RBI and the finance ministry to liberalise foreign investment and fortify the rupee seem to strike the right balance to ensure a more stable currency.

The RBI has temporarily relaxed interest rate restrictions on fresh Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] and Non-Resident External (NRE) deposits until Sep-

RBI has a playbook for a stronger rupee

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH60Bd0F>

tember. This could attract up to \$10 billion in additional inflows by enabling banks to mobilise foreign currency and rupee deposits from overseas investors. It complements a series of RBI measures to attract overseas capital and strengthen India's external finances. By allowing banks to offer more competitive returns, alongside a concessional forex swap facility for these deposits and External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs), the RBI is leveraging global interest-rate differentials to mobilise nearly \$20 billion in dollar funding. For foreign investors and the diaspora, this presents an immediate arbitrage opportunity. For India, reports suggest that these measures could attract \$60-70 billion in foreign capital. The decision to double the individual investment limit for Persons Resident Outside India (PROIs) in equities from 5 per cent to 10 per cent and to

increase the collective investment limit from 10 per cent to 24 per cent reduces compliance friction, drawing stable foreign capital directly into the corporate sector.

Another significant reform is the structural overhaul of the government securities (G-Sec) market. By exempting foreign institutional investors (FIIs) from income tax on interest and capital gains from G-Secs, effective April 1, the government has removed a

The RBI has temporarily relaxed interest rate restrictions on fresh Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] and Non-Resident External (NRE) deposits until September

longstanding withholding tax that discouraged overseas participation while helping reduce borrowing costs. With commercial banks, insurers and the RBI holding nearly 75 per cent of outstanding government securities, India's bond market has long lacked global depth. Eliminating this tax friction makes Indian sovereign debt more competitive with US Treasuries and Japanese government bonds, placing it on a stronger global footing. The reform strengthens India's case for inclusion in major global bond indices, ensuring sustained institutional inflows. Extending similar tax parity to the Bank for International Settlements further enhances India's credibility with central banks and sovereign wealth funds.

India is witnessing a surge in domestic investment, with private sector capital expenditure rising 67 per cent year-on-year in

September 2025 and commercial credit expanding by 15 per cent. Sustaining this momentum without crowding out private investment requires a deep and liquid sovereign debt market. A broader global investor base improves price discovery, enhances competition and lowers the government's borrowing costs by compressing term premia. Lower sovereign yields also establish more efficient benchmark rates, reducing the cost of corporate borrowing. Together, these reforms strengthen the rupee's medium-term prospects by attracting stable foreign capital and reinforcing India's long-term growth and macroeconomic stability.

Deb is chief economist, Chief Minister's Secretariat, Government of Assam. Dutta is Mukherjee Fellow, Policy Politics and Governance Foundation

The writer is associate editor, The Indian Express. aakash.joshi@expressindia.com

@ieExplained

#ExpressExplained

If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• LEGAL

How SC’s gender guide differs from the 2023 version

Vineet Bhalla
New Delhi, August 5

TRIAL COURT judges must actively prevent the secondary trauma of sexual assault survivors, control aggressive cross-examinations and develop an “Emotional Quotient” to handle cases involving crimes against women. These are among the key recommendations laid out in a new Supreme Court report published Monday, aimed at bringing gender sensitivity to the Indian judiciary.

The report, ‘Judgments and Gender: Sensitivity and compassion in writing judgments’, has been drafted by an expert panel headed by retired Supreme Court judge Justice Aniruddha Bose. This marks a shift from a 2023 handbook the top court had published, which focused on helping judges identify and avoid patriarchal language.

‘Compassionate court practices’

The new report addresses the trauma that a victim faces in the criminal justice system. It notes that judges require an “Emotional Quotient” to supplement their “Intelligence Quotient” when discharging judicial functions.

The report highlights how survivors are routinely met with insensitive remarks from police and authorities. Such remarks, it notes, traumatise them and deter them from seeking justice.

To combat this, the report recommends “compassionate court practices”. It urges judges to use the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam’s provisions that bar defence lawyers from asking indecent or annoying questions. This is particularly relevant to questions about a survivor’s sexual history, which the report reiterates is immaterial to a rape trial.

The report advocates treating witnesses as “guests” invited to help the court, rather than going through “long waits and poor treatment in court”. It also recommends pre-trial counselling for victims to alleviate anxiety and that trials for sexual offences be held in private, closed-door proceedings to protect the survivor’s privacy.

WHAT TO AVOID

- Instead of writing that a crime ‘destroys the very soul of a helpless woman’, judges are advised to write that the crime ‘caused severe trauma to the survivor’.
- The report asks judges to refrain from using religious or cultural references, and focus strictly on legal rights.

Shift in language

Both the new report and the 2023 handbook contain glossaries of terms to avoid, but their focus areas are different. While the 2023 handbook, issued under then Chief Justice of India (CJI) D Y Chandrachud, was designed to replace colloquial or archaic words with neutral legal terms, the 2026 report targets the moralistic terms recurring in trial court judgments. After analysing 125 trial court verdicts, the Justice Bose-led committee curated a list of problematic phrases to avoid.

Why a new report

The arc of the new report can be traced back to a March 2025 judgment of the Allahabad High Court, in which the court ruled that acts such as grabbing a woman’s breasts and loosening her pyjama string constituted only a “preparation” to commit rape, rather than an “attempt” to rape. The Supreme Court took suo motu cognisance, setting it aside in February 2026. During the hearings, CJI Surya Kant scrutinised the 2023 handbook’s utility, calling it “too Harvard-oriented”: suggesting it was too elite or theoretical for the Indian context. The court had directed the National Judicial Academy, where Justice Bose serves as director, to form a committee of domain experts to frame practical training guidelines.

Drishhti IAS

IAS GS Foundation Course

Offline & Live Online Batches

Centre	हिंदी माध्यम	English Medium
Karol Bagh	20 अगस्त सुबह 11:30 बजे	11 Aug 8:00 AM
Noida	17 अगस्त दोपहर 3:00 बजे	24 Aug 11:30 AM
Indore	24 अगस्त सुबह 8:00 बजे	18 Aug 5:30 PM
Lucknow	29 जुलाई सुबह 8:00 बजे	30 July 11:30 AM
Prayagraj	18 अगस्त शाम 5:30 बजे	24 Aug 5:30 PM
Ranchi	12 अगस्त शाम 5:30 बजे	19 Aug 5:30 PM
Patna	उपनिवेश आरंभ	30 July 8:00 AM
Jaipur	6 अगस्त सुबह 8:00 बजे	11 Aug 5:00 PM

drishhtiias.com

Call Us: 87501 87501

• ECONOMICS

As Vijay govt presents first budget, TN’s key challenge: Mounting debt burden

Udit Misra
New Delhi, August 5

TAMIL NADU Finance Minister N Marie Wilson on Wednesday presented the first budget under the new government led by Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay.

The minister committed to push the size of Tamil Nadu’s economy to the \$1.5-trillion mark by 2036. As of now, the gross state domestic product (GSDP) of the state ranges between \$350 billion to \$400 billion depending on the exchange rate. In other words, the government aims to more than treble the size of the economy over the next 10 years.

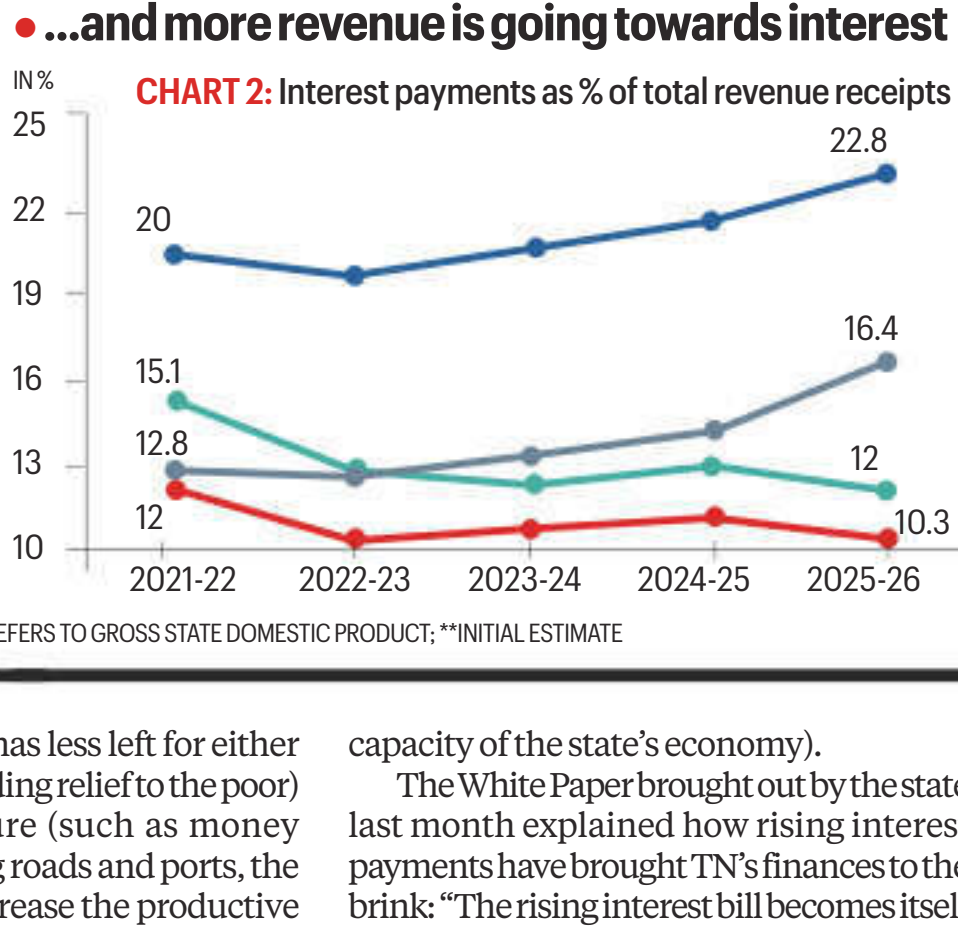
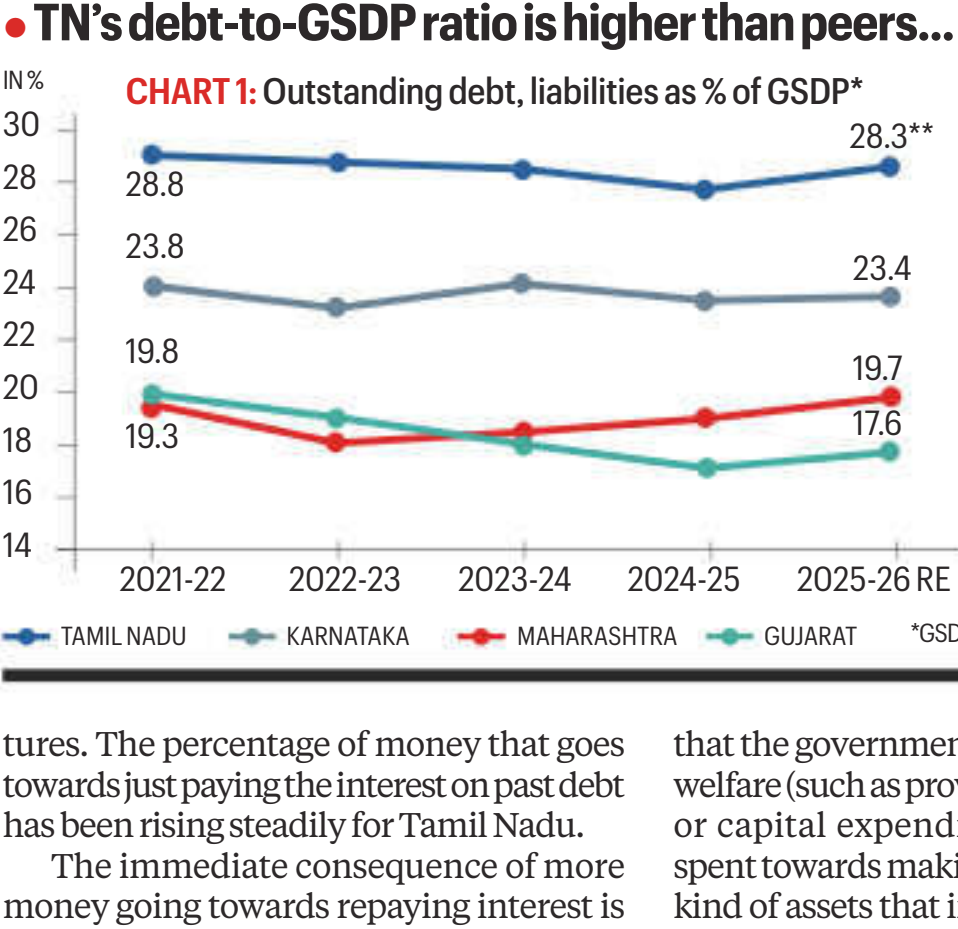
Tamil Nadu, along with states such as Maharashtra, Gujarat and Karnataka, has long been among India’s fastest growing states. It is second in terms of overall economic output among all Indian states, with only Maharashtra ahead of it. But while Tamil Nadu’s headline economic growth has been fairly robust over the past few years, its financial health has worsened.

The main challenge

In his budget speech, Wilson made it clear that past Tamil Nadu governments have been spending far in excess of what they earned and, as a result, borrowed far more than what they were capable of repaying in a sustainable manner.

The two charts alongside provide a glimpse of the fiscal challenge facing Tamil Nadu. *Chart 1* maps the total debt as a percentage of the GSDP (or the state’s annual economic output) for Tamil Nadu and some of the comparable states. While this figure has not really shot up, what is noteworthy is that it is much higher than states with comparably sized economies.

The reason is that Tamil Nadu has borrowed more and more each year just to plug the gap between its expenditure and revenues. The consequence of having high levels of debt is that, over time, the interest burden itself keeps going up, especially if the state doesn’t enhance its ability to raise more revenues. This is what *chart 2* cap-



a reason to borrow further because the state must finance the interest payment from somewhere, and if revenue receipts are insufficient, additional borrowing fills the gap. This is the debt-interest spiral, and Tamil Nadu is now entering its early stages.”

What the budget says

Given the stark challenge facing its finances, the Tamil Nadu government would have to, at the same time, reduce its borrowings by cutting expenditure as well as find ways to increase its revenues.

“...this government has already taken action towards mobilization of nearly Rs 15,000 crore... and has constituted a high level Revenue Augmentation Committee under the chairmanship of the renowned economist... Montek Singh Ahluwalia,” stated the Finance Minister in his speech.

Wilson also promised that the debt-to-GSDP ratio — which was at 28% as of 2025-26 — will be brought down to 26.57% in 2027-28 and 26.10% in 2028-29.

• TECH

Cut, copy: Why books are being destroyed to feed AI



ANAGHA JAYAKUMAR

IN RECENT weeks, booksellers in Australia and Europe have raised concerns about unusual, bulk purchases of books amid reports that artificial intelligence (AI) companies are acquiring physical copies to train their datasets.

It is the manner of such training, however, that has caused alarm: unsealed documents in a copyright lawsuit against Anthropic revealed that the company was resorting to “destructive scanning”, a process in which books are destroyed after their contents are scanned.

The *Guardian* reported recently that Australian booksellers had received requests for books ranging from rare and obscure titles to cheap paperbacks through intermediaries. *Fortune* reported a similar incident involving a Dutch bookseller.

In many cases, intermediaries source books in bulk from sellers before sending them for digitisation, making it difficult for sellers to know who the eventual buyer is.

The reports build on earlier findings about Anthropic’s Project Panama. In January, *The Washington Post* reported that the company had bought millions of physical books, removed their bindings and scanned them to build a massive collection of high-quality training data for its models.

The new reports suggest that a practice once visible mainly through court filings and investigative reporting is now becoming visible further up the supply chain, with booksellers noticing unusual demand.

Why books?

The terms AI and generative AI usually refer to a subset of artificial intelligence called large language models (LLMs). LLMs learn statistical patterns from enormous volumes of content and generate output based on the quality of data fed into them.

While the AI competition in recent times has largely centred on the race for computing power through chips, the push for physical books reflects a growing demand for another critical resource: high-quality training data.

For years, frontier AI companies have relied heavily on text scraped from the public internet. But as AI-generated content

• UNDER THE SCANNER: THE TWO WAYS TO DIGITISE BOOKS

Non-destructive scanning

- Digitises a book without physically altering it, using a V-cradle (see pic) to protect spine.
- An overhead scanner photographs each page while the book remains fully intact.
- Ideal for rare or valuable books that must be preserved.

Destructive scanning

- Digitises a book by cutting off the spine and separating the pages.
- Loose sheets are scanned rapidly using automated scanners, producing high-quality images.
- The process is irreversible, making it suitable only for replaceable books that do not need physical preservation.



The ‘Scribe’ scanner used by Internet Archive. The non-profit digital library says it uses non-destructive digitisation.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

has proliferated online and copyright disputes have made large-scale web scraping increasingly contentious, companies have begun looking elsewhere for reliable, human-written material. Books offer long-form, edited text across a wide range of subjects, much of which is either unavailable or difficult to obtain in digital form.

ISBNdb, which markets book-sourcing services to AI companies, has argued that books published before the AI boom are particularly valuable because they are free of AI-generated content. As AI-generated text proliferates online, older books are increasingly seen as a source of cleaner training data.

Jannis Lennartz, Visiting Professor at Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin, argues in an essay titled *AI Is Eating the Book World* that the current debate over book digitisation began with Google Books, Google’s effort to digitise millions of library books in the 2000s. The project sparked years of litigation over copyright and mass digitisation.

Lennartz argues that the current digitisation efforts by AI companies resemble Google Books in technique but differ in purpose. Instead of making books searchable or accessible online, the goal is to convert them into machine-readable training data for AI systems.

Destructive scanning

Many books are unavailable as clean digital files, while publishers often control access to commercial ebooks. Physical copies therefore remain one of the simplest ways to obtain large volumes of text for digitisation.

What Indian copyright law says

The legal position under Indian copyright law remains unsettled.

•

Section 52 of the Copyright Act, 1957, outlines the fair dealing exception, which allows the limited use of protected material without the owner’s permission for specific purposes.

• CLIMATE

Silt in rivers to urbanisation: Behind Kerala’s worsening floods

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, August 5

AN UNEXPECTED spell of extremely heavy rainfall in early August has triggered flooding in several parts of Kerala, with Kottayam, Pathanamthitta and Alappuzha districts among the worst affected.

Twenty-six people were killed and four others were missing in monsoon-related incidents, while more than 27,000 were sheltering in around 460 relief camps as of Wednesday, said Chief Minister V D Satheesan.

So how have these flash floods so rapidly submerged a chain of urban settlements in the state? The answer lies in a range of mostly human-made factors.

Carrying capacity of rivers

Studies conducted by Kerala’s irrigation department have found that sedimentation in rivers and water bodies contributed to the intensity of the crisis. The water-holding capacity of rivers has significantly declined owing to the accumulation of silt and sand over the last decade.

The 2018 floods, which had deposited huge amounts of sediment into the rivers,

aggravated the situation. Landslides in hilly and forest areas deposited huge volumes of soil and sand in river beds.

Sediment accumulation has also resulted in formation of deltas, which obstruct the flow of floodwater.

Sedimented reservoirs

The extremely heavy rains have increased the water level in all dams, run by both the state’s electricity board and the irrigation department.

A CAG report in 2021 had found a significant fall in storage capacity of dams due to sedimentation. It said the Kallarkutty dam had lost 47% of gross storage in 45 years while the figure for Anayirankal dam was 30.92% in 33 years.

Disappearance of wetlands

Rapid urbanisation, coupled with change in land use patterns, have shrunk the state’s paddy fields, marshlands and wetlands, which would have absorbed a huge volume of rainfall.

According to data from the statistics department, Kerala had 793 lakh hectares of paddy land in 1979-80. This fell to 2.05 lakh



Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

A collapsed bank along the swollen Chaliyar river in Malappuram district. [PH](#)

across both rural and urban areas has significantly altered the state’s natural hydrology. During heavy rains, these impervious surfaces channel stormwater rapidly into nearby rivers and streams, causing water levels to rise within hours. This rapid runoff has become a defining feature of the state’s landscape, where tarred roads and concrete pavements extending from the hills and other high-lying areas effectively function as channels for stormwater.

What the government plans

The state government is planning to desilt rivers and reservoirs to ensure that they have enough room to hold water. Chief Minister Satheesan said on Wednesday: “There is no room for water to flow... To lower the threat of floods, the sedimentation in rivers and dams will be removed urgently. An asset register will be prepared for rivers, streams and lakes and land auditing will be conducted to prevent encroachment of rivers.”

Mining of sand from rivers and reservoirs can also act as a source of income. Till a decade back, sand mining in rivers had been widespread but was banned following environmental concerns.

MALHOTRA FLAGS RISING ENERGY PRICES & TRADE POLICY UNCERTAINTIES AS UPSIDE RISKS TO CURRENT ACCOUNT DEFICIT

Outlook hazy, need clarity before taking any policy action: RBI Gov

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 5

RESERVE BANK of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra on Wednesday signalled that the central bank is in no hurry to alter its policy course as it weighs a more challenging growth-inflation mix.

“The outlook, however, is hazy because of the uncertainties regarding south-west monsoon, El Niño, geopolitics and global trade policy. There is a need for greater clarity to emerge, especially regarding inflation, its path and composition before taking any policy action,” he said while unveiling the monetary policy.

“Any such action (on the interest rate front) would also have to consider the need for recalibration of policy rates in line with the evolving growth-inflation dynamics, especially the normalisation of the underlying inflation from its benign levels seen hitherto,” Malhotra said. The RBI’s policy panel on Wednesday kept the policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25%. The US Federal Reserve also kept the federal fund target range unchanged at 3.50-3.75% on July 29 amid growing concern about inflation.

He said growth, albeit resilient, is expected to be lower in 2026-27. The supply-side pressures caused by the West Asia conflict have eased somewhat since June 2026, leading to withdrawal of temporary measures undertaken by the government and normalisation of key input supplies.

However, the reescalation of the conflict since the first week of July has amplified volatility in energy prices and renewed uncertainty about supply chains, he said.

“The MPC underscored that it will maintain a close vigil and remain resolute in its commitment to align inflation with the



Even though headline inflation is projected to increase, it is primarily on account of supply side pressures caused by food and fuel, Governor Sanjay Malhotra said. REUTERS

Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F prices translating to broad-based inflation persist. After considering all factors, CPI inflation for 2026-27 is projected to be 5.0% with Q2 at 4.7%, Q3 at 5.9%, and Q4 at 5.5%. Inflation for the first quarter of 2027-28 is projected at 5.3% with risks being evenly balanced.

Core inflation is projected at 4.3% for 2026-27. Core inflation excluding precious metals is projected to be lower, though it is likely to align with core inflation from Q4.

Growth projection for FY27 lowered
The RBI lowered its real GDP growth projection for 2026-27 to 6.7% while emphasising that the recent uptick in inflation is largely being driven by food and fuel supply shocks rather than broad-based demand pressures.

Stressing that core inflation remains benign, the governor said the central bank would closely monitor whether these supply-side shocks spill over

‘No proposal to prematurely end FCNR(B) scheme’

Mumbai: RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra has said that banks are receiving robust inflows under the Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) — FCNR(B) — deposit scheme, and that there was no proposal to discontinue the scheme prematurely.

“We have got robust flows. We don’t have a target in mind, but expect healthy flows going forward,” Malhotra said.

“There is no proposal under consideration to close the scheme prematurely. As now, the deposits have ticked all boxes. We don’t have the geographical split. We had mentioned that we had a very strong external position even before these measures. This further fortifies our external position,” he said. ENS

RBI to streamline loan interest rate framework

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India has proposed a comprehensive overhaul of the regulatory framework governing interest rates across all regulated entities (REs), marking a significant step towards improving transparency, consistency and consumer protection in the country’s lending ecosystem.

The central bank announced that the proposed changes would establish a principle-based regulatory framework aimed at harmonising interest rate guidelines while addressing operational challenges in existing system. ENS

RBI set to launch ‘plastic’ notes at start of 2027-28

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 5

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) plans to launch polymer banknotes at the beginning of next financial year (FY28), and people will initially get hold of lower denomination “plastic” notes, that of Rs 10 and Rs 20.

“Polymer notes have two purposes. One, it enhances the durability. This is relevant especially for the lower denominated notes with higher velocity. These notes have been in circulation for more than 30 years in various countries, and one finds that the life is much more, around 2-4 times the life of the paper currency,” Malhotra said at the central bank’s post monetary policy press conference.

“The second purpose is to expand our capacity as the needs of the economy increase,” he said. The new notes will be checked for durability and adaptability to Indian conditions before the RBI clears it for circulation. “We will test and check on how they perform in the Indian climate, conditions, and other infrastructure that we have put in place,” Mal-



The project will start with the lower denomination notes of Rs 10 and Rs 20, that are prone to more wear and tear. REUTERS

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 tender for 3.4 crore polymer sheets for the same purpose. The tender had deemed the sheets an “immediate requirement” and once field trials were successful, “we intend to go for procurement of larger quantities of substrate across different denominations”. This would be the central bank’s second attempt at introducing plastic notes, having attempted to procure 100 crore bank notes of Rs 10 each. These were to be tried across cities under various climates like Kochi and Shimla. However, the trial was not successful due to “certain technical infirmities”.

The project will begin with the lower denomination notes of Rs 10 and Rs 20 which have “higher velocity” to change hands, and thus are prone to more wear and tear.

The RBI’s trial of plastic notes will see 100 crore pieces of Rs 10 and Rs 20 notes each being introduced, totalling Rs 3,000 crore. The RBI’s subsidiary Bharatiya Reserve Bank Note Mudran Private Limited had last month floated a global

Zero tolerance for unethical practices: HDFC Bank Chairman

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 5

HDFC BANK Part-time Chairman Rajiv Kumar on Wednesday said the bank’s Board will ensure that control functions remain fully empowered to have “zero tolerance towards any unethical practice”, which will be “dealt with speed and firmness on a case-to-case basis”. “There are no governance related concerns at the systemic level,” Kumar said

while addressing the AGM of the bank.

The Board is committed to ensure that HDFC Bank operates from the pedestal of high-est levels of corporate governance and remain anchored in integrity, transparency, accountability, and prudent stewardship, he said. He said large institutions like HDFC Bank, may encounter some issues from time to time. “It is important that these issues are addressed in a timely and trans-

parent manner,” Kumar said. He took charge as Chairman in July this year. The bank has demonstrated that it has control systems/ guard rails in place to identify deviations, if any and the oversight at committee levels are strong, Kumar said. “Let me reiterate, on my behalf and on behalf of the Board, that the bank is fundamentally strong, with a pristine balance sheet,” he said.

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

New NBFC-UL list soon, but Tata Sons listing question remains open

Akash Mandal & George Mathew
Mumbai, August 5

THE QUESTION of whether Tata Sons will pursue a stock market listing remains unresolved, with RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra saying that the Non-Banking Financial Company—Upper Layer (NBFC-UL) list will be determined under the central bank’s newly introduced principle-based classification framework.

The RBI’s thinking indicates that the revised identification methodology does not alter the Tata Group holding company’s existing regulatory standing.

Addressing queries during the post-monetary policy press conference on Wednesday, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said, “It (the upper list) is now more principle based. The list will come out very soon. But everyone knows which NBFC is in the upper layer, which is in the middle, and which is in the base.” “All those that meet the

criteria will remain in the list,” he said. On being asked if Tata Sons will remain in the list, “as we said, it is principle based, and that will continue. Let’s not ask questions related to a specific entity.” While Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata and some former Tata Sons directors are against listing the company, two trustees of Tata trusts — Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh — have argued for listing of Tata Sons.

The RBI replaced the previous methodology to determine NBFC-UL with a simple criterion that only NBFCs with assets of Rs 1 lakh crore or more will be classified as NBFC-UL. While this is a major policy shift, it’s not clear whether Tata Sons will qualify as an NBFC-UL. The RBI had recently reinstated a key definition on public funds in its revised guidelines for core investment companies (CICs) and upper layer NBFCs.

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Govt, Indian Statistical Institute faculty spar over new Bill, autonomy

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, August 5

DAYS AFTER The Indian Statistical Institute Bill, 2026, was introduced in Lok Sabha, the government and faculty members hit out at each other.

While members of the teaching staff said the new bill would lead to the loss of autonomy over academics and governance, government officials accused them of wanting to cling on to power like “local satraps”.

Addressing reporters in Delhi, faculty members from Indian Institute of Statistics-Kolkata said on Wednesday that the new bill’s proposal to replace the existing 33-member Governing Council to an 11-member Board of Governors, a change in the structure from a society to a body corporate, and the government’s expansion plans risked sending the institute into a limbo for the next five years and the Centre exerting complete control over it’s future.

Opposition party members including Saugata Roy, John Brittas, Praveen Chakravarty,

and Pratima Mondal — also present at the briefing — called for the Bill to be referred to the Standing Committee on Finance, with Roy saying the Bill was a “bureaucratic conspiracy”.

Renowned economist Prabhath Patnaik said the Bill was an “insult to PC Mahalanobis”, referring to the famed statistician who founded ISI in 1931.

Tabled in Parliament on Monday, almost one year after a draft version was made public for feedback and drew intense criticism, the new Bill would lead to the repeal of the 1959 legislation that governs India’s premier statistical institute.

According to government officials who spoke on the condition of anonymity, the new Bill is needed to bring about necessary changes that are currently being blocked or taking too long to be implemented: an increase in the number of students, autonomy for Delhi, Bengaluru, and other centres, greater accountability, and expansion of teaching programmes, among others. “It’s not in our interest to kill the institute,” said a senior

government official. “The new Bill says the Board of Governors can overrule the Academic Council where it needs to. And that’s fair.”

“They don’t want to give up any autonomy because that’s what they are comfortable with,” the official added, referring to members of ISI faculty.

ISI faculty pointed out that the composition of the proposed Board of Governors — which will replace the Governing Council as the main decision-making body — was also problematic as it excludes the Dean of Academic Affairs.

Declared as an institute of national importance in 1959, the Kolkata-headquartered ISI operates under the administrative jurisdiction of the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

It is involved in research, teaching, and application of statistics, natural sciences and social sciences and has contributed heavily to India’s official statistics.

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Centre raises Rs 31,552 cr via LIC share sale

Mumbai: The government has raised Rs 31,552 crore through an offer for sale (OFS) in Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) which closed “with an overwhelming response from both retail and institutional investors”.

“The issue was over-subscribed on both days and the government exercised its entire green shoe option. With this the public ownership of LIC has increased to 10% and it has achieved this critical milestone ahead of schedule.

“A total of 82.23 crore shares have been allocated for an amount of Rs. 31,552 crore, making it India’s largest public offering ever,” Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) said in a post on social media platform X.

The government offered to disinvest 2.5% stake in LIC with an additional 4% as the green shoe option. The proceeds will go to the central government. ENS

FULL REPORT ON

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY

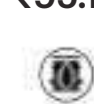
SIAM withdraws letter flagging E20 fuel quality

New Delhi: Auto industry body Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers has withdrawn a letter written to the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas that had flagged concerns over contamination of E20 fuel that caused problems with vehicles citing the need for further authentication. SIAM said the “communication in question” was part of routine and ongoing technical deliberations. PTI

India’s forex reserves hit 3-month high

Mumbai: India’s foreign exchange reserves rose to a near three-month high of \$692.9 billion as of July 31, data from the RBI showed on Wednesday. Reserves surged nearly \$10.5 billion compared to previous week, in their biggest surge since the week ended January 30. A larger pile of foreign exchange reserves gives the central bank greater capacity to defend rupee, hit by oil price volatility. REUTERS

• MARKETS

 Sensex 78,581.00 152.05 0.19%	 NIFTY 24,624.65 9.75 0.04%	 Gold ▲ ₹1,45,626	 US Dollar ▼ ₹95.13
		 Silver ▲ ₹2,24,562	 Oil ▼ \$85.19

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 4, 2026

• INDIA HAD PROHIBITED IMPORTS, DIRECT OR INDIRECT, FROM PAKISTAN FOLLOWING PAHALGAM ATTACK LAST YEAR

DRI seizes Pakistan-origin dry dates imports worth Rs 3 cr misdeclared from UAE

Aanchal Magazine
New Delhi, August 5

ENFORCING THE prohibition on imports from Pakistan, the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) has seized 364-tonne dry dates worth Rs 3 crore that were misdeclared as having originated from the UAE.

Terming it as a “significant crackdown on attempts to circumvent India’s prohibition on imports originating from Pakistan”, the Ministry of Finance in a release on Wednesday said the DRI intercepted the 13-container consignment, imported at Kandla Port, for clandestine routing and misdeclaration of

Pakistan-origin goods through third countries.

DRI is India’s apex anti-smuggling intelligence and investigation agency.

It is responsible for detecting and curbing the smuggling of contraband, combating commercial fraud related to international trade, and preventing customs duty evasion.

“In an intelligence led operation, officers of DRI intercepted 13 containers carrying 364 MT (metric tonne) of dry dates, valued at approximately Rs 3 crore, imported at Kandla Port. Investigation revealed that the goods, though declared as originating from the UAE, were in fact of Pakistan origin.

The enquiries established that the goods were first transported from Pakistan to Dubai and subsequently shifted to another set of containers before being exported to India,” the release said. The importers allegedly suppressed material facts and mis-declared the country of origin in an attempt to evade the prohibition on import of Pakistan-origin goods, the release said. “Accordingly, the entire consignment has been seized under the relevant provisions of the Customs Act, 1962,” it said.

In the wake of the terror attack in Pahalgam, Kashmir on April 22, 2025, which had killed 26 people, India had



Last week, the officers of DRI uncovered an attempt to import around 14 metric tonnes of Pakistan-origin Guggul resin. DRI

announced termination of direct trade with Pakistan, marked by the closure of the Integrated Check Post (ICP) at

Attari on April 24 last year. However, imports of Pakistani goods via third countries were still possible. To plug this loop-

hole and eliminate any possibility of Pakistani goods entering its territory, India had then imposed an immediate ban on “the direct or indirect import or transit of all goods originating in, or exported from, Pakistan” in May 2025.

India used to primarily export items such as soya bean, poultry feed, vegetables, red chillies, plastic granules and plastic yarn to Pakistan, while importing dry fruits, dates, gypsum, cement, glass, rock salt and herbs from Pakistan.

Pakistani dates used to arrive at Indian ports through transhipment hubs — particularly via the UAE, which has a free trade agreement with

India. Bilateral trade between India and the UAE was \$101.24 billion in the last financial year.

Tensions between the two countries — particularly after the 2019 Pulwama attack that had resulted in revocation of Most Favoured Nation status of Pakistan by India — had reduced total trade from \$2.41123 billion in 2018-19 to \$647.20 million in 2022-23, as per data by Ministry of Commerce and Industry. However, trade rebounded to \$1.19 billion in 2023-24, the highest during the past five years. During the last financial year, total trade has come down to barely \$258.22 million compared with \$558.24 million in 2024-25. As per the

World Bank, India-Pakistan has a trade potential of \$37 billion, the data showed. While India’s overall goods trade stands at \$430 billion, the comparable number for Pakistan stands at roughly \$100 billion.

As per the estimates by Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) from last year, \$10 billion worth of Indian goods reach Pakistan via the transhipment hub routes. Last week, the officers of DRI uncovered an attempt to import around 14 metric tonnes of Pakistan-origin Guggul resin valued approximately at Rs 1.4 crore through misdeclaration of description and country of origin at Tuticorin port.

Russian missiles kill 17 in Kyiv as air defences falter

Reuters
Kyiv, August 5

RUSSIA FIRED dozens of ballistic missiles at Kyiv and the surrounding region on Wednesday, killing at least 17 people and destroying warehouses and logistics centres of major retailers, Ukrainian officials said, as a shortage of air defence missiles leaves Ukraine vulnerable.

Multiple explosions ripped through the area during the night, and fires lit up the dark skies over the Ukrainian capital, which has come under missile attack every three to four days in recent weeks as Russia has escalated its air war. "Ballistic missile interceptors could have saved the lives of those killed today," President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Telegram. Ukrainian air defences

downed nearly 90% of the 115 drones launched by Russia but failed to intercept a single one of the 24 ballistic missiles and four Zircon cruise missiles, the air force said. Russia's Defence Ministry said it struck seven logistics centres in Kyiv and the region, accusing them of being used to store or distribute dual-use goods and drone components.

Officials said more than 40 people were injured in the attack. At a commuter station in the Kyiv suburb of Brovary, seven bodies were scattered across the platform.

"People missed their last train. For now, we know of eight dead," said Volodymyr Bigun, head of Brovary's local administration, adding that five logistics warehouses had been hit in the district, including food retailer Fozzy. "The enemy continues to



Firefighters at the site of a Russian missile strike in Kyiv region on Wednesday. REUTERS

hit civilian infrastructure."

Epicentr, Ukraine's largest home improvement and DIY retail chain, said two key logistics facilities and a factory were

destroyed. "This is a deliberate attack on Ukrainian manufacturing, logistics, jobs and the country's ability to recover," Epicentr said in a statement.

Russian drone factory director hurt in car blast

Moscow: The director of a factory supplying drones to the Russian military was badly wounded when his car exploded, news reports said Wednesday.

The state *Tass* and *RIA Novosti* agencies said that Vladimir Tkachuk was hospitalized in grave condition following the explosion late Tuesday in Bolshoy Istok just outside Yekaterinburg, 1,400 kilometers east of Moscow. It didn't give details of the explosion or say who could be responsible. There was no immediate comment from the authorities. **REUTERS**

TRUMP: TALKS MOVING NICELY... STRAIT WILL OPEN VERY SOON

Hormuz deal seeks to give Iran control over inbound ships

US army running low on long-range missiles: Report

Reuters
Dubai, Riyadh, August 5

A PROPOSED deal between Iran and Oman would give Tehran control over ships entering the Gulf through the Strait of Hormuz, a senior Iranian source told *Reuters* Wednesday, in one of the biggest concessions yet to Iran.

Despite the apparent step towards yielding to Iranian demands, the sources pushed back against assertions by US President Donald Trump that a deal reopening the strait was imminent. "The concession has already been made regarding some form of control over Hormuz," the source said.

There were still details to be determined about how "control" would be defined, with Gulf negotiators insisting regional countries supervise inspections of ships, and that any payment of fees be voluntary.

The senior Iranian source said the text of an agreement already on the table envisioned Iran having control of ships heading into the Gulf through the strait, and one of the main sticking points was what role Iran would also have over ships



Shiite worshippers carry a portrait of late Iran leaders Ayatollah Ali Khamenei and Ayatollah Khomeini in Karbala, Iraq, on Tuesday. AP

heading in opposite direction.

Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei described the negotiations between Tehran and Muscat as "professional" and "moving forward". "The two sides had reached a mutual understanding on the geographical parameters of the route under discussion," he said.

He said if third parties did not obstruct the process, a joint statement between the two countries was in the final stages of review and drafting.

US officials have repeatedly insisted that they would never accept any arrangement that lets Iran control access to the world's most important trade route for energy supplies. But Trump and senior officials in his administration have said in recent days that a deal is imminent to end war.

There was no immediate reply from Washington about any proposed agreement.

US commanders advised Trump in July that they were running low on supplies of some munitions. *Reuters* reported Tuesday the US Army had used up nearly all of its long-range precision missiles.

Trump told *Fox News* talks were "moving along nicely" and "an all-day negotiation" had taken place on Tuesday. The Strait of Hormuz "is going to be open very soon", Trump added.

Meanwhile, Baghaei said there was no plan for the foreign minister or the parliament speaker to travel to Qatar or Pakistan during the weekend, adding Tehran continued to stay in contact with the two countries that are "continuing their efforts to reduce tensions".

Pak ex-minister, held in UK in sexual assault case, now on bail, wins in PoK

Ahmed was arrested in Manchester in 2024 for trafficking: Guardian report

Press Trust of India
London, August 5

A FORMER Pakistani state minister, arrested on sexual assault charges in the UK, contested and won an election in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK) while on police bail, according to a British media report published Wednesday.

Rukhsar Ahmed, 62, was arrested at Manchester Airport in 2024 on suspicion of rape and trafficking children in care as part of a grooming gang scandal,

The Guardian reported.

Last week, he was reportedly "re-elected" in the so-called legislative assembly in PoK, after being out of office for five years.

Ahmed was expected to report to the Greater Manchester Police last month under his bail conditions, but reportedly failed to comply. The British police reportedly wanted to restrict Ahmed's ability to travel abroad as part of his bail conditions, but a court rejected the tougher measures two years ago.

Ahmed is affiliated with Pak-

istan Muslim League-Nawaz (PML-N). He headed several ministries over time from 2006 until he lost his seat in 2021.

The politician was recently pictured on social media campaigning at various "election gatherings" in PoK's Mirpur.

In a Facebook post on Wednesday, Ahmed shared images of his meeting with federal minister Amir Muqam.

"Ahmed was arrested at Manchester airport on 18 July 2024 in relation to past child sexual abuse allegations...." *The Guardian* said. The ongoing probe against Ahmed relates to allegations from several women about sexual abuse of children at care homes in the early 1990s.

Trump chopper came too close to a passenger plane

Reuters
Washington, August 5

THE FEDERAL Aviation Administration said a military helicopter carrying President Donald Trump on Tuesday was briefly too close to a passenger jet departing Reagan Washington National Airport but said the US president was not in danger.

The incident raises serious questions about why the passenger airplane was allowed to depart while Marine One was nearby, a time when commercial traffic is typically halted. Following a January 2025 crash between a military helicopter and a commercial jet that killed 67 people, the FAA barred

mixed helicopter and jet traffic around the airport.

"Based on our preliminary safety review, there was momentary loss of separation after which the aircraft continued to move away from one another," the FAA said on Wednesday.

Trump's Marine One helicopter took off from the White House Tuesday afternoon, but air-traffic controllers had not halted commercial flights at Reagan National as required under a policy set last year following the collision, two sources told Reuters.

FAA rules require aircraft to remain separated by at least 1.5 miles horizontally and 500 feet vertically around airports.

Hasina's former home now 'July Mass Uprising Memorial Museum'

Press Trust of India
Dhaka, August 5

AMID TIGHTENED nationwide security, Bangladesh on Wednesday inaugurated a memorial museum to commemorate the victims of violence during the anti-government protests in 2024 that toppled Sheikh Hasina's government.

Prime Minister Tarique Rahman inaugurated the 'July Mass Uprising Memorial Museum' at Ganabhaban, prime minister's official residence during Hasina's regime, coinciding with the day she fled to India on August 5, 2024.

"The killers in the anti-fascist movement will be tried in a transparent, impartial and credible manner following the due process of law," Rahman said in a brief address while unveiling the museum's plaque.

"Justice for every crime is essential to ensure rule of law" Rahman said as the Interim government chief Muhammad Yunus stood beside him.

The PM announced that government institutions would be named after slain activists of the uprising and those who were killed during the rule of Hasina's Awami League since 2009.

According to a February 2025



Bangladesh PM Tarique Rahman visits the memorial museum for victims of the July 2024 mass uprising at the former residence of ousted leader Sheikh Hasina, in Dhaka on Wednesday. PTI

UN rights office report, up to 1,400 people were killed between July 15 and August 15 last year, the period dubbed as the 'July Uprising,' as Hasina's government ordered a security crackdown on protesters.

Three days after Hasina fled to India following the widespread protests against her government over a controversial quota system in jobs, Yunus took over as the chief adviser of the Interim government.

A special tribunal set up by Yunus' government gave Hasina a death sentence in November 2025 on charges of "crimes against humanity" and "genocide."

His interim regime, under an executive order, also banned Hasina's Awami League that has been in power for many terms since 1971. The decision was endorsed by Rahman's Bangladesh Nationalist Party government after February 12 elections.

Bangladesh is commemorating August 5 as the 'July Mass Uprising Day' with the government and political parties organising various programmes to honour the sacrifices of those, including students, who took to the streets against what they described as Hasina's "misrule and autocracy," state news agency *Bangladesh Sangbad Sangstha*.

• BRIEFLY

THE VATICAN

Pope's first Latin America trip to include Uruguay, Argentina, Peru



Pope Leo XIV at St Peter's Basilica. AP

POPE LEO XIV will make his first trip to Latin America as pontiff in November, returning to a region where he spent much of his ministry, with visits to Uruguay, Argentina and Peru, the Vatican announced Wednesday. The November 6-17 trip will include stops in Montevideo, Paysandú and Florida in Uruguay; Buenos Aires, Córdoba and Luján in Argentina; and Lima, Chiclayo, Cusco and Pucallpa in Peru. The visit is especially significant because of Leo's longstanding ties to Peru.

The first US-born pope spent decades there as a missionary and church leader and served as bishop of Chiclayo from 2015 to 2023. He also holds Peruvian citizenship. AP

UNITED KINGDOM

Woman arrested for stabbing four at Covent Garden

LONDON POLICE said Wednesday that a woman has been arrested after four people were stabbed in Covent Garden, a busy central area popular with visitors. The Metropolitan Police said four men, aged 34, 39, 42, and 52 were found with stab wounds and that a 47-year-old woman was arrested on suspicion of possession of an offensive weapon and assault. The injured were taken to a major trauma center on nearby Endell Street later in the afternoon. AP

GERMANY

Explosive drone found at Leipzig air cargo hub

GERMANY OPENED a counterterrorism investigation Wednesday after an explosive-laden drone was found near a runway at Leipzig/Halle airport overnight, prompting the closure of parts of one of Europe's biggest cargo hubs. Investigators were examining what a DHL cargo plane had struck in the air after being diverted from the airport in eastern Germany during disruption. Workers discovered the drone in a restricted cargo area near runway. REUTERS



People view the wreckage of a WWII German warship that emerged due to the drought in Danube, near Prahovo, Serbia, on Tuesday. AP

As drought drains the Danube, World War II warships resurface

Associated Press
Prahovo, August 5

WATER LEVELS on the Danube River, second longest in Europe, have dropped so low because of drought that the hulks of dozens of World War II German battleships are emerging into view.

They are a curious distraction from the summer heat crisis. The Danube's record low water levels also have forced power plants to the brink of shutting down, and governments across Central and Eastern Europe are taking steps to conserve electricity.

In the middle of the river separating Serbia and Romania near the Serbian port of Prahovo, a rusty hull is now visible along with a broken mast where the Nazi flag used to fly.

The ships, some still laden with weapons, belonged to Nazi Germany's Black Sea fleet

that the Germans deliberately sank as they retreated from Romania and as Soviet forces advanced deeper into Europe near the end of the war.

Historians say up to 200 German warships were scuttled in September 1944 near Prahovo in the Danube gorge as they came under Soviet fire. The idea behind the deliberate sinking was to slow down the Soviet advance in the Balkans. But Nazi Germany surrendered months later, in May 1945.

The sight of the old warships is a reminder that the Serbian government, with European Union financial support, has long been trying to do something about them.

Some were removed from the river by Communist Yugoslav authorities, but most have remained because of the explosives they carried.

Progressive El-Sayed wins crucial Michigan primary

Reuters
Michigan, August 5

THE DEMOCRATIC Party's progressive wings scored a high-profile victory on Wednesday when Abdul El-Sayed won the party's US Senate nomination in Michigan, giving its anti-establishment message a boost ahead of November's midterm elections.

El-Sayed, a doctor whose campaign focused on healthcare, the economy and an end to unconditional military aid to Israel, was the first progressive to win a statewide primary in a state that President Donald Trump carried in 2024.

He will face Republican former congressman Mike Rogers in November.



US Senate Democratic candidate Abdul El-Sayed

The vote, billed as a defining test of the party's direction, became an election-night cliffhanger between El-Sayed and US Representative Haley Stevens, a moderate supported by Democratic leaders and pro-Israel groups. "My hope is that our democracy will never be the same," El-Sayed said at a press conference on Wednesday. "From here on out, we can always point and say, 'No, this is the people's democracy, and we will always own it.'"

Peace with Kurdish rebels: Turkey takes historic step

Reuters
Anakra, August 5

TURKEY'S RULING alliance submitted a draft law to parliament on Wednesday meant to achieve peace with the Kurdistan Workers' Party (PKK) in part by protecting many former militants from prosecution and suspending prison sentences for some others.

The draft law marks a leap towards ending an insurgency that has killed more than 40,000 people since 1984, sown deep discord at home and fuelled violence across borders in Iraq and Syria. It aims to end the decades-old conflict in part by facilitating the return to Turkey of potentially thousands of former PKK

militants and civilians from hideouts in northern Iraq.

It is backed by a majority of lawmakers and is expected to pass the assembly later this week, but polls show some scepticism it will bring lasting peace.

Turkey's national security council would verify the group's disarmament and a committee including the vice president, some ministers and head of the MIT intelligence agency would oversee the militants' surrender and disarmament under the bill.

The committee would inform a parliamentary commission on the proceedings of the process. The bill would suspend prison sentences for those convicted of PKK membership or aiding the group.

• HOT AIR IS THINNER THAN COOL AIR, MAKING IT HARDER FOR A PLANE'S WINGS TO ATTAIN LIFT AND FOR JET ENGINES TO GENERATE THE THRUST FOR TAKEOFF

Rising temperatures could keep more flights from taking off on time

Rio Yamat & M K Wildeman
Las Vegas, August 5

AIRLINE PASSENGERS know to expect possible flight delays when weather forecasts call for thunderstorms, heavy snow or strong wind. The omens are less obvious on a hot summer day with clear skies.

Yet extreme heat also disrupts flights and travel plans. On the hottest days, thinner air can make it harder for aircraft to get off the ground safely. Airlines may have to lighten the load by removing passengers or cargo, or carrying less fuel.

The snag is well known at airports in desert climates around the world, from the US South-

west to West Asia.

But even less extreme heat can create similar challenges at airports with higher elevations or shorter runways. Researchers say human-caused climate change could make such disruptions more common.

With heat waves searing parts of the US and Europe this summer, Las Vegas illustrated how extreme heat can interfere with air travel. American Airlines offered compensation to customers who voluntarily gave up their seats on a July 24 flight from Harry Reid International Airport after temperatures reached 47 degrees Celsius.

The airline described reducing a plane's weight as a standard



A Turkish Airlines Boeing 777 takes off from Hatay Airport in Turkey. FILE

industry practice in hot-weather destinations when conditions require it to ensure a safe takeoff.

The explanation comes down to physics. Hot air is thinner than cool air, making it harder for a

plane's wings to generate lift and for jet engines to generate the thrust needed for takeoff, explained Ross Aimer, a retired United Airlines captain and CEO of Aero Consulting Experts.

"There is a science behind all this," Aimer said. "You can't deny the science of flight and what it takes for an airplane to operate."

Aimer likens the effect of high temperatures on airplane performance to athletes competing at high altitude. During this year's World Cup, foreign teams competing in Mexico City — located more than 7,300 feet above sea level — had to contend with thinner air that can leave players fatigued more quickly. "Just like

human beings, jet engines require lots of cool, dense air to perform well," Aimer said.

Before every departure, pilots and airlines determine whether an aircraft can safely take off by calculating several key factors, including weight, airport's elevation and outside temperature, said Alan Price, a retired Delta Air Lines captain.

Aircraft at higher elevations are already operating in thinner air, so temperatures don't have to climb as high to affect takeoff performance. Runway length also matters. Airliners need room to build enough speed for takeoff when temperatures soar, and shorter runways leave less distance to do that, Price said.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I Rashmi Shukla W/O, Pradeep Shukla R/o Flat No 202 Tower 3 Parsvnath Prestige-2 (Srishti), Sector 93, Noida have changed my name to Rashmi Pradeep Shukla. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Rashmi Pradeep Shukla for all future purposes. 0040870120-1

I, Altaf Ahmed alias Altaf, S/o Rafatullah, R/o 2881/82, Gali Captain Wali,Kucha Chellan, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Altaf Ahmed Qureshi, permanently. 0040870166-5

I Naresh Aggarwal S/o Ram Pratap, R/o- C-1/13,Phase-1, Budh Vihar,Delhi,have changed my name to Naresh Kumar Dadri. 0040870051-1

I, Nitin Gupta S/o Mukesh Gupta R/o Flat No. - I-204, JM Orchid, Plot No. Gh-01/C, Sector-76, Noida, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh- 201301, have changed my name to Jatin Gupta. 0071052159-1

I, VIRENDER KUMAR S/o- Raj Kumar R/o-15/19-B, Moti Nagar New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to VIRENDER KUMAR SETH, for all purposes. 0040870169-4

I Dally Salwan D/o Ashwani Kumar Sharma and W/o Balraj Salwan R/o Saket Callipolis B604 Sarjapur Road, Bengaluru, Karnataka - 560035, have changed my name to Dolly Salwan 0071051941-2

I Shashi Gaur W/O, Deepak Kumar R/o Flat No.54, Sector A Pocket C Vasant Kunj, New Delhi 110070 have changed my name to Shashi Sharma for all purposes vide affidavit No. IN-DL6804442639112Y dated 03/08/2026 at Delhi. 0040870135-1

I, SONIA @ SONIA KAPOOR @ SONIA AHUJA /O RAVI AHUJA, R/O-5A/7, GROUND-FLOOR, TOOT SARAI, MALVIYA NAGAR, DELHI-110017, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SONIA KAPOOR AHUJA, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE 0040870046-1

I, Chokhe Lal S/o Beeda Ram, R/o 1958, Gali Kumahar Wali, Malka Ganj, Delhi-110007, Changed my minor son name from VANSH to VANSH KUMAR. 0040870173-2

I, BRIJESH KUMAR VASHISHTHA S/o Devi Ram Vashishtha R/o H.No-211, Block, H, Karam Pura, West Delhi-110015, have changed my minor son's name from Maan aged 11 years to MANAS VASHISHTHA forever 0071052166-1

J. Satish Kumar S/o Girdhari Lal R/o Plot No-Z-101-A & Z. 101-B, UGF, Z-Block, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, have changed my name to Satish Harjai. 0040870168-1

I, Anisha Aggarwal Suneja, W/o Saurabh Suneja, R/o D-3/3386, Vasant Kunj, New-Delhi-110070, have changed my name to Anisha Aggarwal, for all purposes. 0040870169-6

I, Gagan Deep Chhabra, R/o J-1870, Ground Floor, C.R.Park, New Delhi-110019, My son correct name is Shauryaveer Chhabra but his name is mentioned as Shaurya Veer Chhabra in his Aadhar Card. 0040870054-1

I hitherto known as Rajni alias Rajni Meena, wife of Rajesh Kumar residing at D-9A, Mansarover Garden, New Delhi - 110015 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Rajni Meena. 0130067658-1

I, Arun Kumar Yadav, S/o Ajay Pal Yadav, R/o-RZ-16, Sayed Nangloi, Paschim Vihar, Delhi-110087, have changed my name to Arun Yadav, Permanently 0040870086-2

I, Israj Jan Ansari W/O Hanif Ansari R/O H.No.1738, Plot.No.12, Dayalpuram, Naubasta, Kanpur, Kanpur Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-208021, have changed my name to Israj Jahan. 0040870170-2

It is for general information that I, Dharmesh Kumar Agrawal, S/o Indralal Agrawal, R/O-A-314, Ganga-Tower, Ashoka City, Govardhan-Chauraha, NH-2, Mathura, PO-Mathura, Dist:-Mathura, Uttar Pradesh-281001, declare that name of mine and my father have been wrongly-written as Dharmeshkumar Agarwal and Indralal Agrawal in my Passport-No.J1577985.The actual name of mine and my father are Dharmesh Kumar Agrawal and Indralal Agrawal and my date of birth is wrongly-mentioned in my passport was.05.08.1978, however my correct-date of birth is-01.08.1977. 0040870046-3

I, Mosin C/o Shafiuallah Khan, A-11, SF, Khajoori Road, Jogabai Extn., Jamia Nagar, Delhi-25, have changed my name to MOHSIN WRISHA. 0071052172-1

I, MD Irfan, S/o Syed Abdul Mannan, R/o 816, Chatta Sheikh Mangloo, Jama Masjid, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Syed Mohammad Irfan, permanently. 0040870166-2

I, SUNNY S/o-Rajbir Singh R/o: Flat-722, Block-17, Delhi Government Employee Residential Complex, Sector-3, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075, Have Changed My Name to SUNNY SINGH. 0071052153-1

I, Avantika Puri W/o Puneet Mehra have changed my name to Avantika Mehra as per documents 0071052130-1

I, hitherto known as POOJA BHARTI, W/O-AMIT residing at, A-34/U/G/F, Back Side, Jeevan-Park, Uttam Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110059, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as POOJA SETHI. 0040870169-8

I, Rajesh Kumar S/o Ramveer R/o KH.No. 123, Street No.13, Village Wazirabad, Delhi-110084 have changed my minor son name from DIVYANSH to DIVYANSH CHOUDHARY for all future purposes. 0071052152-1

I, Mohammad Ajmal R/o-832, Khalapar-8, Muzaffarnagar, UP have changed my daughter name from Atufa to ATUFA AJMAL. 0071052212-2

I, DILSAD S/O MUKHTAR AHMED R/O 2042 GALI KALYAN PURA TURAKMAN GATE DELHI-6 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD DILSHAD. 0040870169-1

I Rishikesh Kaushik, S/o Sh. Sachida Nand Tiwary, R/o B-501, Saffron, Niho, Scottish Garden, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad-201014 have changed the name of my minor son from Evyavan Kaushik to Evyavan Mishra Kaushik for all purposes. 0040870048-1

I, Kailash W/o Om Prakkash R/o K2/11 Madangir Dr ambedkar Nagar Delhi-110062, have changed my name Krishna for all purposes. 0040870173-6

I, NADIM AHMAD S/o WAZIR AHMAD R/o-4, Toot Sarai, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-17 have changed my name to NADEEM AHMAD. 0071052185-1

I, Vijay Kumar S/o Late Sh. Mange Ram Dahir, R/o H.No.2178, Sector 23, Sonipat, Haryana-131001 have changed my name from Vijay Kumar to Vijay Kumar Dahiya for all future purposes. 0040870078-1

I, Mashkoora Khattoon alias Mushkora, W/o Altaf Ahmed Qureshi, R/o 2881/82, Gali Captain Wali, Kucha Chellan, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Maskkura Qureshi, permanently. 0040870166-4

I, Sapna, D/O Shispal Yadav, W/O-Abhijit Nath, R/O J-502, French- Apartment, Sector-16B, Greater Noida West, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-201308, have changed my name to Sapna Yadav, for all future purposes. 0040870169-10

I, Kripal singh S/o Mela Singh R/o Bazar-1 Palia Kalan Palia kheri UP-262902 changed my name to Kripal Singh 0040870173-4

I, RAHUL GARG, R/O D-1803 M2K VICTORIA GARDEN AZADPUR DELHI-110033 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME HREYANSH GARG TO SHIVAY GARG. 0040870169-3

I, Arvind Kumar Sharma, s/o late Krishna Chander Sharma, Flat No.1202, tower 7, Ace Parkway, Sector-150, Noida, 201310, have changed my name from Arvind Sharma to Arvind Kumar Sharma. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Arvind Kumar Sharma for all future purposes. 0040870048-3

I, Rani Khan W/o Mohammad Miyan R/o Mo Peerzadgan, Garh Pukhta Rural, Shamli, UP have changed my name to Rani. 0071052190-1

I Mohammad Zahid Ali S/o, Khalil Ahmed R/o H.No 55 Gali No.1 New Ganes Park have changed my name to Mohd Zahid. 0040870132-1

I, Nida, W/o Gulfam Danish, R/o-632, Rang Mahal Ground Floor, Near Chandni Mahal Police Station, Ganj Mir Khan, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Nida Qureshi, permanently. 0040870166-6

I, Urmila Aggarwal W/o Naresh Kumar Dadri R/o-C-1/13, Phase-1, Budh Vihar, Delhi, have changed my name to Urmila Dadri. 0040870051-2

I, Narendra, S/O-Jagdish Rai Chawla, R/O H.NO.94, New Lahore Shastri Nagar Gandhi-Nagar East, Delhi 110031, have changed my name to Narendar chawla for all purposes 0040870173-1

I Kurshida Begam Alias Khurshid Begam Alias Khurshida Begam Alias Khurshidan D/o Masuiddun Khan and W/o Hashmat Ali Khan R/o C-13/674, Surender Colony Part-1, Jharoda Mazra, Burari, Delhi-110084, have changed my name to Khurshidan. Amend to read DOB AS -01.01.1962 FOR Age -34 as mentioned in PPO. 0071052164-1

I, SHIVAM, S/o RUKAM PAL, R/o-ADD: FLAT NO.2, FIRST FLOOR, KH NO 1151/3, PLOT NO 893/39, VICTORIA APPT,WARD-8, MEHRAULI NEW DELHI-110030, have changed my name to SHIVAM CHOUGHAN. 0040870169-5

I, Manswini Sharma D/o Hari Dutt Sharma, R/o A-2, Flat Number-606, Suncity 76 Avenue, sector 76, Gurgaon-122004, have changed my name to Manaswini Sharma. 0071052131-1

I, Sattyaki Majumder, S/O- Joyanta Kumar Majumder, R/O-304, Shara-Kunj, C-58/18, Sector-62, Noida, Gautam-Budh Nagar, UP-201301, india have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Swetabjo Majumder. 0040870169-9

I, Anam Begum, W/o Abdul Ahad, R/o 1956, Gali Baradari, Kucha Chellan, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002, have changed my name to Anam, permanently. 0040870166-1

I, Yashvi Sugumar D/o J. Sugumar R/o J/4/96, Khirki Extension, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-110017 have inform that my father's correct name is Joseph Sugumar but in my educational certificates and other documents my father's name has been mentioned as J. Sugumar. J. Sugumar and Joseph Sugumar both are one and same person. 0071052215-1

0040870049-1

I, Sharad Kumar Singh S/o Om Pal Singh Rathor R/o House No. 74, Second Floor, Inder Enclave, Paschim Vihar, Delhi - 110087 have changed my name to RUDRA RATHORE for all purposes. 0130067657-1

I hitherto known as Sunit Kumar, S/O-Rishabh Kumar Jain R/O 58, Delhi Administration Flats, Nimri Colony, Ashok Vihar, Phase-4, Delhi-110052, have changed my name, from Sunit Kumar to Sunit Kumar Jain and shall hereafter be known as Sunit Kumar Jain. 0040870170-1

It is for general information that I, Lavi Agrawal, D/o Dharmesh Agrawal, R/O-A-314, Ganga-Tower, Ashoka City, Govardhan-Chauraha NH-2, Mathura Banger, PO-Krishna Nagar, Dist-Mathura, Uttar Pradesh-281003, declare that name of mine, my father and mother have been wrongly written as Lavi Agarwal Dharmeshkumar Agarwal and Manju Agarwal in my passport-No.J1577986.The actual name of mine, my Father and my Mother are Lavi Agrawal, Dharmesh Agrawal and Manju Agrawal. 0040870046-2

I, RASHMEET W/O Rahul Kumar R/o H.No.88-C, Gali No.5, Near Sai Mandir, East Laxmi Market, Shakarpur, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to RASHMEET KAUR permanently. 0040870173-3

I Charvi Khanna D/o Rajeev Khanna R/o 17/13, Second Floor, Near Rock Garden, PO-West Patel Nagar, Distt-Central Delhi, Delhi - 110008 , have changed my name to Shweta Khanna 0071052168-1

I, Sunil Kumar Kandwal S/o Manik Lal R/o Flat No.1425, Block-C, Gaur Global Village, Crossing Republik, Ghaziabad, UP-201016 have changed my name from Sunil Kumar to Sunil Kumar Kandwal for all future purposes. 0040870064-1

I, MOHD SHOAB S/O MOHD SALEEM R/O 790, THIRD FLOOR, GURU RAM DASS NAGAR EXT, LAXMI NAGAR, DIST: EAST DELHI, DELHI - 110092 That both the names MOHD SHOAB and MOHAMMAD SHOAB are one and same person 0071052128-1

I, BHOOPENDRA SINGH alias BHOOPENDRA SINGH RAWAT, S/O DIGAMBER SINGH, R/o-80/41A, Second-Floor Malviya-Nagar South-Delhi Delhi-110017, have changed my name to BHOOPENDRA SINGH RAWAT. 0040870169-7

I, Md EHRAZ ZAFAR S/O ZAFAR ALAM R/o 134/76, MITHILA APARTMENT, PLOT NO-76, PATPARGANJ, I.P. EXTENSION, DELHI, 110092 have changed my name to MOHAMMAD EHRAZ ZAFAR for all purposes. 0071052151-1

I, Mukesh Kumar Aggarwal S/o Umesh Chand Aggarwal R/o F-5, Plot No -2, BM Rohtagi Apartment, Ram Kishore Road, Civil Lines, Delhi - 110054, have changed my name to Mukesh Aggarwal permanently. 0040867726-2

I, Prity W/O Vishal Mehra R/O BR 35-C, Shalimar Bagh, New Delhi-110088, declare that Prity and Priti Mehra both are names of one and the same person. 0040870170-3

It is for general information that I, Swati Agrawal, D/o Dharmesh Agrawal, R/o-Ashoka City, Govardhan-Chauraha NH-2, Mathura Banger, PO-Krishna Nagar, Dist-Mathura, Uttar Pradesh-281004, declare that name of mine my father and my mother have been wrongly-written as Swati Agrawal, Dharmeshkumar Agrawal and Manju Agrawal in my passport-No.J1578016.The actual name of mine, my father and my mother is Swati Agrawal, Dharmesh Agrawal and Manju Agrawal and my date of birth is wrongly-mentioned in my passport was.23.10.2005, however my correct-date of birth is-28.10.2005. 0040870046-4

I, MONIKA KHANNA YADAV, W/O Dinesh Yadav R/O WZ-92E, Todapur, P.O. Pusa, Inderpuri, Delhi-110012, have changed my name to MONIKA KHANNA permanently 0040870173-5

I, Abdur Rehman S/o Shafiuallah Khan, A-11, SF, Khajoori Road, Jogabai Extn., Jamia Nagar, Delhi-25, have changed my name to ABDUR REHMAN KHAN. 0071052175-1

I, ABHISHEK RAIKWAR S/O MR. HARDAYAL R/O S-126/554, KANAK DURGA COLONY, R K PURAM, SECTOR-12, DELHI-110022, I HAVE CHANGE MY NAME CHHOTU TO ABHISHEK RAIKWAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSE. 0040870067-1

I, Yasmen, R/o Syed Mohammad Irfan, R/o 816, Chatta Sheikh Mangloo, Jama Masjid, Delhi-110006, have changed my name to Yasmeen Begum, permanently. 0040870166-3

I, NAIEM AHMAD S/O JAN MOHAMMAD R/O S-19, Batla House, Jamia Nagar, Delhi-25 have changed my name to NAIEM AHMAD. 0071052187-1

I, Yogendra Kumar, S/O Shri Brahmopal Singh, R/O Village Kirachpur alias Kailashpur, Greater Noida, District Gautam Buddha Nagar (U.P.) have changed my daughter name from SAUMYAA to SAUMYAA BHATI for all future purposes. 0071052215-1

I, Sanjeev Kumar/Sanjeev Nagpal, S/o Ram Lal Nagpal, R/o H.No.638, Sector-15, Faridabad, Haryana, have changed my name to Sanjeev Kumar Nagpal, for all purposes. 0040870169-2

I Rishikesh Kaushik, S/o Sh. Sachida Nand Tiwary, R/o B-501, Saffron, Niho, Scottish Garden, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad-201014 have changed the name of my minor son from Drisana Kaushik to Drisana Mishra Kaushik for all purposes. 0040870048-2

LOST & FOUND

I, UMMEED SINGH, S/O SH. ATAR SINGH, R/O-E-593-B, West Vinod-Nagar, Mandawali Fazalpur, East-Delhi, Delhi-110092, have lost some of my original property documents such as GPA, Agreement to Sell, Money-Receipt etc, of Property bearing-No.E-593-B, KH.No.829, WEST VINOD-NAGAR, MANDAWALI FAZALPUR, DELHI-110092. Finder may contact M.No.9712780168. 0040870169-11

Lost my original DDA FDR (File No.F16(8029)/2012/RHN, Application No.124085, Priority No.15236) of Rohini LIG Scheme D-3/620, Sector-29, Rohini, Delhi-110085 in the name of Satwant Singh. Finder may Contact-Harjeet Singh at-K-57, Shyam Nagar, Mukharjee Park, Delhi-18 0040870109-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN, that my clientest Smt. SADHANA Wo Late Shri Santosh Kumar residents of House No. B-885, Second Floor, Rishi Nagar, Rani Bagh, New Delhi-110034 have severed their relation and commenced with her Son namely Mr. Tushar S. Kumar and his wife Smt. Vidhi Ambesh both resident of House No. B-885, Second Floor, Rishi Nagar, Rani Bagh, New Delhi-110034 and she has disowned and disbarred both of them from all her movable-immovable properties/assets, as they have become dishonest, disobedient and unfaithful towards my clientest. My clientest shall not be concerned and shall not be responsible in respect of any of their liabilities, dealings, acts, transactions, proceedings etc. If anybody shall deal with them, the same shall be on his/her/their own risk and responsibility. My clientest shall not be responsible in any manner whatsoever. Sd/- Akshika Mahavir (Advocate) Ch. No. S-19, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054

TO BE KNOWN TO ALL, Ramesh Kumar Sharma S/o Tilak Raj Sharma R/o AE-58 BLOCK A/ SHALIMAR BAGH, DELHI, 110088. Have applied for certified copies in DDA. The original documents (i.e. Allotment Letter, DDA Handing over Possession Letter, Site Possession Slip & Bank Challans etc. of free hold plot/Property No. 58, land measuring 84.00sq mtrs. Block AE, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi-110088. Vide DDA File No F16(25 3275/LSB(R) has been lost. An FIR Lt. No.510124/2026 dated 09/08/2026 to this effect has been lodged in P.S.Crimine Branch, Delhi. Any persons/claiming any right, interest, having any objection or found in possession of original documents, may write/contact with above named person at Address/Phone: 9646562558 within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. The person claiming any right, interest, objection with respect to this property, can personally inform or write to Deputy Director(LAB)-Resd or Director (LAB) Resd., Delhi Development Authority, Vikas Sadan, New Delhi-110023

THIS IS TO BRING TO NOTICE OF ALL CONCERNED that my client Sh. Vivek Arora S/o Sh. S. S. Arora, R/o H-4, Gali No.1, Chander Nagar, Delhi-110051 has severed all his relations with his wife namely Monika Arora and his son namely Shivansh Arora both resident of H. No. 201, 2nd Floor, Ashok Vihar, Phase-I, Delhi-110052 from his all movable-immovable properties/assets. The above said Monika & Shivansh both misbehaved & ill-treated my client as both were of legal age. Thus, my client has disowned them from all his movable & immovable properties/assets. Any person dealing with them shall do so at his/her own risk, cost & consequences. My client will not be responsible for their any act or omissions. Sd/- VINOD KUMAR SINGH (ADVOCATE) Ch. No. 72B, 1ST & 2ND FLOOR, TIS HAZARI WINGS, TIS HAZARI COURTS, DELHI-110054

General Public is hereby informed that my clients Sharangit Singh Bhargi S/o, Kishan Singh & Smt. Sarabjeet Kaur W/o. Sharangit Singh Bhargi both R/o WZ-58, Gali No-9, Pitthi Park, MBS Nagar, Tikla Nagar, West Delhi-110018 hereby sever all their relations with their son namely Harinderjit Singh Bhargi & daughter Simranjeet Kaur Bhargi. Due to his misbehavior and disobedience towards my clients, hereby I disown and disbarred them from their all movable and immovable properties forever. Any person dealing with them shall be doing so at his/her/their own risk and responsibility. My clients will not be responsible for their any act and deeds. PRADEEP KUMAR (ADVOCATE) Off. SR-Ind B, Distt. Centre, Janak Puri, N.O.-58

It is for general information that I, NEERJA SHARMA KHANNA EX W/O ARUN SHARMA D/O ASHWANI SHARMA R/o D-77/B, MOTI NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110015 declare that I got divorce from my husband Vide Court Decree No.HMA No.1203/2020 dated 23-10-2020. Further I remained with VAIBHAV KHANNA vide marriage Registration No. 90730000222051 dated 17-06-2025. Henceforth, name of my minor daughter namely INAYA VASHISHT aged 09 years may be known as INAYA KHANNA. Further the name of father of my daughter may be known as VAIBHAV KHANNA for all future purposes.

THIS IS TO INFORM General Public that my clients Rakesh Kumar, S/o Sh. Shiv Singh and Sunita Devi, Wo Sh. Rakesh Kumar, both R/o Quarter No. 8-797, NTPC Township, Vidyalaynagar, District Gautam Budh Nagar, 201008, Uttar Pradesh do hereby sever their son Sh. Lakshya Chaudhary (currently posted as Major), r/o Kumaon Officers' Mess, Kumaon Junction, Shimla Vihar Military Station, New Delhi-110010 (Mob.8602866705) from all their movable and immovable assets and properties due to his disrespectful, abusive behaviour and indifferent attitude towards my clients. They have no relation with their son hence forth and anyone who deals with him in the future shall deal at his own risk and peril. Saurabh Sharma (Advocate) Ch. No.708, Saket Courts New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE
Public is hereby informed that My client M/s Balkshi Properties Pvt. Ltd intend to purchase the property bearing no. 1/6701/A (Old Property No. 1159), Out of Khana No. 375 & 581/374, situated in the abadi of East Rohatash nagar, Village Udhampur, Itaga Shubhara, Delhi-110032, area measuring from 50 Sq. Yds i.e. 41.81 Sq. Mtrs from (1) Sh. Himanshu Kandpal & (2) Shubham Kandpal Both sons of Late Sh. Narech Kumar Sharma and want to execute the Bayana/ Ikarama Agreement. In case any person has any right, title, interest, claim or demand/loan of whatsoever nature by way of sale, gift, lease, hire/purchase, possession or any other nature in respect of aforesaid property, the same should be known in writing to me at the address mentioned below with the documentary proof within 15 days from the date hereof, failing which it shall be construed that such claim is waived, abandoned. Sd/- VIPIN ARORA Advocate G-85, 1st Floor, Karkardooma Court, Delhi-110032 Mobile: 9313626324, 9999075990

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, Shwetank Kumar, S/O Satish Kumar, R/O 8060, D-8, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi-70, have lost the original Builder Buyer Agreement (BBA) of Flat No. 1316, Krish Aura, Bhiwadi, Alwar (Raj.) Loss Report vide LR. No. 511807/2026 Date 05.08.2026 has been lodged at P.S. Vasant Kunj South, Delhi. Any person having any agreement/claiming may contact 9650291596 within 15 days of publication.

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given to the general public that I Ashok Bansal S/O Late Amar Nath Bansal and Smt. Krishna Bansal R/O 131, Promise Apartment, Vikasuri, New Delhi-110018 have lost Original possession letter of property bearing no. 131, Promise Apartment, Vikasuri, New Delhi-110018, E-FIR (NCR) lodged vide LR No. 458807/2026, Dtd. 18.07.2026. Finder contact me at above address. If anyone have issues regarding sale and purchase of this property, please contact/inform to me at above address and contact No.89680004 within 15 days of publication of this notice.

PUBLIC NOTICE
General Public is hereby informed that my clients Harichand S/o Bharti & Smt. Darshana W/o Harichand both R/o WZ-381, Harjan Colony, Tikla Nagar, West Delhi-110018 hereby sever all their relations with their son namely Ajay. Due to his misbehavior and disobedience with my clients, hereby disowned and disbarred him from their all movable and immovable properties forever. Any person dealing with him shall be doing so at his/her/their own risk and responsibility. My clients will not be responsible for his any act and deeds.

"IMPORTANT"
Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

Call or WhatsApp 9717006820 to advertise on classified page The Indian EXPRESS JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE, U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN), Jhansi Email- seurbanjhsccircle@gmail.com

Letter No: 1128 /F-03/166 Date: 05.08.2026

SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTICE (NIT)
U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), online e-tender in two bid system on percentage rate basis for construction of "Industrial area Bhooragarh Water Supply Scheme, District Banda Under Deposit Work Programme" are hereby invited on "TURNKEY" basis from eligible, reputed and experienced contractors/ firms having requisite work experience & financial capabilities. The work includes "Surveying, Soil investigation, Engineering, Design, Supply of all materials, labour, T&P etc. required for completion of following works of "Industrial area Bhooragarh Water Supply Scheme, District Banda Under Deposit Work Programme" on turn-key basis: Rising main, Feeder main, Distribution System & Site development works etc. The scope of work also includes provisions & Specification as specified in tender documents, Testing & Commissioning, trial & run for 1 months, defect liability period of 12 months for Civil works & 24 months for E/M works after completion of successful trial run. All completed and commissioned work under Industrial area Bhooragarh Water Supply Scheme, District Banda Under Deposit Work Programme shall be handed over to UPSIDA/ Jal Sansthan after 1 months of successful trial run period". E-bid documents will be available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal https://etender.up.nic.in and U.P.J.N. (Urban) website www.jn.upscd.gov.in for download from dated 10.08.2026 from 12:00 hrs. Pre-bid meeting will be held on dated 17.08.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. in undersigned office. E-bids can be submitted till 24.08.2026 up to 15:00 Hrs. Technical bid shall be opened on 24.08.2026 at 17:00 hrs. in the office of the Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Jhansi in presence of contractor or their authorized representative who wish to participate. E-tender Cost is Rs. 10000.00 + GST @ 18%. Details are available on U.P. Govt. e-procurement portal http: etender.up.nic.in & UP.J.N website www.jn.upscd.gov.in.

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता पूर्वी गंगा नहर निर्माण मण्डल, हरिद्वार ई-निविदा सूचना सं०-01/एसओई०/2026-27 महामहिम राज्यपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से निम्न कार्य हेतु ऑनलाइन http://etender.up.nic.in के माध्यम से प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन टेनिकल बिड च फाइनैन्शियल बिड, उत्तर प्रदेश सिंचाई विभाग में निम्नांकित तालिका सं०-01 में वर्गीकृत श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों/प्रतिष्ठानों से तालिका सं०-02 में निहित कार्यक्रम के अनुसार मुख्य अभियन्ता (पूर्वी गंगा), सिचाई विभाग, उ०ग्र० मुरादाबाद द्वारा गठित निविदा समिति/अधोदस्तराक्षरी द्वारा ऑनलाइन खोली जायेगी। टेनिकल बिड में क्वालीफाई होने वाले निविदादाताओं की सूची अपलोड किये जाने के उपरान्त उनकी फाइनैशियल बिड दो दिवस उपरान्त खोली जायेगी। इस बीच की अवधि में टेनिकल बिड के सम्बन्ध में इस कार्यालय की ई-मेल आई०डी०-egccchdw@gmail.com पर आपलियां ज्ञात करायी जा सकेगी, इसके बाद प्राप्त आपलियों पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा। कार्यालय बन्द होने या अवकाश होने अथवा तकनीकी कारणों की स्थिति में यह बिड अगले कार्यालय दिवस में उसी समय खोली जायेगी।

तालिका सं०-01							
क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत (बीएसएफ/रु०)	सहायक कर्मचारी (लाभ रु० में)	निविदा प्रपत्र का नम्बर+स्टेशनारी (बीएसएफ/रु० में)	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि	पंजीकरण की कींमती	कार्य से सम्बन्धित अधिसूचना अभियन्ता
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	जनपद बिचौली में पूर्वी गंगा मुख्य नहर के आन्तरिक अनुयाग में वि०मी० 26.400 से वि०मी० 33.525 के मध्य कतिपयत लाइनिंग की पुनर्स्थापना की परियोजना का कार्य।	322.64	6.45	2354.00	12 माह	सिंचाई विभाग में उ० ए० ए० नहर निर्माण पंजीकृत श्रेणी	अधीक्षारी पूर्वी गंगा अभियन्ता बम्बई-2 हरिद्वार।



Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
M. 241	CE / MM	Procurement of 7_2 50mm AAA Weasel conductor

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in

DIPR/2561/Tender/2026



VJTI MUMBAI
वीरमता जिजाबाई तंत्रज्ञान संस्था
Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute
(Autonomous Institute of Govt. of Maharashtra)
H. R. Mahajan Road, Matunga (East), Mumbai - 400 019
Phone: +91 22 24186101/102 - Fax: +91 22 24102874. www.vjti.ac.in

Notice Inviting Tender

E-tenders are invited for the work of "Renovation of Existing Internet Laboratory as CoE AI," having an estimated cost of Rs. 1,11,69,000/- from the eligible contractor having experience of this type of work.

The blank tender forms are available on Maha tender website. <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

The interested tenders are requested to download the entire tender document from Mahatender website. Last date of submission of E-Tender document duly filled in shall be 21st August 2026 up to 5.00 p.m.

For further details, please see the detailed tender notice on the Mahatender website.

Right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof will be with the competent authority of VJTI.

Registrar
VJTI, Matunga, Mumbai-19



BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(Wholly Owned by Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN-U04010KA2002SGC030438)

TENDER NOTIFICATION (Through KPP portal)

BESCOM invites tenders through KPP portal platform from eligible Bidders for "Renewal of Annual Technical Support (ATS) for existing ArcGIS and ArcFM software licenses in the GIS Production environment at BESCOM Data Centre"

Description: Renewal of Annual Technical Support (ATS) for existing ArcGIS and ArcFM software licenses in the GIS Production environment at BESCOM Data Centre.

Enquiry No. BESCOM/2026-27/SE0474. Bid Documents Available from:07-08-2026 04:00 PM Onwards.

The Tenders can be obtained through KPP portal website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>. Aspiring bidders need to register on KPP portal. Further Bidders can take assistance with KPPP help desk contact numbers +91-8046010000 +91-8068948777 or email at support@eprochelpdesk.com..

Sd/-
General Manager
(ICT & MIS.) BESCOM

For electricity related complaints Call: 1912
Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP



THE PUNJAB STATE COOPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS FEDERATION LTD.
SCO 153-155, SECTOR 34-A, CHANDIGARH-160022. EPABX No. 0172-5041812,66

Notice Inviting Tender www.verka.coop

E- Tenders are hereby Invited for the purchase and supply of following items:

Sr. No.	Name of Work/Item	Period/Tentative Qty
1.	For Verka Head Office, Chandigarh a) 15 kg Ghee tins b) Ice Cream cup i. 65 ml ii. 80 ml iii. 90 ml c) WMP Tins with C.Boxes i. ½ kg ii. 1 kg d) ESL EVOH Film 90 (Microns) i. 130 ml ii. 450 ml	Annual 1.4 Lac 20 Lac 3.5 Lac -- 60 K 70 k 30 K 20 K
2.	For Verka Mohali Dairy Annual rate contract for used polyliner/ polyfilm scrap, assorted used curd/ kheer cups/ misc bottles scrap, used empty broken plastic trays scrap, toned empty SMP craft paper bags scrap, used corrugated boxes/ cones/ rolls scrap and Half yearly rate contract for disposal of other unserviceable items lying at Verka Mohali Dairy.	—
3.	For Verka Patiala Dairy Supply, Installation Supervision & Commissioning of one bulk milk pouch (1.5/6 ltr) filling Machine, Cap: 720 PPH for 5000 ml pouch at Verka Patiala Dairy.	01 Unit

NOTE:

- For complete details regarding above tender (NIT), please visit our website i.e. www.verka.coop & e Tendering portal i.e. eproc.punjab.gov.in.
- Corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded on website only

General Manager (Purchase)



UTTAR PRADESH POWER CORPORATION LIMITED
Shakti Bhawan, 14-Ashok Marg, Lucknow
CIN: U32201UP1999SGC024928 | website: www.uppcl.org

Extracts of Financial Results for the quarter ended 30th June, 2026 [Regulation 52 (8), read with Regulation 52 (4), of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015]				
S. NO.	Particulars	Quarter ended		Year ended
		30th June, 2026	30th June, 2025	31st March, 2025
		Un-audited	Un-audited	Audited
1	Total Income from Operations	25,067.84	22,239.83	84,438.18
2	Net Profit/(loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	(6,850.85)	(7,665.29)	(8,714.86)
3	Net Profit/ (loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	(6,850.85)	(7,665.29)	(8,727.29)
4	Net Profit/ (loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	(6,850.85)	(7,665.29)	(8,727.29)
5	Total comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	(6,850.85)	(7,665.96)	(8,723.79)
6	Paid up Equity Share capital (Face value of ₹1000/- per share)	1,60,484.84	1,48,484.13	1,57,334.80
7	Other Equity	(1,24,977.97)	(1,18,416.04)	(1,17,023.83)
8	Securities Premium Account	NA	NA	NA
9	Net worth	33,460.12	28,631.83	37,160.93
10	Outstanding Debt	45,487.10	54,606.04	48,091.86
11	Outstanding redeemable preference shares	NA	NA	NA
12	Debt Equity Ratio	1.36	1.91	1.29
13	Earning per share (of 1000/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)			
	Basic	(43.52)	(51.97)	(57.81)
	Diluted	(43.52)	(51.97)	(57.81)
14	Capital Redemption Reserves	NA	NA	NA
15	Debtenture Redemption Reserves	NA	NA	NA
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	(0.001)	(0.002)	(0.004)
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	(6.12)	(5.68)	(1.69)

Note 1 The above results have been reviewed by the audit committee of the Board of Directors in the meeting held on 5th Aug, 2026 and approved by the Board of Directors in their meeting held on the same day.

Note 2 The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange (BSE Limited) under Regulation 52 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015. The detailed format is available on the website of BSE Limited and the company's website at www.uppcl.org

Note 3 Additional information/other line items pursuant to Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI (LODR) 2015, have been disclosed in the detailed Quarterly Financial Results filed with the stock exchange (BSE Limited) and can be accessed on the website of BSE Limited and the company's website www.uppcl.org

Note 4 The figures/ratios for the previous periods have been restated, regrouped/reclassified wherever necessary to conform to current period classification.

For & on the behalf of Board of Directors
Sd/-
(Nitin Nijhawan)
Company Officer

Date: 05th August, 2026
Place: Lucknow संख्या 13 ज.स./याकालि./ ज.स./2026, दिनांक 05/08/2026



RAJASTHAN STATE COOPERATIVE CONSUMER FED. LTD.
2nd Floor, Nehru Sahkar Bhawan, Jaipur (Rajasthan)
Tel. : 0141-2740095, 2740098, 2741679, E-mail: confedmd@gmail.com

Sr.No.: Upsangh/Man Power/01/2026-28/3037-43 Date: 30.07.26

NOTICE INVITING BID

Bids for Providing Services of Man Power of subject matter(s) of Procurement are invited from interested bidders up to 20.08.2026 at 11.00 AM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://eproc.rajabsthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> of the state.

UBN: CCF2627SLOB00017 **Managing Director**



NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

The Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Const), Northern Railway, Shivaji Bridge, New Delhi for and on behalf of the President of India invites open e-tender for the following work:-

- Name of work and location:** Electrical works in connection with conversion of New Ghaziabad Railway Station from Halt to Crossing Station, provision of Connection at Garhi Harsaru to avoid reversal of trains at Garhi Harsaru (2.5 km), and provision of a new Crossing Station 'ASIA' between ROK-GHNA section of Northern Railway.
- Completion period of the work:** 12 months
- Approx. Cost of work:** Rs.72,55,452.40/-
- Bid Security to be deposited:** Rs. 1,45,200/-
- Date & Time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender:** Tenders may be uploaded upto 15:00 hrs on 27.08.2026 date on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in The bidders can participate in the e-tender, the tender will be opened at 15:00 hrs on 27.08.2026
- Detailed Tender Notice & Tender Document.** The detailed e-tender notice is available on Northern Railway web site i.e. www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in and tender document is available on www.ireps.gov.in
Above tenders document will be available for submission of offer on IREPS web site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 13.08.2026 to 27.08.2026.
All other terms and conditions in respect of above tenders are given in tender document.

The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.
Tender No. 17-Elect./DYCEE/CI/T/171 Dated: 05.08.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2701/2026



NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, SILCHAR
(An Institution of National Importance)
Assam – 788 010

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-tender invited from experienced and financially sound contractor/agency as follows:

Sl. No.	Name of Work NIT-E/Estate/2026-27/04	Estimated Cost (In Rs.)	Cost of tender documents (In Rs.)
1.	Construction of new 11/0.4 KV substation near Civil Engineering Department at NIT Silchar (Re-Tender).	98,82,203/-	2,000/-
2.	Electrical renovation work at Boy's Hostel no 4 at NIT Silchar (Re-Tender).	64,66,099/-	2,000/-
3.	Supplying and installation of street light along with pole at the road a) from starting point of entrance of hostel 9 to entrance of hostel 6 b) at the road between 33kV substation and new guest house upto the junction point of children's park and repairing of street lights at the road of sports complex area at NIT Silchar.	83,60,066/-	2,000/-
4.	Roof treatment, civil repairing, inside and outside painting works at Production Engineering Building, NIT Silchar.	52,02,276/-	2,000/-
5.	Renovation and Seepage Treatment in Residential Quarters Type-IV (new) at NIT Silchar.	10,16,715/-	1,000/-

Last date of online submission is on 20/08/2026.
Any further clarification, modification etc. will be posted in the website <http://www.nits.ac.in> & CPPP only. Sd/- Registrar



GUJARAT MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Gujarat Undertaking)
Regd. Office: Block No. 14/I,
Dr. Jivraj Mehta Bhawan, Sector-10, Gandhinagar
☎ 079-23250767, 23250766, 23257698

TENDER NOTICE NO:GMSCL/ D-34/2026-27

Tenders are invited online from reputed Manufacturers/formulators/ Direct importers for Miscellaneous and Surgical Item on Rate contract basis and details of specification, quantity is available on, <https://gmscl.gujarat.gov.in> All tender documents can be downloaded free on the website: <https://tender.uprocure.com>

Interested bidders are requested to submit the tender through e-tender process.

Duration of downloading of tender document (online):-
05/08/2026 to 20/08/2026 up to 18.00 Hrs

Last date for Submission (online): 20/08/2026 up to 18-00 HRS

Last date for submission of EMD/Tender Fee (Physical) : 21/08/2026 upto 18:00 HRS

Due Date and Time of Physical Submission of Samples: 21/08/2026 upto 18:00 HRS

Opening of Technical Bid Date (online): 25/08/2026 At 15-00 HRS.

Pre-Consultation meeting (Pre-Bid)

Interested Manufactures/formulators/Direct Importers are requested to remain present for pre- Consultation meeting to be held on 13/08/2026 at 11.30 am at Committee room at above mentioned address. Only one representative from each Manufacturer carrying authority letter would be allowed to participate in the pre-bid.

INF-1065-2026-27 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**



TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking & An ISO 27001-2022 Certified Company)

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The APTRANSCO invites bids online for Spec.No.PMM11-e-60/2026: Supply of Lot-I: 220kV 8KN-102 Nos, Lot-II: 220kV 6KN-1653 Nos, Lot-III: 132kV-3426 Nos & Lot-IV: 33kV - 2041 Nos Solid Core Insulators. Date & Time of availability of above tender: 05.08.2026 at 5:00PM. Websites: www.tender.aeprocurement.gov.in Contact No. CE/Transmission:0866- 2429230. R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/115 /26-27 Sd/- CHIEF ENGINEER/TRANSMISSION



TELANGANA FOODS
IDA : NACHARAM : HYDERABAD - 500076
Phone No. 040-27152207, 08 & 09

No. TF/GG/Tender/"Laminated Film Rolls", HDPE Bags and HM-HDPE Bags/1589-2026-27, DL05.08.2026.

Inviting e-Tenders (a) for supply of "Laminated Film Rolls" (b) HDPE Bags and (c) HM-HDPE Bags. For detailed information including eligibility criteria, specifications, terms & conditions and bids submission please visit website: <https://tender.eprocurement.gov.in> and website: <https://foods.telangana.gov.in>. Bids can be downloaded from 06.08.2026 @ 5.00 pm onwards. Sd/- Managing Director

DIPR R.O. No. : 390-PPCL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27, Date: 05-08-2026



NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF URBAN MANAGEMENT (NIUM), HYDERABAD

CORRIGENDUM - EXTENSION OF EOI SUBMISSION DATE

With reference to EOI No. NIUM-UP/5/2026-PH-NIUM dated 18.07.2026 for Empanelment of Individual Consultants / SMEs the last date for submission of applications has been extended from 05.08.2026 (5:00 PM) to 12.08.2026 (5:00 PM). All other terms and conditions of the EOI remain unchanged. For details, visit www.nium.org.in.

Sd/- Director General
NIUM

DIPR R.O. No. : 392-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:05-08-2026



Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala- 147001
Contact Number: 96461-01251, Email id:- ase-it-erp@pspcl.in
Corporate Identity No. U140109PB2010SGC03813, Website: www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry No. 360 Dated 05/08/26

Dy. CE/IT (A&PM), Ground Floor, 7-Story Building, PSPCL Head Office, The Mall, Patiala invites short term open e-tender for Renewal of Sophos Firewall Subscription (XGS-3100) for 3 years along with supply of similar model new hardware for HA mode. For detailed NIT & Tender specifications please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 06.08.2026, 1:00 PM onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>.

No. 13968/PB C-772/26



OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER WATER RESOURCES CONSTRUCTION CIRCLE DUNGARPUR
No:- SE/Acc/Dungarpur/2026-27/1242 Dated:- 28/07/26

INVITATION FOR BIDS

E-NIT No 01/2026-27
NIB No.-: WRD2627A0203

S. No	Name of Work	Approximate Value (in Rupees)	UBN NO.
1.	Construction of Dham Ka Talab Ancient, Village -Tham Ka Talab, P.S. Simlawar & Bala Ka Nala Ancient (Chauras) Village, Mandela Upl, P.S. Jhohri Dist. Dungarpur	44052187.00 (with include GST)	WRD2627WSOB00439
2.	Repair and Renovation of Canal of Amarpura dam From Amarpura to Duka Kanba (Chorasi), Dist - Dungarpur	4673700.00 (with include GST)	WRD2627WSOB00440

Above cited works bids are invited from interested bidders upto 06:00 Pm on 19.08.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://eproc.rajabsthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in> of state, and www.waterresources.njabsthan.gov.in/wrd departmental website.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Water Resources Construction Circle
Dungarpur

DIPR/C/13518/2026



कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
प्रथम मण्डल सिचाई कार्य, मेरठ।
se.iwc1@gmail.com

ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या:-09/ एस0ई-1/2026-27

महामहिम राज्यपाल, उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से सिंचाई विभाग निम्नानुसार श्रेणी के पात्र पंजीकृत निविदाताओं से आनलाईन टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से नीचे दर्शाये गये कार्य हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम / सीट का नाम	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (कोट/रुपये/लाख)	कार्य की पूर्ण करने की अवधि	बिडर काटती 3 दिनांक (रुपये)	निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य (रु. में)	पंजीकृत अवधि	कार्य से सम्बंधित अधिकारी का पता
		अधिक अधिक	अधिक अधिक	अधिक अधिक	अधिक अधिक	अधिक अधिक	अधिक अधिक
1-	राजधानी गाँव पोखरणपुर के सिंचनी 06.000 से सिंचनी 27.842 तक नहर पुनर्विनिर्माण, खडगवा व डिक सिंचनी सिंचनी का कार्य।	486.50	05 मार	9.75	रु. 340.00 + 18% G.S.T. + रु. 2000 सेटअप का कार्य	"ए" पर उल्लेखित उपर	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, राजधानी गाँव, सिंचनी कार्य, मेरठ। अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, राजधानी गाँव, सिंचनी कार्य, मेरठ। अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, राजधानी गाँव, सिंचनी कार्य, मेरठ।
2-	राजधानी गाँव के सिंचनी 06.000 से सिंचनी 4.848 (टीए) एवं राजधानी गाँव के सिंचनी 0.000 से सिंचनी 7.500 (टीए) के नहर नहर पुनर्विनिर्माण, खडगवा व डिक सिंचनी सिंचनी का कार्य।	171.50	05 मार	3.45	रु. 340.00 + 18% G.S.T. + रु. 2000 सेटअप का कार्य	"ए" पर उल्लेखित उपर	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, राजधानी गाँव, सिंचनी कार्य, मेरठ। अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, राजधानी गाँव, सिंचनी कार्य, मेरठ। अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, राजधानी गाँव, सिंचनी कार्य, मेरठ।

बिड डाक्यूमेंट वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर दिनांक: 11.08.2026 की पूर्वाह्न 10:00 बजे से दिनांक:- 19.08.2026 की अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक उपलब्ध है, अपलोड किये जा सकते हैं। इसकी तकनीकी बिड दिनांक:- 19.08.2026 की अपराह्न 04:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है।

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
प्रथम मण्डल सिंचाई कार्य, मेरठ।
E-mail Id: se.iwc1@gmail.com

UPID-254459 Date 04/08/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in



CENTRAL ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
6th, 7th, & 8th Floor, Tower-B, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029
सत्यमेव जयते

Petition No. 206/TL/2026 Dated: 3.8.2026

NOTICE UNDER CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-SECTION (5) OF SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003

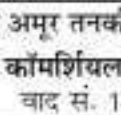
An application under Sections 14, 15 and 79(1)(e) of the Electricity Act, 2003 (the Act) has been made by **Ishanagar Power Transmission Limited**, Windsor, 1st Floor, Unit No. 101, Kalina, Santacruz (East), Mumbai - 400098, Maharashtra for the grant of a separate RTM Transmission Licence to PBITL to implement transmission project "Implementation of 1 No. 400 kV line bay at Ishanagar (New) Sub-station for interconnection of M/s Avaada Energy Pvt. Ltd. (AEPL) 350 MW REGS" under the Regulated Tariff Mechanism (hereinafter referred to as "RTM") mode (hereinafter referred to as "the Project"). The scope of the project for which a transmission licence has been sought is as under:

Sl. No.	Scope of the Transmission Scheme	Item Description	Implementation Time frame	Implementation Agency
1.	Implementation of 1 No. of 400 kV line bay at Ishanagar (New) S/s for RE Interconnection (Appl. 22000001421: Avaada Energy Pvt. Ltd. (350 MW))	400 kV line bay — 1 No. (Main bay along with associated Tie bay)	30.06.2027 i.e. start date of connectivity as per in-principal grant of Connectivity granted to AEPL [3500MW (appl. no. 22000001421)]	Ishanagar Power Transmission Limited (subsidiary of IndiGrid 2 Pvt Ltd.)

Total Estimated Cost: ₹ 15.55 Cr. (May'25 Price Level)

- The Central Transmission Utility of India Limited, vide its letter dated 8.4.2026, has recommended for the grant of a transmission licence to the applicant to establish the proposed transmission system.
- Based on the material available on the record, the Commission vide order dated 1.8.2026 in Petition No. 206/TL/2026, has proposed to issue a transmission licence to the applicant for the establishment of the transmission scheme as noted in para 1 above.
- A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an inter-State transmission licence to **Ishanagar Power Transmission Limited**, before the Commission can be accessed at the <https://www.indigrid.co.in/documents-manager/> or inspected by any person in the Commission's office by following the laid down procedure.
- Notice is hereby given in pursuance of clause (a) of sub-section (5) of Section 15 of the Act that suggestions or objections, if any, to the Commission's proposal to grant a transmission licence to the applicant, as aforesaid, be sent to the undersigned by **12.8.2026** at the above noted address. The suggestions or objections received after the specified date shall not be considered.
- The application shall be taken up for the further hearing by the Commission on **13.8.2026**. Any person who files suggestions or objections may in his/her discretion attend the hearing, for which no TA/DA shall be paid by the Commission.

Sd/-
(Harpreet Singh Pruthi)
Secretary



EASTERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF A.P. LTD
Corporate Office, P&T Colony, Seethammadhara, Visakhapatnam-530 013.

e-Tender Notice

The APEPDCL is opting for e-tendering from the eligible bidders for Appointment of SCADA Implementation Agency (SIA) for Design, engineering, supply, integration, installation, testing & commissioning of SCADA software applications, Dispatcher Training Simulator (DTS), SCADA hardware and SCADA Enablers at Substations in cities of Visakhapatnam & Rajamahendravaram in APEPDCL (Outdoor Breakers and RMUs will be supplied by APEPDCL) vide RFP No. CGM/PROJECTS/APEPDCL/VSP/SCADA /01/2026-27. All the interested bidders may visit www.aeprocurement.gov.in to view and download the tender document from Dt. 07.08.2026, 11:00 Hrs onwards.

Ph: 0891-2582325, 2582326 Advt-38 Chief General Manager/Projects

समन वास्ते करार वाद अप्रु तनकी तलबी आईई 5 कायदा 1 व 5 न्यायालय कॉमिश्नियल कोर्ट सं. 1, आगरा वाद सं. 14/2026

बैंक ऑफ बर्होदा, कमला नगर शाखा, आगरा द्वारा चौक मैनजर व पॉवर ऑफ अटैन्टी होल्डर.

वादी

बनाम्

मोहम्मद फहीम पुत्र मोहम्मद सलाउद्दीन प्रोपराइटर मे. के. जी. एन. ट्रेडर्स नि. ई-4/435 शहीद नगर, नौचर साई बाबा मन्दिर, आगरा-282001. मो 6399461810

प्रतिवादी

हरगाह वादी ने आपक नाम एक नालिश वावत रुपये 11,76,474/06 रू के दायर की है, लिहाजा आपको हुक्म दिया जाता है कि जो आप व तरीख 27-08-2026 तक 10:30 बजे दिन असालत या मार्फत न्काल के जो हालत मुकदमा मे वाकई वाकिक किया गया हो और कुल मुकदमा का जबाब दे सके या उसके साथ में कोई और सख्त हो जो कि ऐसे सवाल का जबाब दे सके हाजिर हो और जबाब देहो दावा की करे और आपको लाजिम है कि जुमान दस्तावेज को आप इसी रोख पेश करे जिन पर जबाब देहो के इस्तेमाल पेश करना चाहते हो - आपको इतिहा दी जाती है कि अगर व रोख मजबूत में हाजिर न हूए तो आपको गैर हाजिरी में और फंसित होगी। प्रतिवादनत्र भी उक्त दिनांक तक प्रस्तुत करें।

व सिम्ब मेरे और मुजर अदालत के आज व तरीख 31 माह 07 सन् 2026 ई0 जारी किया गया।

पीठसमो अधिकारी
कॉमिश्नियल कोर्ट नं.-1, आगरा



उत्तराखण्ड पावर कॉर्पोरेशन लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम)

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विद्युत वितरण मण्डल (ग्रामीण) ईश्वरीय रोड, देहरादून, नूतनाफ. +91-135-2653601

“पुनः ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना”

अभोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा ई-निविदा संख्या 43 / EDCRDDUN / 2026-27 आमंत्रित की गई थी जिसको खोलने की तिथि 25.07.2026 थी को संशोधन के कारण पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

उपरोक्त निविदा की अधिक जानकारी हेतु वेबसाइट www.uktenders.gov.in पर देखें।

“विद्युत बिलों के 24x7 ऑनलाईन मुगतान हेतु www.upcl.org पर जायें”

पत्रांक: 2793 / विद्युतमंडलादेश / उपकासि दिनांक: 04 / 08 / 2026 अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

“राष्ट्र हित में बिजली बचायें” टोल फ्री नं0 1800-419-0405

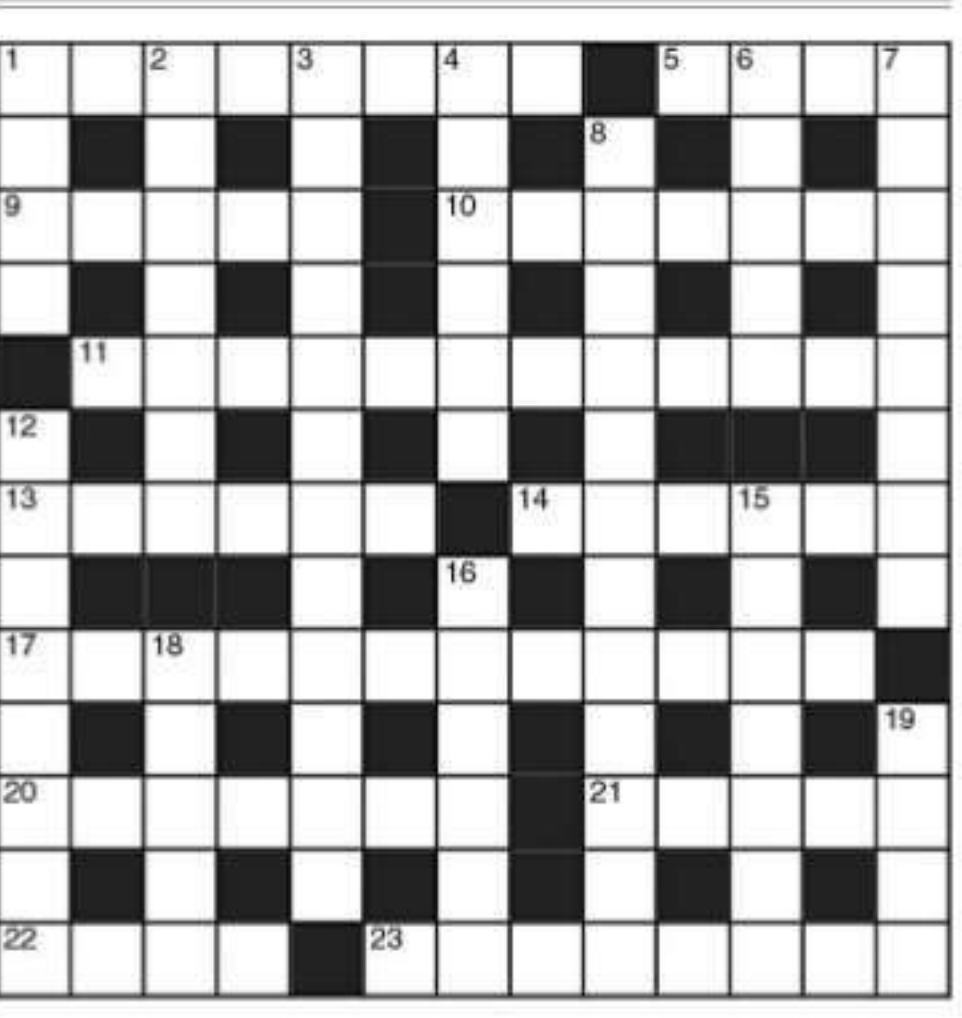


WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

Commercial Branch
No.: C/BPL/NFR/E-Auction/2026/5
Date: 04.08.2026

President of India, through Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager West Central Railway Bhopal Division, has invited E-Auction for awarding contracts of advertisement on exterior panel of Locomotives. Catalogues are available on IREPS Portal (www.ireps.gov.in). Details of catalogues are as follows: Catalogue number : C-BPL-NFR-Loco, Type of contract : Advertisement, Lot no : ADVT-LOCO-BPL-ET-220 ADVT-LOCO-BPL-ET-221,

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 Move to break concentration (8)
- 5 Rainbow seen when in the garden (4)
- 9 One may have nothing to say at any stage (5)
- 10 About ten Anna's a bit of a butterfly (7)
- 11 He lacks refinement and sparkle perhaps (5,7)
- 13 They have news or distribute it (6)
- 14 Not so fair (6)
- 17 Container that's made to go by elephant (9,3)
- 20 Make the most of an adventure (7)
- 21 Giant group of stars (5)
- 22 Quits the day before starting at noon (4)
- 23 A double first (4,4)
- DOWN
- 1 Expected to end in mortal combat (4)
- 2 Placed in a losing position in tennis (3,4)
- 3 Inflation means cut-back to going rate perhaps (12)
- 4 A drink that is diluted and cast out (6)
- 6 Music for a man to perform (5)
- 7 Normal colours (8)
- 8 A firm grip on the throttle? (12)
- 12 Whole poem Celt revised (8)
- 15 Fancy a title for a Lennon song (7)
- 16 A fine state to be in (6)
- 18 Fall back in initial circuits to gain energy (5)
- 19 Speed of negative sound (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6059 ACROSS: 1 Incurious, 8 Arena, 9 Logical, 10 Allege, 11 Peanut, 12 Improved, 15 Optional, 18 Yachts, 20 Awaits, 21 Clarets, 22 Radii, 23 Nectarine DOWN: 2 Noose, 3 Unions, 4 Inaction, 5 Sailor, 6 Reserve, 7 Calendars, 11 Put on airs, 13 Polyglot, 14 Strands, 16 Obtain, 17 Scorer, 19 Titan

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Laughing at our _____ can lengthen our own life. Laughing at someone else's can shorten it. Cullen Hightower (8)

CLPAE

ELLRIT

HLOSS

EGSUKM

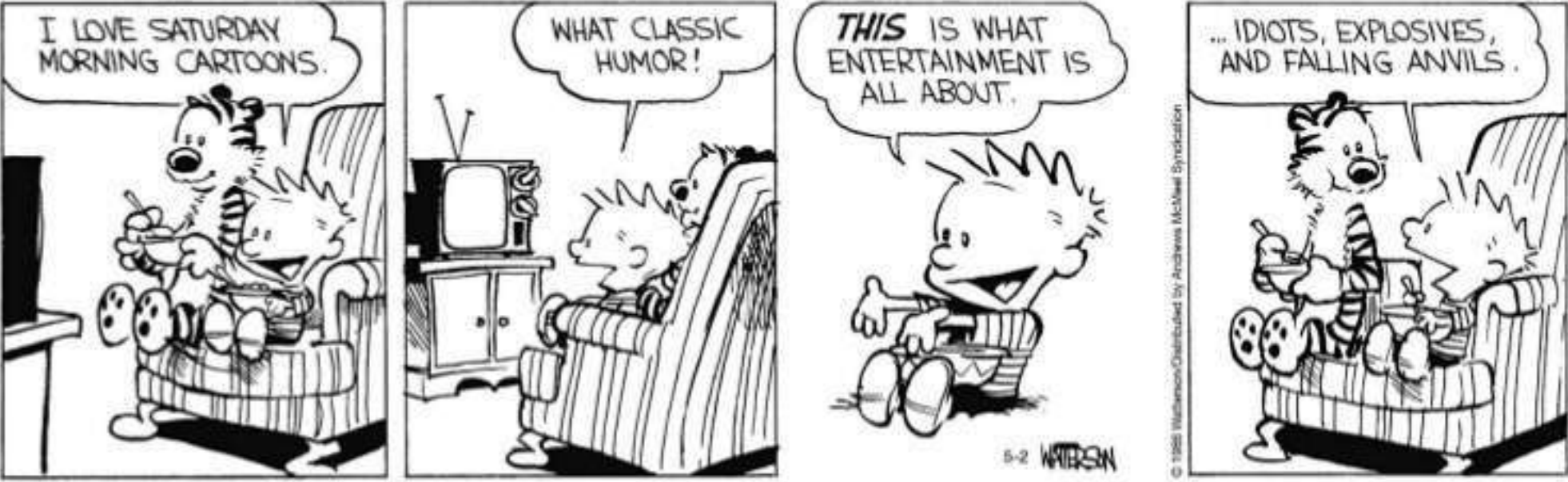
Someone else's can shorten it - Cullen Hightower

ANSWER: Laughing at our mistakes can lengthen our own life. Laughing at someone else's can shorten it - Cullen Hightower

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6402

	8	6	9		1	2	4	
				8				
5	1				8		3	
1		6	3				7	
		5			4			
9			5	8			1	
4	9				3		8	
				6				
5	2	7			9	1	6	

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6401

7	6	5	1	2	3	8	9	4
9	4	3	5	7	8	6	1	2
1	2	8	6	4	9	3	5	7
6	5	9	4	3	2	7	8	1
3	1	2	7	8	6	5	4	9
4	8	7	9	5	1	2	3	6
2	9	4	8	6	5	1	7	3
5	7	6	3	1	4	9	2	8
8	3	1	2	9	7	4	6	5

ROYAL STARS

- ♈

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Discussions about home repairs and family matters might occur. It's an excellent day to make plans about the education and care of your kids. Some, will plan a vacation. Tonight: Conversations.
- ♉

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today the Moon is in your sign dancing with Mercury, which will increase the pace of your day and attract others to you. You might be keen to share your feelings or write down something for someone else to read. Tonight: Check your money.
- ♊

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Someone older might have advice for you today. Possibly, you are the person dispensing advice. This is a good day to learn something new because you have the discipline necessary to make it happen; plus, you won't overlook details. Tonight: You win.
- ♋

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): It's the perfect day to draw up a budget and think about how to use your money as economically as possible. You might give advice to a boss or someone in authority, or a boss might have advice for you. Tonight: Solitude.
- ♌

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): A conversation with a parent, or someone in authority could be important today. It might be your chance to share your feelings. You want to organize your life with an overall plan. Tonight: Friendships.
- ♍

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): If you have a chance for some time alone today, you might do some deep thinking. This is also a good day to think about how you can expand your world through learning. Tonight: You're admired.
- ♎

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Discussions with partners, spouses and close friends will be serious today but meaningful. Advice might flow back and forth. You're focused more on solid, practical issues today. Tonight: Explore.
- ♏

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): You'll make a great impression on bosses, parents, and, teachers today. They see you as reliable, conscientious and hardworking. Meanwhile, spouses, partners and close friends see you as bright, clever and interesting. Tonight: Check your finances.
- ♐

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This is the perfect day to study, write or review an important paper. Your mind will be detail-oriented and self-disciplined. You'll have a practical approach to dealing with kids, as well as social events. Tonight: Cooperate.
- ♑

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): This is a solid day to discuss how to divide assets or share the cost of something or deal with inheritances, taxes and debt. Very likely, it could relate to family matters or something to do with your home. Tonight: Work.
- ♒

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): When talking to someone close today, you'll steer the conversation in the way you want it to go. You know what's important to you, and you'll discuss it. You'll get great satisfaction from a job well done. Tonight: Socialise.
- ♓

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is a productive day. You'll keep plugging along at whatever you have to do with your job, your health or a pet. Meanwhile, you'll enjoy little intervals and breaks where you can talk with the someone in a lighthearted way. Tonight: Rest.

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd

Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
02	SE / Civil Maint / NCTPS -1	Lifting and disposal of wet ash on As is where is condition Basis available at Ash dyke of NCTPS-I

For details of works/Procurement/Due date of submission /Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in

DIPR/2455/Tender/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of work and its location	101-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27 Operation, Maintenance and Repair of Electrical assets at Abhinandan Rest House, Tilak Bridge New Delhi (For Three Years)
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 16013669.44/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 320300.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	27.08.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	27.08.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

2703/2026

SHIRDI MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, SHIRDI

A/P-SHIRDI, TAL-RAHATA DIST-AHILYANAGAR, email-coshirdi@gmail.com

Outward No - NP/T-8/1176/2026 Date - 03/08/2026

E-TENDER NOTICE 2026-27

Shirdi Municipal Council invites online e-tenders for the Additional Works under the Shirdi Water Supply Scheme being Implemented under the AMRUT 2.0 Mission. The Estimated cost of the work is Rs. 2.83 Crore. Detailed tender information, including the tender documents is available on the Maharashtra e-Tender Portal at www.mahatenders.gov.in

Sd/- (Saurabh Galande)

Sd/- (Satish Dighe)

Water Supply Engineering, Shirdi M.C.

Chief Officer, Shirdi M.C.

PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LIMITED

(Regd. office PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate Identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Mobile No. 96461-10914)

E-Tender Enq. No. 7846/P-1/EMP-13405 dated 03-08-2026

Dy. Chief Engineer/ Headquarter (Procurement Cell-1) GGSSTP, Roopnagar invites E-Tender ID No. 2026_POWER_172967_1 for Procurement of material under PJ Group (Packing and Joining material) for the year 2026-27. For detailed NIT & Tender specification please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 03-08-2026 from 05.00 PM onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

No. 13960/PB RTP-77/26

Yeola Municipal Council

District - Nashik

E-Tender for the year 2026-27

Yeola Municipal Council invites e-tender for the work of Water supply Project for Yeola Under Amrut 2.0, Tal. Yeola, Dist. Nashik in the State of Maharashtra, of Estimated Cost of Rs 133,91,50,193.00/-. The e-Tender details are available on www.mahatenders.gov.in All relevant dates will be as per the tender published in web portal www.mahatenders.gov.in

Date : 06.08.2026

Sd/- President

Sd/- Chief Officer

Out No. 320/2026

Date : 05/08/2026

Yeola Municipal Council

Yeola Municipal Council

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Deepu S/o Popi Ram R/o H. No. A-290, Ground Floor, Shahbad Daulatpur, Delhi also at A-283, Shahbad Daulatpur, Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 438/2018 U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. K.N. Katju Marg, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Deepu cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Deepu has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Deepu of case FIR No. 438/2018 U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S. K.N. Katju Marg, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 08.09.2026.

By Order

Sh. Aakash Sharma

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03

North District, Room No.213

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10881/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Anuj Pandey @ Ashish Pandey S/o Sh. Shiv Mani Pandey R/o H.No. 84, Village: Nithari, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under E-FIR MVT No. 007584/2018 U/s 379/411 IPC., has been registered at PS: Alipur, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, Anuj Pandey @ Ashish Pandey cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, Anuj Pandey @ Ashish Pandey has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, Anuj Pandey @ Ashish Pandey of under E-FIR MVT No. 007584/2018 U/s 379/411 IPC., Registered at P.S. Alipur, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 07.09.2026.

By Order

Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot

Ld. CJM (North), Court No. 115

Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10869/ON/2026 (Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Shawan @ Raju, S/o Munna R/o H.No.23/24, 2,4 Ground Floor, Gram Sabha Village Libaspur City, Delhi-42 Also at 66 Futa Road, Near Kabir Mandir Dharamshala Libaspur, Delhi-42 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.157/23 u/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Shawan @ Raju cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Shawan @ Raju has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Shawan @ Raju of FIR No.157/23 u/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 27.10.2026.

By Order

Sh. P. Bhargav Rao

Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (East), Room No.03

2nd Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10787/ED/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Khushnasib @ Kale, S/o Nasir R/o A-20, G.No.1, Near Rahish Halwai Shop No.33, 100 Foota Road Kabir Nagar, Welcome, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.708/2022 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Khushnasib @ Kale cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Khushnasib @ Kale has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Khushnasib @ Kale of FIR No.708/2022 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.10.2026.

By Order,

Deepakshi Rana

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, Court No.19,

Karkardooma, Shahdara District, Delhi

DP/10723/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Narender @ Sonu S/o Dayanand R/o H. No. 60, Pana Udyan, Narela, Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 502/2024 U/s 333/305/308(4)/351(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Alipur, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Narender @ Sonu cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Narender @ Sonu has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Narender @ Sonu of case FIR No. 502/2024 U/s 333/305/308(4)/ 351(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Alipur, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said case on or before 15.09.2026.

By Order

Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot

Chief Judicial Magistrate

Court No. 115

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10657/Crime/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons 1. Hari Chand Kumar S/o Sh. Ishwar Mehto R/o Village Ghar Ghatwa, Inarwa, Betiah, Bihar Also At: Jhuggi Meera Bagh, Delhi & 2. Raju Babu S/o Sh. Sita Ram R/o Village Parsoni, Mohammadpur, Gopal Gunj, Bihar Also At: Jhuggi Meera Bagh, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 451/2021 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Alipur, Delhi and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said 1. Hari Chand Kumar & 2. Raju Babu cannot be found and whereas it have been shown to my satisfaction that the said 1. Hari Chand Kumar & 2. Raju Babu have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita have been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said 1. Hari Chand Kumar & 2. Raju Babu accused of FIR No. 451/2021 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act at P.S. Alipur, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.09.2026.

By Order: Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot

Chief Judicial Magistrate (North)

Room No. 115, 1st Floor,

Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10843/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) RAMVIR S/o Surender R/o H.No. 719, Satbir Ka Makan, Pana Madan, Bawana, Delhi committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No./CC No. 229/2022 U/s 302/427 IPC, PS Bawana, Distt. Outer North, Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) RAMVIR can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) RAMVIR has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) RAMVIR of FIR No./CC No. 229/2022 U/s 302/427 IPC, PS Bawana, Distt. Outer North, Delhi are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 06.10.2026 at 10:00 AM.

By Order

Sh. Jagmohan Singh

Adtl. Sessions Judge (North)-03

Courts No. 312, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10615/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Mahender, S/o. Navratna, R/o.KN-769, Street No. 4, Durga Chowk, Rajiv Nagar, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi Also at: H. No.110, Rajiv Nagar, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide FIR No. 530/2017 U/S 186/332/353/380/411/457/458/34 IPC registered at P.S Karawal Nagar, North East District, Delhi and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said Mahender could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused Mahender is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said Mahender, accused of FIR No. 530/2017 U/S 186/332/353/380/411/457/458/34 IPC, P.S. Karawal Nagar, North East District, Delhi is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.09.2026.

By Order, Isra Zaidi,

Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,

Room No. 04, Fourth Floor, North East District,

Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/10834/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Amit Tomar S/o Late Shadav Tomar R/o H. No. A-119, Gali No. 8, Meot Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 440/2013 u/s 279/337 IPC at P.S. Welcome, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Amit Tomar cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Amit Tomar has absconded (or is concealing hisself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said Amit Tomar accused of FIR No. 440/2013 u/s 279/337 IPC at P.S. Welcome, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 29.09.2026.

By Order: Ms. Deepakshi Rana,

Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,

Room No. 19, 1st Floor,

Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/10715/NE/2026

EXPRESS
interview

CRAIG FULTON
CHIEF COACH, INDIAN MEN'S HOCKEY TEAM

‘Sometimes things go out of control, but we’ve got to stick together’

Ahead of World Cup, Fulton explains why it’s important not to take anything for granted & how the team has tide over recent controversies

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 5

FOR CRAIG Fulton and his team, the year so far has been about fighting one battle after another, on and off the field.

Be it the star players being dropped on disciplinary grounds, seniors being ‘forced’ into retirement, a string of defeats before a sharp recovery, or the controversial change of jersey colour that has overshadowed the build-up to the World Cup, which begins on August 15.

In two separate interviews with *The Indian Express*, conducted before India’s saffron jersey was unveiled, Fulton reflects on navigating those challenges, why he may field a different group in the first leg of next year’s Pro League, the composition of the World Cup squad and his expectations from the tournament.

Excerpts.

How tough have the last six months been, managing all the external issues?

Yeah, it’s been difficult. It’s been very difficult from Cape Town (Manpreet Singh disciplinary issue) through till now. There’s been a lot of distractions and noise. And it’s just reminded me again, okay, stay in your lane and focus on what you can control.

How tough is it to do that?

Yeah, it’s just how it happens sometimes. I think challenges are good because you really see what kind of character you have in the group, in your staff and in your environment; and who’s ready to go. ‘All right, this is not like us. This is where we were not good.’ We put in conversations and agreements that we’d never get into this situation again. And that’s the lesson. If I said everything was hunky-dory and we never have a problem, then I’d be lying to you.

You’ve always got that simple saying: 10 per cent of life is what happens to you, 90 per cent of life is how you react. Something happens and derails this phase. What do you do? You get tested in all your strategies, all your values, and then you’ve got to bounce back again.

I think this has been a really good thing for us because it happened at a time that wasn’t great, but it wasn’t the World Cup or the Asian Games. If there’s one thing we’ve taken from it, it’s that we’ve learnt a lot about ourselves and I think we’re now in a better place.

What was the toughest part? Dealing with it yourself or ensuring the players didn’t go off track?

I just think with lots of players, lots of staff and lots of moving parts, things can slip through the cracks. You end up in a situation that wasn’t great, and now you’ve got to go for it. So it’s just about keeping everything really tight, really committed and open.

What did you learn about yourself and the players during this testing period?

Just don’t take anything for granted. If you start assuming things are great and always at the level you want them to be, then something happens and you go backwards. Sometimes things go out of control. But we’ve got to stick together and we’ve got to make this work.

What did you think of PR Sreejesh’s comments on the performances?

No comment.

The Pro League this season has been a mixed bag. What was the harshest criticism you received?

When we play post-Hockey India League, it’s a double-edged sword. It’s really good for the youth and the exposure of Indian players because the Hockey India League is a great initiative for the future of Indian hockey. But if we play a full Pro League programme five days later, it doesn’t give us the right balance because all our Indian players have just played in the Hockey India League. There’s not much we can do about it because of the window.

It’s not an excuse. It’s just about managing it better going forward. We’d probably use a different group in the first block and then bring the seniors into the second block. The HIL is very good for hockey in India. But we have to balance it better with who’s fresh and who’s able



Craig Fulton’s India are in World Cup Group D, alongside England, Pakistan and Wales. FILE

“You’ve always got that simple saying: 10 per cent of life is what happens to you, 90 per cent of life is how you react. Something happens and derails this phase. What do you do? You get tested in all your strategies, all your values, and then you’ve got to bounce back again.”

ON MANAGING EXTERNAL ISSUES

to continue playing because it’s a six-week block. It’s like a full-on tournament. Then you come back and play straight away in the Pro League. So it’s not the easiest.

Is it harsh, then, that people judge you and the team only by the results?

And rightfully so, because it’s international hockey and you want your team to do well. You want to win everything.

But I’d like to be judged, like I said, after I have a training

block. Every other team has their league and they train during the week. So there are lots of contact points with the group. Then you build a programme for six, eight or 12 weeks before you play a tournament. Fortunately, we’ve been able to do that now.

Were you happy with how things went in European leg of the Pro League?

We got results in all of them against top opposition. We learnt a tough lesson in the second Germany game (lost 2-1), where we know we could have got back-to-back results against them. We were 37 seconds away from a result and then we lost the game. So I’m glad that happened then because it helped us put a few things right.

Then, against the Dutch, we finished strongly, which was important. Even though we were 3-1 up, they made it 3-2, but we were still able to finish the game. I’m glad that happened because it was a great exercise, a proper test match, and we were able to do it well.

Coming across to England, there was always a lot of expectation around the Pakistan game. We were a bit rusty in the first game (won 4-3), did well

and then let them back in. But we hit our straps nicely in the second game (won 7-1) and were a lot more efficient.

I think the travel between Amsterdam and London caught up with us in the first game. The longer we were there, the more settled we became. The two games against England (2-2 and 0-0) were tough. They’re great opposition and they’re in our pool at the World Cup. They learnt a lot about us, we learnt a lot about them, and I think it’s going to be a humdinger when we play each other at the World Cup.

What’s the thought behind the World Cup squad?

We’ve gone with quite a lot of experience in defence and midfield. We can always fill in from midfield if anything happens in the striker line. It’s super difficult to take strikers and put them back into midfield, or midfielders and put them back into defence. So we didn’t go that route. We have a well-balanced and experienced defence and midfield group that has operated well over the last few tournaments, starting from the Olympics.

You have experienced

“Our ranking at the moment is eighth. So what’s realistic? Should we play the quarters? Yes. What happens after that? We’re not really ranked to do anything after that, and that’s great for us. That’s exactly where we want to be. I think we’ll peak at the right time.”

ON WORLD CUP EXPECTATIONS

players like Manpreet, Hardik and Harmanpreet alongside some younger players. How have they fitted in?

It takes time. It’s not an easy transition. We’ve transitioned seven guys out of the national squad over the last 18 months and brought in some younger, talented players for the future, but that doesn’t mean they’re ready. Any time you have a strong team culture... the gym takes time to get used to, the conditioning takes time, the hockey takes time and then the connections within the group take time because everyone’s from different environments, speaks different languages and then it’s senior versus junior. You wait until they’re respectful enough that they can play, and then it’s like, okay, now we build that chemistry.

What would count as a good World Cup for you?

A podium finish would make us happy because I don’t think we performed the way we could have in the February and March block. Now we’ve nailed things down a bit, and I think we’ll be much closer to the way we want to perform.

There’s a beautiful history with the World Cup. It’s the 50th anniversary. If you look back at the last two or three World Cup campaigns, they’ve been difficult. So we want to start well in the pool, get out of the pool and play in those playoff positions. That’s where we want to be.

Our ranking at the moment is eighth. So what’s realistic? Should we play the quarterfinals? Yes. What happens after that? We’re not really ranked to do anything after that, and that’s great for us. That’s exactly where we want to be. Our planning is good. I think we’ll peak at the right time.

• BRIEFLY



Tanvi Sharma beat China’s Yuan An Qi 21-16, 21-15. PTI

Tanvi wins, Srikanth crashes out in opening round at Korea Masters

NEWLY-CROWNED Taipei Open champion Tanvi Sharma made a strong start even as Kidambi Srikanth suffered an opening-round exit at the Korea Masters Super 300 badminton tournament. Third seed Tanvi eased past China’s Yuan An Qi 21-16, 21-15. Rakshit Ramraj recovered from a game down to beat Korea’s Yoo A Yeon 22-24, 21-12, 21-13, while Mansi Singh fought back to defeat Kim Joo Eun 21-21, 21-19, 21-9. Fifth seed Isharani Baruah overcame Korea’s Lee So Yul 21-18, 15-21, 21-7 while Annol Kharb rallied to beat Hong Kong’s Lo Sin Yan Happy 16-21, 21-17, 21-12. Third seed Srikanth lost 20-22, 21-14, 12-21 to Israel’s Daniil Dubovenko.

PTI

Arsenal agree to \$99.5 mn deal for Guimaraes

PREMIER LEAGUE champions Arsenal have agreed a deal worth \$99.5 million to sign Newcastle United captain Bruno Guimaraes, British media reported on Wednesday. Arsenal’s opening offer for the 28-year-old Brazil midfielder was rejected earlier this week, but the London club returned with an improved bid and have now reached an agreement with Newcastle, according to Sky Sports. Guimaraes had previously told Newcastle United that he wanted to join Arsenal if a suitable offer arrived, reports said.

REUTERS

Bridge: India win bronze at Youth C’ship

INDIA’S UNDER-31 team won the bronze medal in the Teams Event at the 9th World Youth Transnational Bridge Championships in Hefei, China, finishing third in the eight-team final round robin with 82.34 Victory Points. China’s AGOOFANS took gold (89.96 VP) and China U31 the silver (89.47 VP). India secured the medal despite visa delays and last-minute changes to partnerships. The team — Anshul Bhatt, Sagnik Roy, Sayantan Kushari, Shubham Acharya, Surajit Bar and Vidhya Patel — was captained and coached by Kaustubh Bendre.

ENS

Indian Navy post comfortable win over NEROCA

INDIAN NAVY produced a clinical performance to secure a 2-0 victory over North Eastern Re-Organising Cultural Association Football Club (NEROCA FC) in a Group D fixture of the Durand Cup on Wednesday. Roshan Panna (twenty-third minute) opened the scoring in the first half before E Muhammed Inayath (sixty-fifth minute) sealed the result after the interval, as the Sailors produced a disciplined and clinical performance to register their first win of this year’s competition.

PTI

Shubhankar to play in DP World India C’ship

SHUBHANKAR SHARMA and Anirban Lahiri will spearhead the Indian challenge against a world-class field featuring Major winner Rory McIlroy, and defending champion Tommy Fleetwood among others at the DP World India Championship, to be held at the Delhi Golf Club from October 15 to 18. They will be joined by an elite international field that includes reigning Open champion Ryan Fox. The tournament is the eighth of nine events in the Back 9 phase of the 2026 Race to Dubai and serves as a key stop on the road to the season-ending DP World Tour Play-offs.

PTI

Praggnanandhaa on a Rapid run, leads 10-man field in St Louis

Mayank Chaudhary
New Delhi, August 5

The impressive showing in St Louis also helped Pragg break into the world top 10 in Rapid for the first time

SOME PLAYERS chase glory. Others take equal delight in denying it to someone. Jordan van Foreest belongs to the latter category. The Dutch Grandmaster calls it “fun, at least” to play the spoiler, by injecting a bit of chaos into a tournament that might otherwise go according to the usual script.

At the 2026 Saint Louis Rapid & Blitz Tournament, he nearly pulled it off. In the ninth and final round of the Rapid section, Foreest took down R. Praggnanandhaa with a clinical finish, threatening to derail the Indian’s dream run. For a moment, at least, the spoiler had done his job. But van Foreest’s mischief had come a little too late. Praggnanandhaa’s emphatic Rapid run over the first eight rounds, over three days, had already built a cushion too thick to crack. His ship was already in calm waters and despite the late defeat, he finished as the leader of a strong 10-man field in Missouri.

Despite the loss in the final round, Praggnanandhaa finished on top with 12 points, holding off arch-rival Javokhir Sindarov, whose stock is at an all-time high. Barring the solitary defeat to van Foreest, the

ever-consistent Indian racked up four wins and as many draws, ending the Rapid section with an impressive +3 result. There are still 18 Blitz rounds to follow.

Sindarov, the World Championship challenger from Uzbekistan, remained unbeaten throughout the Rapid section and has 11 points.

If there is one defining strength of Praggnanandhaa, it is his ability to learn from his lows and make amends quickly. The last time he played at the Saint Louis Rapid & Blitz, he failed to register a single win in the Rapid event, finishing dead last in 2024. This time, he exorcised those ghosts and started with a clean slate.

On Day 1, after a draw against USA’s Leinier Domínguez Perez, Praggnanandhaa shifted gears. Game 2 saw a thematic pawn break, but Armenian-American Levon Aronian mistimed it with 13...c5, allowing White to go a pawn up.

Aronian never quite found a way to win it back.

But the Indian’s best game of the day was against World No. 2 Fabiano Caruana. Praggnanandhaa, wielding black, took his chances in a tight space and forced the ever-solid Caruana to crumble. He finished the day as the sole leader, one full point ahead of Sindarov and Wesley So.

On Day 2, when 13 out of 15 games ended without a decisive result, Praggnanandhaa made sure to capitalise on the opportunities that came his way, securing his overall lead.

While he failed to convert a favourable position against Sindarov in the marquee fourth-round clash, his response in the following round was ruthless. Against Awonder Liang, he broke down the American’s paper-thin defence, crushing him to a 32-move defeat with black pieces in a Caro-Kann Defence. At that stage, his scorecard read 8/10, forcing the entire field to play catch-up.

The 2023 World Cup finalist did slow down over the last four rounds, picking up four points from two draws against Anish Giri and Wesley So, a win over Germany’s Vincent Keymer, and a loss to Van Foreest. Still, it was enough to stay on top, and clinching the Rapid event.

Syndrela story: Idolising Manika to defeating her

Bhuvan Gupta
New Delhi, August 5

THE SCORE is 9-10. Syndrela Das is serving to stay in Game 1. She counters two top-spin drives from Yangzi Liu before launching a ferocious cross-court forehand. Game point saved. The score now is 10-9 in Game 2. Syndrela, facing Yangzi’s serve, repeats the backhand counter-forehand smash routine. Game point won.

The 16-year-old disregards the match situation and her Australian opponent’s rank in a single-minded attack and wins the Commonwealth TT Championships quarter-final against the 31-ranked top seed.

This audacious disposition has made her one of Indian TT’s most exciting talents, as also the youngest member of its Asian Games 2026 squad. Syndrela recently bagged singles and doubles medals at the Asian Youth Championships, and will hope for a bright debut at the bigger continental stage in Aichi-Nagoya next month.

The Kolkata girl has made punching above her weight a habit. She claimed triple National Ranking age-group titles (U15, U17 and U19 singles) in 2023 and graduated to the domestic seniors in style, making the women’s singles semi-finals in 2025 and final this year. Her most memorable moment fol-



16-year-old Syndrela Das is carving out a reputation as one of Indian table tennis’ brightest young talents. UTT

lowed in Goa, where she beat childhood idol Manika Batra 3-0 in her maiden UTT edition.

Manika later said that despite her loss, she “was really happy” with the way Syndrela performed. “I respect and love Manika di a lot. I feel great that she thinks Indian table tennis is in good hands. I will keep idolising her,” Syndrela tells *The Indian Express*.

For this Standard 12 student, academics go hand-in-hand with sport. Syndrela has chosen a unique combination: mathematics alongside the humanities stream. While mathematics “keeps her brain active”, psychology aids in understanding opponents’ thought processes. She cites an instance: “Our body releases adrenaline when we are very nervous or

excited. Both of them help, but one stops us from excelling, and the other facilitates it.”

Even before she took up the subject, Syndrela had exhibited remarkable mental toughness in what she calls the turning point of her life. She broke her right (playing) wrist around the time she had begun playing at the national level in 2021. After the initial shock, she vowed to use the setback as motivation and return stronger.

Two-time Olympian Soumyajit Ghosh, who has followed her game closely, narrated how she visited the academy with a plaster in her hand and watched others play.

Mental Edge

Like Syndrela, Soumyajit, too, experienced early success

She claimed triple National Ranking age-group titles in 2023 and graduated to the domestic seniors in style

as a teenager - he was the youngest Indian player to qualify for the 2012 Olympics and the youngest national champion at 19. But he reckoned Syndrela was built for greater things. “She is more talented than me and more hard-working. Normally I don’t praise anyone so much, but she is different. She is special.”

Soumyajit has ‘never seen her nervous’. “Regardless of the scoreline, her approach is always aggressive. She picks up strokes quickly, and the way she hits the ball, she makes it look so easy.”

Her coach Soumyadeep Roy singled out Syndrela’s backhand as her primary weapon and reiterated that fearlessness was her greatest asset. “The good thing about this generation is, they’re not afraid of anybody on the table. Even when she plays the world number one, her attitude will stay the same. She plays with the same aggression, hunger to win and belief.”

While the Arjuna awardee

felt her ward was “ready to face any kind of challenge” at the Asiad and otherwise, he sounded a word of caution. “The only thing I’m worried about, especially at events like the Asian Games, is that she’s very young and there she will see stars from all sports... It’s okay to get excited when you meet your childhood stars, so we were when we started. You just have to stay grounded and keep working, cut out the distractions.”

Soumyadeep travels with Syndrela wherever possible to try and ensure that. He knows that things will only get tougher from here on, since “she will be marked and everybody would want to beat her.”

Amid hectic tournament travel and soaring expectations, a supporting family is a boon for the paddler. “Most parents want their children to continue doing whatever they have done in their own lives. But my parents never forced me to play TT or to study. They just want me to love what I do, and I play the game because of my passion towards it.”

That passion comes with the ambition of qualifying for LA 2028 and winning Olympic gold one day. Some might deem the latter goal lofty, but not Soumyajit. “We never know what she’ll win and how far she’ll go. Sky is the limit for her.”



Early danger at Delhi Worlds

Sindhu vs World No 2 Wang, Sen vs Vitidsarn likely in R16, even as Satwik-Chirag face upstarts Indra-Joaquin

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, August 5

WITH THE Badminton World Championships returning to India after 17 years, Indian shuttlers were handed testing draws, to keep their 12-edition streak going.

It could be déjà vu for five-time World Championships medallist PV Sindhu, whose pathway could look similar to last year with potential clashes with Chinese Wang Zhi Yi in pre-quarters and the tricky Putri Kusuma Wardani in quarters. Placed in same halves as World No 1 An Se Young, the Indian would've ensured a sixth medal if she reaches semis.

Sindhu, who is fresh off winning the Japan Open Super 750, is in the same half as Olympic and World champion An Se Young and will avoid her till the semi-finals. "Apart from An Se Young, it is a very open field. I think Sindhu definitely has a chance," said National head coach Pullela Gopichand. "She looks good in her training and the best part is that she is able to close the matches that she used to lose earlier." After a potential clash with Wang, Sindhu can face Wardani of Indonesia who has been her nemesis of sorts in recent times. At the 2025 edition, Sindhu defeated Wang but lost to Putri in the quarterfinals.

Sindhu is eyeing her sixth Worlds medal and she won't get a better chance than this to win it in front of the home crowd.

Youngster Unnati Hooda, who starts against Thet Htar Thuzar of Myanmar, has a potential Round of 32 clash against experienced Michelle Li of Canada.

In the men's singles, both homeboys have got tough opponents coming early in the draw. Lakshya Sen, who was seeded

14th, has a potential pre-quarters clash with Olympic silver and World Championships gold medallist Kunlavut Vitidsarn while unseeded Ayush Shetty will face World no 1 and reigning world champion Shi Yuqi of China in the first round.

"It is better that Ayush faces Shi Yuqi in the first round instead of the later rounds. It gives him a chance to take him out early if he pulls off the upset. With his big smash, Ayush is definitely going to be a threat," said Gopichand.

"If we talk about Lakshya, men's singles is a stacked field. Lakshya had a good run at All England where he defeated both Shi and Li Shifeng. So, it is going to be an unpredictable but exciting men's singles tournament this time," he said.

Focus on Sat-Chi

India's biggest medal hope is going to be the men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty. The duo got a bye in the first round but have a potential clash with Olympic silver medallist Chinese pair Liang Wei Keng and Wang Chang in quarters.

Upstarts Raymond Indra-Nikolaus Joaquin who made finals of the Super 1000 Indonesia Open, can prove handful testing the Indian service returns. "The draw is quite okay. On their day, if Satwik-Chirag is in good form, they can beat anyone," said coach Tan Kim Her, who will have Mathias Boe join him in strategizing.

However, the biggest concern remains Satwik's long-term shoulder fitness, that needs managing at all times. After winning the Singapore Open 750 in June, the duo skipped tournaments to prepare for the World's and avoided aggravation from over-use.



PV Sindhu will face off against Sophia Noble of Ireland in the first round. BAI

• INDIANS' DRAW AT WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

SATWIK-CHIRAG (MD), 5TH SEED
6/10 DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Sat-Chi avoided top ranked Koreans Seo Seung Jae and Kim Won Ho as well as Aaron Chia-Soh Wooi Yik. But Raymond - Nikolaus in pre-quarters can surprise, with Liang-Wang wait in the quarters.

PV SINDHU (WS), 9TH SEED
8/10 DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Dealt the same possible draw as 2025, Sindhu is expected to get past a sturdier Wang Zhi Yi in pre-quarters and then Putri Kusuma Wardani. She avoids An Se Young till semis.

AYUSH SHETTY (MS), UNSEED
9/10 DIFFICULTY LEVEL

World No 1 Shi Yuqi is vulnerable first up. Which is good for Ayush. But both will arrive well rested, well prepared. Pressure on the Chinese, who would be sick of Indians who turn up in Round 1 to evict him while he has a crown to defend.

LAKSHYA SEN (MS), 15TH SEED
6/10 DIFFICULTY LEVEL

The potential pre-quarterfinal Round of 16 match against Kunlavut Vitidsarn jumps out threateningly. But Sen digs big events. Remember the Paris Olympics? Toughest group but he marched into semis.

"His shoulder is almost fully recovered now. He is ready now," Tan said. "He has gone through rehab. I think now he is improving a lot. Of course, the rehab is still there but he is getting much better. Chirag is fully 100 per cent fit."

However, the Malaysian coach admitted that Satwik's shoulder, which has troubled him since suffering a tear several years ago, continues to be a worry. "I am a little worried about Satwik's shoulder. It is on and off, hopeful he will overcome it in time. That's my only concern. They are confident

otherwise," he said.

In the women's doubles, top Indian duo of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand were on sidelines due to an injury dating back to eve of Uber Cup when Treesa collided with her mixed doubles partner. The duo just returned to the court last week at the Philippines International Challenge winning the title.

"Treasa's injury was an unfortunate one. She collided with another shuttler while playing a mixed doubles game. It was unfortunate but they have returned and they looked good in the last tournament,

Players excited but anxious before landmark Brazil friendly

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, August 5

JUST A day after All India Football Federation (AIFF) announced a milestone international friendly against five-time World Cup champions Brazil came the sobering news of Jamshedpur FC, owned by the Tata Group, withdrawing from the Indian Super League. If the AIFF had hoped for some much-needed feel-good factor in the perennially-fraught game in the country, they were quickly hit by a heavy reality check.

There remains little clarity over when the country's top league will begin, or even how many teams will take part.

The Indian Express has learnt that the clubs' consortium, which was handed the commercial rights of the nation's top league a month ago, has earmarked October 10 as the date for the commencement of the ISL. This is a deviation from the announcement post AIFF's Special General Body Meeting (SGBM) — held on June 20 — wherein it was announced that the league will start on September 4.

The uncertainty leaves India's internationals caught between excitement and apprehension: the thrill of facing Brazil, and the prospect of doing so without competitive football in their legs.

Friendly before fixtures

"As a player, I'm extremely happy. It's a huge privilege and a massive opportunity to play against the Brazil national team. It's a dream for every footballer. It is undoubtedly a big occasion," Rahul Bheke tells *The Indian Express*.

The excitement is soon replaced by concern. "But personally, I feel it's happening at the wrong time. If you look at the current state of Indian football, there is so much uncertainty. We don't even know when the ISL season will start.



Rahul Bheke. INSTAGRAM

Everything has been delayed. Then you have the Jamshedpur situation, and there is still uncertainty around clubs like Inter Kashi and Diamond Harbour. We still don't know what the ISL will eventually look like, how many teams will participate or exactly which clubs will be playing," he added.

"So, while there are definitely positives to hosting a team like Brazil, there will also be many concerns because of the circumstances we are in. That's why I feel the timing isn't ideal."

Fellow right-back Pritam Kotal echoed Bheke's enthusiasm, but with a caveat. "The occasion will be huge for us. We will never forget the experience we will get from this Brazil game. It is not every day that a team of Brazil's stature comes to India, so we are looking forward to it. But at the same time, it is not ideal that we will have to play this fixture without any match practice. Those currently playing in the Durand Cup at least have some competitive minutes under their belt. But most ISL clubs are not in this tournament. My team is not playing either. For us, it will be a challenge to keep ourselves sharp for the Brazil game," the Chennaiyin FC defender told this newspaper.

Mumbai City FC's midfielder Brandon Fernandes perhaps sums the mood best.

"Right now, everything in

Indian football is a challenge. It would have been better if we had match practice. But since we won't, all we can do as professional footballers is be disciplined and do the work even when we are away from the pitch to stay fit."

Priorities unclear

Former India international Mehrajuddin Wadoo, currently president of the Football Players' Association of India (FPAI) and Mohammedan SC coach, believes the episode reflects poorly on the game in the country.

"Our first priority should be to get Indian football back on track, and not the Brazil game. Everyone has to think about how we can make our league stronger and improve the overall standard of the game. Of course, it's wonderful that Brazil are coming. But improving the state of Indian football has to remain the priority. If our league still hasn't started by then, our players won't have regular game time or match fitness. Playing a team like Brazil without competitive matches behind you is extremely difficult," he says.

The concerns extend beyond the result. "It would have been much better if our domestic football was in a healthier place before hosting a team like Brazil. People from outside will also notice that there's no league, there are administrative issues and so much uncertainty. That doesn't help the reputation of Indian football on the global stage. In fact, it could end up making our image worse."

Bheke, too, hopes the spectacle against Brazil doesn't distract from the more pressing task at hand. "I hope everything gets back on track and the season returns to the way it used to be. I'm hoping for a competitive campaign with as many matches as possible. That's important because players need game time. More than anything else, I'm simply hoping for a normal season."

EXPERIENCE TOYOTA HYBRID ELECTRIC ADVANTAGE

HIGH ON MILEAGE. HIGHER ON SAVINGS. NO CHARGING WORRIES.

PARAMETER	HYBRID	REMARKS
MILEAGE	High	BEST IN CLASS
RUNNING COST	Low	MORE SAVINGS
MAINTENANCE COST	Low	BUDGET RELIEF
EMISSION	Low	ENVIRONMENT FRIENDLY

HYBRID MILEAGE **27.97** km/l*

ATTRACTIONAL LOW RATE OF INTEREST@ 5.99%*

*Applicable only on Hybrid Grades

EAST DELHI	WEST DELHI	SOUTH DELHI	NORTH DELHI	NOIDA	GURUGRAM	FARIDABAD
MALIK PD - 24, Metro Pillar No-52, Jhimli Industrial Area, Shahdara 9053988880, 9053988881	GALAXY Moti Nagar Crossing 8448293658, 457 23 000 MGF Shivaji Place, District Centre, Ring Road, Raja Garden 89299007449, 8929904428, 9311079716 GALAXY Dwarka, Nr. Sec-9 Metro Station 7838193193, 434 77 777	ESPIRIT Mathura Road, N. Delhi 7290064952, 1800 103 5686 GALAXY G-1 Station Box, Chattarpur Metro Station 9870191014, 66763666 GALAXY Ring Road, Opp. Moolchand Hospital, Lajpat Nagar-IV 9599788513, 465 77 777	GALAXY Shalimar Place, Outer Ring Road, Nr. Rohini 9599788514, 400 11 111 SATYAM Netaji Subhash Place, Pitampura 9266774644	ESPIRIT D-37 & 38, Surajpur Site-4, Kasna, Gr. Noida 7290095001, 9654999635, 1800 103 5686 ESPIRIT D-11, Sec-8, Noida 7290095001, 9654999635, 1800 103 5686	MGF MGF Mega City Mall, M.G. Road, Gurugram 9289007445, 9289007447, 9289007446, 0124-4603333 MGF Global Foyer Mall, Golf Course Road, Sec-43 9289007447, 0124-4596800 MGF Sector-50, Golf Course Extn. Road, Gurugram 9512295122, 9289670701 IJM Boulevard II, Sector-47 Gurugram Sohna Road 9289670701 IJM C-1 Block, Palam Vihar, Near Narayana School, Gurugram 8448286497	THIRTY SIX 147, Main Mathura Road, Faridabad 8800333636, 0129-4293636

ESPIRIT TOYOTA: BULANDSHAHR- 7290095001, SIKANDRABAD- 7290095001, JEWAR- 7290095001, **GALAXY TOYOTA:** MUNDKA- 9599624698, NARELA- 9999534551, NAJAFGARH- 9266753380, **IJM TOYOTA:** PATAUDI- 9512295122, SOHNA- 9512295122, **MGF TOYOTA:** FARRUKH NAGAR (NEAR ANAJ MANDI)- 9599121800, MANESAR (NEAR IMT CHOWK)- 9599121800, **THIRTY SIX TOYOTA:** HODAL (MAIN MARKET)- 8199900183, HATHIN (RAJA JI MARKET)- 7988274475, TIGAON (BHUAPUR)- 8800790130, BALLABGARH (NEAR ESCORTS MUJESAR)- 8800790081

*Terms & conditions apply on all schemes & offers. Offer valid till 31st August 2026. The Aero Edition kit is an accessory package to be fitted by authorized dealers based on customer preference and at additional cost. Fuel efficiency as certified by Test Agency under rule 115 of CMVR, 1989 under standard test conditions. Actual mileage on road may vary. Finance at the sole discretion of Financier. The background images used in this creative are AI-generated and are intended solely for illustrative purposes. Any resemblance to any person, place, property, event or entity is purely coincidental and unintentional. Creative visualization. Digitally created visual. Picture of vehicle was not taken while driving. Accessories shown may not be part of standard equipment.

Vol XCIV- 231 Regd.No. DL-21046/03-05 R.N.I. No.506/1957. Printed and Published by Ramesh Chander Malhotra on behalf of The Indian Express (P) Limited and Printed at The Indian Express (P) Limited Press, A-8, Sector-7,Noida - 201301 and Published at The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Editorial office: The Indian Express (P) Limited, Mezzanine Floor, Express Building, 9 & 10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002. Phone: 0120-6651500. Advertising office: The Indian Express (P) Ltd., Express Building, B1/B, Ramnath Goenka Marg, Sector 10, Noida-201301. Phone: 0120-6651291. Chairman of the Board: Vivek Goenka, Chief Editor: Raj Kamal Jha, Editor: Unni Rajen Shanker, Editor (Delhi): Monojit Majumdar ** *Responsible for selection of News under the PRP Act. Copyright: The Indian Express (P) Limited. All rights reserved. Reproduction in any manner, electronic or otherwise, in whole or in part, without prior written permission is prohibited. The Indian Express®

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi